Non-Abelian Matrix-Condensate Geometrogenesis

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Preface

This book develops Non-Abelian Matrix-Condensate Geometrogenesis (NAMCG) as a single derivation chain: from a microscopic matrix order parameter to an emergent Lorentzian metric, massless spin-2 dynamics, covariantly conserved entanglement backreaction, and a set of astrophysical corollaries.

The text is written for any reader who will follow an argument in order. The working language is the Einstein equation, geodesic deviation, and the idea of a Lagrangian. Quantum field theory is reviewed where it is used. Entanglement entropy is developed from scratch.

Two reading rules are in force throughout.

First, a composite metric is not general relativity until the infrared spectrum contains two massless transverse-traceless polarizations, the Einstein–Hilbert prefactor is computed from microscopic data, and every extra stress tensor satisfies $\nabla^\mu T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu} = 0$. Analog-gravity metrics and phenomenological drag terms are treated as insufficient.

Second, numerical laboratories in later chapters are reduced models. They illustrate conservation and dissipation after the covariant theory has been stated. They do not replace that theory.

Chapter 1 states the derivation problem. Chapter 2 installs only the geometry and field theory consumed by later proofs. Chapters 3–11 are the core. Chapters 12–15 are applications. Chapter 16 restates the chain. Chapter 17 lists limitations and falsifiers.

Lake Ontario, 2026-09-19
Edward Schipani, Independent Researcher

Notation

Throughout, spacetime indices $\mu, \nu, \ldots$ are coordinate indices, $A, B, \ldots \in \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$ are tangent-space Lorentz indices, and $I, J, \ldots$ are internal gauge indices of the matrix condensate. The metric signature is $(-, +, +, +)$. Repeated indices are summed.

Symbol	Meaning	Introduced
$\Phi^I{}_A$	matrix order parameter	Ch. 3
v	condensate vacuum expectation value	Ch. 3
$\hat{X}^\mu$	matrix coordinates	Ch. 3
$\Theta^{\mu\nu}$	non-commutativity tensor	Ch. 3
Λ_{UV}	ultraviolet cutoff $\sim \Theta^{-1/2}$	Ch. 3
e^A_μ	emergent vierbein $\langle \partial_\mu \Phi^{IA} \rangle$	Ch. 4
$g_{\mu\nu}$	composite metric $\eta_{AB} e^A_\mu e^B_\nu$	Ch. 4
$T_{\mu\nu}$	symmetric trace-free shear mode	Ch. 5
S_D	entanglement entropy of causal diamond D	Ch. 6
H_D	modular Hamiltonian $-\ln \rho_D$	Ch. 6
U_{ent}	mutual-information potential	Ch. 6
G_{eff}	emergent Newton coupling	Ch. 8
$T^{\mathrm{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$	entropic stress tensor	Ch. 11
$\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{irrev}}$	irreversible drag acceleration	Ch. 11
S_{HBEV}	holographic boundary-entropy action	Ch. 12
Λ_{eff}	regulated cosmological constant	Ch. 12
r_0	core-regularization scale in $f(r)$	Ch. 13

Where a later chapter needs a second meaning for a symbol, the local definition is restated at the start of that section. The table above is the default.

Chapter 1

What Geometrogenesis Must Derive

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. state the geometrogenesis problem as a derivation task, not a metaphor;
2. explain why analog-gravity metrics are not general relativity;
3. identify the representation content that a microscopic order parameter must carry if massless spin-2 modes are to exist;
4. list the consistency conditions treated as non-negotiable in this book: diffeomorphism invariance, $\nabla^\mu T^{\rm total}_{\mu\nu} = 0$, a bounded infrared Hamiltonian, and an explicit map from microscopic couplings to $G_{\rm eff}$;
5. see why Chapter 2 is required before any later proof can be stated.

1.1 What this book is trying to derive

General relativity is an infrared theory of a dynamical Lorentzian metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ whose vacuum excitations are two massless, transverse-traceless spin-2 polarizations, and whose coupling to matter is fixed by local energy-momentum conservation and the equivalence principle. In standard presentations the metric is primitive. One writes an Einstein–Hilbert action

$$S_{\rm EH}[g] = \frac{1}{16\pi G}\int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}\,R \tag{1.1}$$

and proceeds.

Geometrogenesis asks a more primitive question:

> Can $g_{\mu\nu}$, the Einstein–Hilbert dynamics, and the two graviton polarizations be obtained as the long-wavelength collective description of a microscopic quantum system that does not contain a metric as a fundamental field?

That question is the subject of this book. The framework developed here is Non-Abelian Matrix-Condensate Geometrogenesis (NAMCG). The microscopic object is not a single complex scalar. It is a matrix-valued order parameter $\Phi^I{}_A(x)$ carrying an internal gauge index I and an emergent tangent-space index $A \in \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$. The metric is a composite,

$$e^A_\mu(x) \equiv \langle \partial_\mu \Phi^{IA}(x) \rangle, \qquad g_{\mu\nu}(x) = \eta_{AB}\, e^A_\mu(x)\, e^B_\nu(x). \tag{1.2}$$

The later chapters argue that entanglement equilibrium on causal diamonds forces the infrared mass of the symmetric trace-free shear mode to vanish, that a heat-kernel expansion supplies an explicit formula for $G_{\rm eff}$, and that the entanglement backreaction stress tensor remains covariantly conserved.

Those are theorems *inside the framework*. This first chapter does not prove them. It makes precise what would count as a proof, and why the obvious scalar shortcuts fail.

1.2 Analog gravity, and the ceiling it cannot break

A large and useful literature constructs effective metrics for perturbations on condensed-matter backgrounds. The standard example is a weakly interacting Bose gas with order parameter $\Psi = \sqrt{\rho}\, e^{i\theta}$. Phase fluctuations θ obey, after linearization, a wave equation

$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{-g_{\rm ac}}} \partial_\mu \Big(\sqrt{-g_{\rm ac}}\, g^{\mu\nu}_{\rm ac} \partial_\nu \theta \Big) = 0 \tag{1.3}$$

in an acoustic metric $g^{\mu\nu}_{\rm ac}$ built from the background density and flow. Horizons, ergoregions, and Hawking-like spectra can be engineered in the laboratory.

This is analog gravity. It is not geometrogenesis of general relativity, for four structural reasons.

Only one scalar mode. The Goldstone field of a single complex scalar is a scalar. The acoustic metric is a rewriting of that scalar wave equation. It does not create two independent tensor polarizations.

Screening. Gross–Pitaevskii interactions introduce a healing length ξ. The static potential felt by a localized source is of Yukawa or modified-Bessel type, not a $1/r$ Newtonian potential with radiative $1/r$ tails.

Wrong infrared gravity. A relativistic scalar condensate coupled to an auxiliary metric generically yields Nordström gravity (conformal, with no bending of light in the pure-scalar sector) or scalar–tensor gravity. The Einstein tensor is not selected as the unique linearized kinetic operator for a massless spin-2 field.

Dissipation inserted by hand. Binary inspiral in general relativity follows from quadrupole radiation in a theory with massless spin-2 waves. Replacing that derivation by a Peters formula or a drag term in Newton's equation may fit a curve. It does not derive the curve from the microscopic action.

NAMCG is written to climb over that ceiling, not to decorate it.

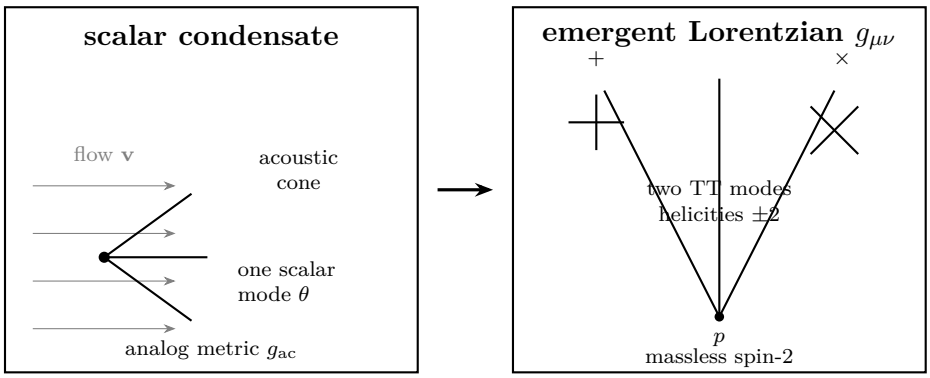


Figure 1.1: A scalar order parameter supplies an acoustic metric. It does not supply the two massless spin-2 polarizations of general relativity.

1.3 Representation theory in one paragraph

Local Lorentz invariance acts on tangent-space indices. A graviton is a symmetric, traceless, divergenceless tensor $h_{\mu\nu}$ with two on-shell degrees of freedom in four dimensions. A single scalar ϕ can produce a conformal mode proportional to $g_{\mu\nu}\delta\phi$, and perhaps a vector current if a global symmetry is gauged, but it cannot produce an irreducible shear tensor as an independent propagating excitation of the order parameter itself.

That is the representation-theoretic reason the microscopic field is promoted to $\Phi^I{}_A$. The tangent index A is not cosmetic. It is the handle on which local $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ will later act. Chapter 5 decomposes

$$\delta\Phi^I{}_A = \frac{1}{4}\eta_{\mu\nu}\delta g^{\mu\nu}\, I + A_\mu \gamma^\mu + T_{\mu\nu} \tag{1.4}$$

into conformal, vector, and symmetric trace-free pieces. Chapter 7 is the argument that $T_{\mu\nu}$ becomes massless.

If that argument fails, NAMCG collapses back to analog gravity. The book is organized so the reader can see exactly where it would fail.

1.4 What must be delivered before one may say "this is GR"

A derivation of infrared general relativity from a microscopic model is not complete unless all of the following are obtained, not assumed.

1. **Composite metric.** $g_{\mu\nu}$ is defined from microscopic expectation values. It is not put into the fundamental action as an independent Einstein metric.

2. **Local Lorentz frames.** The vacuum must lock internal indices to tangent indices so that e_μ^A transforms as a vierbein and no physical Goldstone scalars remain. That is Chapter 10.

3. **Two massless TT modes.** The infrared kinetic operator of $T_{\mu\nu}$ must be the Lichnerowicz / Einstein operator, with $m_T^2 = 0$. That is Chapters 6–7.

4. **Coefficient map.** Matching the physical G_{eff} requires specified gauge-fixed operators, determinant weights, sector thresholds, and a scheme. Chapter 8 gives a conditional truncated identity; denote the continued curvature coefficient for those inputs by C_R^L; its physical value remains open in Problem F:

$$C_R^L[\{\mathcal{O}_s, w_s, \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}\,s}, \mu_s\}, \mathcal{S}] \quad \text{is not yet evaluated.} \tag{1.5}$$

5. **Bianchi consistency.** Whatever extra stress is attributed to entanglement or condensate backreaction must satisfy

$$\nabla^\mu \big(T_{\mu\nu}^{\text{matter}} + T_{\mu\nu}^{\text{tensor}} + T_{\mu\nu}^{\text{ent}}\big) = 0. \tag{1.6}$$

   That is Chapter 11. Without it, one has a non-conservative force, not geometry.

6. **Ultraviolet control.** Higher-derivative terms generated by integrating out the condensate cannot leave propagating Ostrogradsky ghosts in the infrared. That is Chapter 9.

7. **Vacuum energy.** The same heat-kernel expansion produces a term $c_0\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^4$. A framework that claims to recover Einstein's equation must say why this is not a Planck-scale cosmological constant. That is Chapter 12.

8. **Phenomenology as corollary.** Rotation curves, regular cores, inspiral drag, and tidal disruption are allowed only after items 1–7. They are not evidence that items 1–7 have been proved.

This checklist is the spine of Parts II–IV. Parts V–VI apply it.

1.5 The NAMCG derivation in one view

The logical order used from Chapter 3 onward is

$$\begin{aligned}\Phi^I{}_A &\longrightarrow \langle\Phi\rangle = v\,\delta^I{}_A \longrightarrow e^A_\mu = \langle\partial_\mu \Phi^{IA}\rangle \\ &\longrightarrow g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{AB} e^A_\mu e^B_\nu \longrightarrow \delta\Phi = \text{conformal} + \text{vector} + T_{\mu\nu} \\ &\longrightarrow \delta S_D = 0 \longrightarrow m_T \to 0 \longrightarrow S_{\rm EH}[g] + S^{(\text{backreaction})}_{\rm NAMCG}.\end{aligned} \tag{1.7}$$

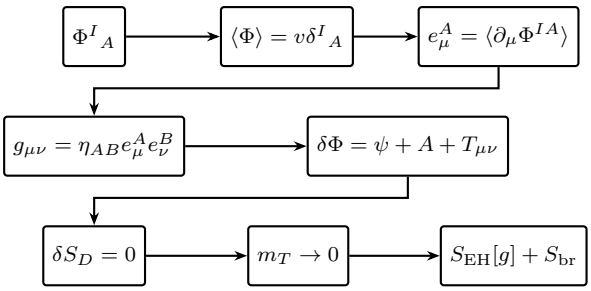


Figure 1.2: The NAMCG derivation spine used in this book. A single scalar phase cannot lock internal indices to local Lorentz frames.

Two comments are essential already.

First, the entanglement step is doing real work. In a generic spontaneously broken matrix model, $T_{\mu\nu}$ may be massive. The central physical claim of the book is that Jacobson's stationarity condition on dyadic causal diamonds,

$$\delta S_D = \delta\langle H_D\rangle = 0, \tag{1.8}$$

is not an extra thermodynamic slogan. It is a Ward identity of the microscopic theory, and that identity forbids $m_T^2 \neq 0$ in the infrared.

Second, the entropic drag must not be mistaken for a derived result. The inspiral integrator of Chapter 15 is a reduced Newtonian laboratory for the phenomenological law

$$\mathbf{F}_{\rm diss} = -\eta\,\frac{\mu}{d^4}\,\mathbf{v}. \tag{1.9}$$

Its bookkeeping does not establish that this force is the reduction of a covariantly conserved NAMCG stress. That microscopic connection remains open in Problem H.9. If the reader treats the Python drag as the theory, the book has failed.

1.6 How the later phenomenology sits on the spine

Once the infrared Einstein sector exists, NAMCG adds three controlled deformations, each with a named chapter.

Holographic Boundary-Entropy Vacuum (HBEV). A boundary functional involving $K/8\pi G$ and an entropy density $S_{\rm ent}(h_{ij}, \phi)$ is used to regulate $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$. This is how the book addresses the $c_0\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4$ term rather than ignoring it.

Einsteinian cubic gravity. A cubic curvature invariant whose linearization is Einstein-like on maximally symmetric backgrounds [1] motivates a regular-core model for compact objects (a phenomenological profile, not an established exact solution),

$$f(r) = 1 - \frac{2Mr^2}{r^3 + r_0^3} - \frac{\Lambda_{\rm eff}}{3} r^2, \tag{1.10}$$

so that $f(r) \to 1 - \Lambda_{\rm eff} r^2/3$ as $r \to 0$. This does not imply nonlinear or sourced stability, nor derive the profile from the ECG action.

Vacuum backreaction in galaxies and compact binaries. The same conserved extra tensor sources a modification of Poisson's equation; a phenomenological drag in compact binaries is tested as a separate assumption, not derived from that tensor.

None of these is a substitute for Chapters 3–11. They are tests of whether the extra tensors have the right long-distance falloff and the right conservation law.

1.7 How to read this book

Chapters 2–5 are definitional. Read them with a pen. If a symbol is used later with two meanings, the fault is in those chapters and should be caught there.

Chapters 6–11 are the proof core. Each theorem is written with hypotheses first. If a hypothesis is an assumption of the framework rather than a lemma, it is labeled as such.

Chapters 12–15 are applications. Numerical sections flag reduced models in the first paragraph.

Chapter 16 restates the whole derivation as a single chain. Chapter 17 lists what would falsify the framework. Read Chapter 17 before deciding that the theory is closed.

Prerequisites.

What you need. Special relativity, the Euler–Lagrange equation, and the Einstein equation as a field equation for a metric. Linear algebra at the level of commutators and traces. Quantum field theory is helpful but is introduced at the point of use. Entanglement entropy is built in Chapter 6 and Appendix B. If a later proof needs more than that, the extra tool is installed in Chapter 2 or in an appendix, not presupposed as coursework.

1.8 Exercises

1. **Acoustic metric.** Starting from the continuity and Bernoulli equations of an irrotational barotropic fluid, derive $g^{\mu\nu}_{\text{ac}}$ and show that linearized phonons see that metric. Where does a healing length appear if the fluid is a Gross–Pitaevskii condensate?

2. **Mode count.** In $3+1$ dimensions, how many on-shell degrees of freedom does a massive symmetric tensor have? A massless one with gauge invariance $\delta h_{\mu\nu} = \partial_\mu \xi_\nu + \partial_\nu \xi_\mu$? Why does that counting matter for Section 1.3?

3. **Scalar-tensor ceiling.** Consider $S = \int \sqrt{-g}(\phi R - (\partial\phi)^2 - V(\phi))$. Linearize about Minkowski spacetime and a constant ϕ_0. Show that the propagating excitations are a massless spin-2 field mixed with a scalar. What extra condition would be needed to freeze the scalar?

4. **Conservation as a constraint.** Suppose a two-body equation $\mu\ddot{\mathbf{r}} = -\nabla U + \mathbf{a}_{\text{irrev}}$ is written in Minkowski space. What property must $\mathbf{a}_{\text{irrev}}$ have if there is to exist a stress tensor $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$ with $\partial^\mu(T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}) = 0$? A full curved-space answer is Chapter 11; a Newtonian answer is enough here.

5. **Checklist audit.** Take any analog-gravity paper you know and score it against the eight items of Section 1.4. This exercise is the standard the book applies to itself.

1.9 Bridge to Chapter 2

Every later proof is a sentence in a language that has not yet been fixed: manifolds and vierbeine, Einstein–Hilbert variation and Bianchi identities, heat kernels, causal diamonds, and modular Hamiltonians. Chapter 1 stated the derivation problem. Chapter 2 installs the language at the exact thickness later chapters consume—no more, because a reader who must first finish a complete treatise on general relativity will never reach the matrix condensate.

The first object Chapter 2 defines is the one this chapter kept using without ceremony: a Lorentzian manifold with a non-degenerate metric of signature $(-,+,+,+)$, and the difference between a primitive metric and a composite vierbein bilinear.

Chapter 2

Mathematical Preliminaries

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. distinguish a primitive metric from a composite vierbein bilinear, and write the conversion between $g_{\mu\nu}$ and e^A_μ;
2. vary the Einstein–Hilbert action to obtain $G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G\, T_{\mu\nu}$ and state the contracted Bianchi identity that forces $\nabla^\mu T_{\mu\nu} = 0$;
3. expand a functional determinant to second Seeley–DeWitt order and recognize which coefficient multiplies R;
4. define a causal diamond, its modular Hamiltonian, and the first variation δS_D;
5. enter Chapter 3 already possessing every geometric sentence used in the matrix action and the later Ward identities.

This chapter is a toolkit, not a treatise. Every section exists because a later proof calls it by name. Results that are used as black boxes are labeled as such. Results that NAMCG must derive, rather than import, are flagged and postponed.

2.1 Lorentzian manifolds and index conventions

A spacetime in this book is a smooth four-manifold M equipped with a non-degenerate symmetric tensor $g_{\mu\nu}$ of signature $(-,+,+,+)$. The inverse is $g^{\mu\nu}$, and $g = \det(g_{\mu\nu})$. The volume form is $\sqrt{-g}\,\mathrm{d}^4x$.

Coordinate indices μ, ν, ρ, σ transform under diffeomorphisms. Tangent-space (Lorentz) indices $A, B, \ldots$ transform under local $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$. Internal gauge indices $I, J, \ldots$ transform under the microscopic gauge group of the condensate. These three alphabets are never mixed silently.

The Levi-Civita connection compatible with $g_{\mu\nu}$ is

$$\Gamma^{\rho}_{\mu\nu} = \frac{1}{2} g^{\rho\sigma} (\partial_\mu g_{\nu\sigma} + \partial_\nu g_{\mu\sigma} - \partial_\sigma g_{\mu\nu}). \tag{2.1}$$

The Riemann tensor, Ricci tensor, and Ricci scalar follow the conventions

$$\begin{aligned} R^{\rho}{}_{\sigma\mu\nu} &= \partial_\mu \Gamma^{\rho}_{\nu\sigma} - \partial_\nu \Gamma^{\rho}_{\mu\sigma} + \Gamma^{\rho}_{\mu\lambda}\Gamma^{\lambda}_{\nu\sigma} - \Gamma^{\rho}_{\nu\lambda}\Gamma^{\lambda}_{\mu\sigma}, \\ R_{\mu\nu} &= R^{\rho}{}_{\mu\rho\nu}, \qquad R = g^{\mu\nu} R_{\mu\nu}. \end{aligned} \tag{2.2}$$

The Einstein tensor is

$$G_{\mu\nu} = R_{\mu\nu} - \frac{1}{2} g_{\mu\nu} R. \tag{2.3}$$

Remark 2.1 (Mostly-minus versus mostly-plus). Particle-physics texts often use $(+,-,-,-)$. Every energy condition and every sign in a heat-kernel coefficient is convention-dependent. If a formula in a cited paper looks off by a sign, check the signature before inventing new physics.

2.2 Vierbeine: primitive geometry versus composite geometry

A vierbein (tetrad) is a local frame field e^{A}_{μ} satisfying

$$g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{AB}\, e^{A}_{\mu} e^{B}_{\nu}, \qquad \eta_{AB} = \mathrm{diag}(-1,+1,+1,+1). \tag{2.4}$$

The inverse frame e^{μ}_{A} obeys $e^{A}_{\mu} e^{\mu}_{B} = \delta^{A}_{B}$ and $e^{A}_{\mu} e^{\nu}_{A} = \delta^{\mu}_{\nu}$. Local Lorentz transformations act as

$$e^{A}_{\mu}(x) \;\longmapsto\; \Lambda^{A}{}_{B}(x)\, e^{B}_{\mu}(x), \qquad \Lambda^{T}\eta\Lambda = \eta. \tag{2.5}$$

For a given invertible frame, the torsion-free metric-compatible spin connection is unique. Equation (2.6) is the standard definition of the Levi-Civita spin connection:

$$\nabla_\mu e^{A}_{\nu} = \partial_\mu e^{A}_{\nu} - \Gamma^{\rho}_{\mu\nu} e^{A}_{\rho} + \omega_{\mu}{}^{A}{}_{B} e^{B}_{\nu} = 0. \tag{2.6}$$

In NAMCG an independent Lorentz connection is introduced in Chapter 10, (10.3); whether it equals this torsion-free connection is Problem D, not a result of the NAMCG dynamics.

Primitive metric. In textbook general relativity one takes $g_{\mu\nu}$ as the fundamental field. A vierbein is an optional rewriting, useful for spinors.

Composite metric. In NAMCG the logical order is reversed. A microscopic matrix field $\Phi^I{}_A$ is fundamental. After condensation one defines

$$e^A_\mu(x) \equiv \langle \partial_\mu \Phi^{IA}(x) \rangle \tag{2.7}$$

and only then reconstructs $g_{\mu\nu}$ by (2.4). Equation (2.7) is not justified in this chapter. It is the definition that Chapter 4 must earn.

The distinction matters for counting degrees of freedom. A primitive symmetric tensor in four dimensions has ten components, of which diffeomorphisms remove four and local Lorentz transformations are absent because there is no independent frame. A primitive vierbein has sixteen components; local Lorentz invariance removes six, diffeomorphisms remove four, and six remain, matching the metric. When the vierbein is composite, those sixteen numbers are not independent fields. They are expectation values of derivatives of Φ. Gauge redundancies of Φ and of the emergent geometry must be matched, not double counted. That matching is Chapter 10.

2.3 Variation of the Einstein–Hilbert action

The Einstein–Hilbert action with a cosmological term and a matter action is

$$S[g] = \frac{1}{16\pi G} \int_M \mathrm{d}^4x \, \sqrt{-g} \, (R - 2\Lambda) + S_{\mathrm{m}}[g, \Psi]. \tag{2.8}$$

Under a metric variation $g_{\mu\nu} \to g_{\mu\nu} + \delta g_{\mu\nu}$ one uses

$$\delta g^{\mu\nu} = -g^{\mu\alpha} g^{\nu\beta} \delta g_{\alpha\beta}, \qquad \delta\sqrt{-g} = \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{-g}\, g^{\mu\nu} \delta g_{\mu\nu}, \tag{2.9}$$

and the Palatini identity

$$\delta R_{\mu\nu} = \nabla_\rho(\delta\Gamma^\rho_{\mu\nu}) - \nabla_\nu(\delta\Gamma^\rho_{\mu\rho}). \tag{2.10}$$

The covariant-derivative terms become a boundary integral. On a manifold without boundary, or after adding the Gibbons–Hawking–York term

$$S_{\mathrm{GHY}} = \frac{1}{8\pi G} \int_{\partial M} \mathrm{d}^3x \, \sqrt{|h|} \, K, \tag{2.11}$$

the bulk stationarity condition is

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G \, T_{\mu\nu}, \tag{2.12}$$

where the matter stress tensor is defined by

$$T_{\mu\nu} = -\frac{2}{\sqrt{-g}}\frac{\delta S_{\rm m}}{\delta g^{\mu\nu}}. \tag{2.13}$$

The same definition will be used in Chapter 11 for the entropic contribution $T^{\rm ent}_{\mu\nu}$, with $S_{\rm m}$ replaced by the entanglement functional.

Remark 2.2 (Boundary terms are not optional in this book). Chapter 12 promotes a boundary entropy functional to a dynamical object. The combination $K/8\pi G$ appearing in (2.11) is therefore not an afterthought. It is the gravitational piece of the HBEV boundary action.

2.4 Bianchi identities and conservation

The Riemann tensor obeys

$$\nabla_{[\lambda}R_{\rho\sigma]\mu\nu} = 0. \tag{2.14}$$

Contracting twice yields the contracted Bianchi identity

$$\nabla^{\mu}G_{\mu\nu} = 0. \tag{2.15}$$

If the field equation is $G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G\, T_{\mu\nu}$, then necessarily

$$\nabla^{\mu}T_{\mu\nu} = 0. \tag{2.16}$$

This is not a courtesy to matter. It is the geometric content of diffeomorphism invariance.

In an emergent theory the same identity becomes a constraint on the microscopic construction. Suppose the total effective stress tensor is split as

$$T^{\rm total}_{\mu\nu} = T^{\rm matter}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\rm tensor}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\rm ent}_{\mu\nu}. \tag{2.17}$$

Geometry still requires $\nabla^{\mu}T^{\rm total}_{\mu\nu} = 0$. It is not enough that ordinary matter be conserved by itself if the extra pieces dump momentum into the world. Chapter 11 exists to prove that the NAMCG split satisfies (2.16). Until that proof, any inspiral "drag" is a phenomenological force and not a geometric backreaction.

Noether's second theorem makes the same point in field language. If an action is invariant under local diffeomorphisms generated by an arbitrary vector field ξ^{μ}, the Euler–Lagrange tensor $\mathcal{E}^{\mu\nu}$ of the metric obeys $\nabla_{\mu}\mathcal{E}^{\mu\nu} = 0$ identically, off shell as an identity of the tensor densities involved, and on shell as conservation of $T^{\mu\nu}$. Mass terms that break $\delta_{\xi}h_{\mu\nu} = \nabla_{\mu}\xi_{\nu} + \nabla_{\nu}\xi_{\mu}$ destroy that identity. That observation is the skeleton of Chapter 7.

2.5 Gauge covariant derivatives and a scalar warmup

Let $A_\mu = A_\mu^a T^a$ be a connection on a principal bundle with compact gauge group, generators T^a anti-Hermitian in the conventions of this book. The covariant derivative on a field Φ in a representation ρ is

$$D_\mu \Phi = \partial_\mu \Phi - i A_\mu \Phi \tag{2.18}$$

(up to the representation matrices, restored whenever the index structure requires them). The field strength is

$$F_{\mu\nu} = \partial_\mu A_\nu - \partial_\nu A_\mu - i[A_\mu, A_\nu]. \tag{2.19}$$

A complex scalar with Mexican-hat potential,

$$S[\phi] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x \, \sqrt{-g}\Big(- g^{\mu\nu} (D_\mu \phi)^* D_\nu \phi - \frac{\lambda}{4} \big(|\phi|^2 - v^2\big)^2 \Big), \tag{2.20}$$

condenses at $|\langle \phi \rangle| = v$. The phase is eaten by A_μ (Abelian Higgs / Stueckelberg mechanism), and the physical spectrum contains a massive vector and a massive radial scalar. There is no graviton. Here $g_{\mu\nu}$ is a fixed Lorentzian background of signature $(-,+,+,+)$, so time derivatives enter with positive energy. The earlier form $+|D_\mu\phi|^2 - V$ belongs to the $(+,-,-,-)$ convention and is not used in this book. The Euclidean action has $+g^{\mu\nu}(D_\mu\phi)^* D_\nu \phi + V$.

This warmup is here for two reasons. First, the NAMCG potential in Chapter 3 is the non-Abelian matrix analogue of (2.20). Second, the failure mode is already visible: a single complex scalar has one Goldstone phase. After it is eaten, nothing remains that can be identified with a symmetric trace-free tensor $T_{\mu\nu}$.

2.6 One-loop effective actions and the heat kernel

Let $\mathcal{O}$ be a second-order elliptic (or hyperbolic, after Wick rotation) differential operator on a bundle over M, typically of Laplace type,

$$\mathcal{O} = -g^{\mu\nu} D_\mu D_\nu + E, \tag{2.21}$$

with bundle endomorphism E. The one-loop effective action obtained by integrating out a fluctuation η is

$$W[g] = \frac{1}{2} \mathrm{Tr} \, \ln \mathcal{O} = -\frac{1}{2} \int_0^\infty \frac{\mathrm{d}s}{s} \, \mathrm{Tr} \, e^{-s\mathcal{O}}, \tag{2.22}$$

up to local counterterms and the usual $i\varepsilon$ / Wick-rotation caveats. The operator $e^{-s\mathcal{O}}$ is the heat kernel. Its diagonal admits the Seeley–DeWitt expansion

$$\langle x|e^{-s\mathcal{O}}|x\rangle \sim \frac{1}{(4\pi s)^2}(a_0(x) + a_1(x)s + a_2(x)s^2 + \cdots) \qquad (s \to 0^+), \tag{2.23}$$

in four dimensions. For a Laplace-type operator the first coefficients are

$$\begin{aligned} a_0 &= 1, \\ a_1 &= \frac{1}{6}R - E, \\ a_2 &= \frac{1}{180}(R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}R^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} - R_{\mu\nu}R^{\mu\nu} + \tfrac{5}{2}R^2) + \frac{1}{2}E^2 - \frac{1}{6}RE + \cdots, \end{aligned} \tag{2.24}$$

where the omitted terms involve derivatives of E and the bundle curvature. The precise tensor combination in a_2 will be written in full in Appendix A when it is needed for ghost analysis. What Chapter 8 requires is only this fact:

Proposition 2.3 (Which coefficient contributes to the curvature term)**.** *In the derivative expansion for specified Laplace-type sectors, the term linear in curvature and quadratic in the ultraviolet cutoff receives a contribution from a_1. After a cutoff Λ_{UV} is imposed on the proper-time integral* (2.22)*, the truncated expansion contains a contribution of the schematic form*

$$W[g] \supset \int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}(c_0\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^4 + c_2\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^2 R + \cdots). \tag{2.25}$$

The coefficient c_2 contributes to the conditional matching target for $1/(16\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}})$; this proposition does not determine it or establish a physical Newton coupling. The coefficient c_0 contributes to the vacuum-energy problem under the conventions stated in Chapter 8.

Proof sketch. Insert (2.23) into (2.22) and cut the proper-time integral at $s \sim \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^{-2}$. The a_0/s^3 and a_1/s^2 terms give the quartic and quadratic cutoff dependence term by term in the truncated expansion. The a_1 curvature contribution depends on the endomorphism E, sector weights, and thresholds; it need not remain nonzero in the completed sum. Chapter 8 gives the conditional identity, while Problem F requires the missing sector calculation. □

Two warnings, both of which the later text will spend chapters respecting.

1. The quartic term $c_0\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^4$ is not small. Declaring $\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} \approx 10^{-120}\rho_{\mathrm{Pl}}$ without a mechanism is not a calculation. Chapter 12 is that mechanism, or it is a failure.

2. If the fluctuation operator is fourth order, as in the quadratic action of Chapter 9, the heat-kernel calculus changes and Ostrogradsky poles appear. One cannot

quote a_1 from a second-order Laplacian and then use a $\Box^2$ kinetic term without further work.

2.7 Causal diamonds

Let p and q be events in M with q in the chronological future of p. The causal diamond (Alexandrov set)

$$D(p,q) = J^+(p) \cap J^-(q) \tag{2.26}$$

is the intersection of the causal future of p with the causal past of q. Its boundary ∂D consists of two null cones joined at a spacelike 2-surface $\mathcal{B}$ (the edge, or bifurcation surface in the small-diamond limit).

A *small* causal diamond is one whose proper size is short compared with the local curvature radius, so that the metric inside D may be written in Riemann normal coordinates

$$g_{\mu\nu}(x) = \eta_{\mu\nu} - \frac{1}{3} R_{\mu\rho\nu\sigma}(0) x^\rho x^\sigma + O(x^3). \tag{2.27}$$

Jacobson's thermodynamic derivation of Einstein's equation uses precisely such diamonds: the matter flux across ∂D is compared with the variation of entanglement entropy of the diamond interior.

Dyadic diamonds $D_{j,n}$ are a nested family obtained by repeated bisection of a reference diamond. They are bookkeeping. The physics is in the statement that first variations of entropy vanish for arbitrary small deformations of ∂D, not in the dyadic label.

Definition 2.4 (Diamond entanglement functional)**.** Let $\rho_D = \mathrm{Tr}_{M\setminus D}\rho$ be the reduced state of the microscopic theory on the diamond interior. The von Neumann entropy

$$S_D = -\mathrm{Tr}(\rho_D \ln \rho_D) \tag{2.28}$$

is the diamond entanglement functional. The modular Hamiltonian is

$$H_D = -\ln \rho_D, \tag{2.29}$$

so that $S_D = \langle H_D \rangle$ up to the additive constant $\mathrm{Tr}(\rho_D \ln \rho_D) + \langle \ln \rho_D \rangle = 0$ written in that form.

For a free field in Rindler space, H_D is proportional to the boost generator (Bisognano–Wichmann). For a small diamond in a curved background the same statement holds approximately, with Unruh temperature

$$T_{\mathrm{Unruh}} = \frac{\kappa}{2\pi}, \tag{2.30}$$

where κ is the surface gravity of ∂D as seen by the conformal Killing vector that fixes $\mathcal{B}$.

This book does *not* take Jacobson's equation of state as an axiom imported from thermodynamics of horizons. Chapter 6 derives $\delta S_D = 0$ from the microscopic matrix theory, or states clearly where an assumption remains. The definitions above are only the language in which that derivation is written.

2.8 Mutual information

For two regions A and B,

$$I(A:B) = S(A) + S(B) - S(A \cup B). \tag{2.31}$$

Mutual information is non-negative, vanishes if and only if $\rho_{AB} = \rho_A \otimes \rho_B$ (for finite-dimensional algebras), and is invariant under local unitaries on A or B. In NAMCG the macroscopic potential

$$U_{\text{ent}} = -\lambda\, I(A:B) = -\lambda\big[S(A) + S(B) - S(A \cup B)\big] \tag{2.32}$$

is the interaction energy assigned to two condensed cores A and B. The sign is chosen so that positive mutual information lowers the potential: entanglement is attractive in the effective description.

Varying the static U_{ent} gives the conservative interaction. It does not by itself produce a dissipative force; deriving drag requires the dynamical response calculation specified in Problem H.9. Because $I(A:B)$ is built from diffeomorphism scalars $S(\,\cdot\,)$, the conservative variation is not free to point in an arbitrary non-conservative direction. Making this remark precise is the content of Theorem 2 in the ultraviolet note, rewritten as a textbook proof in Chapter 11.

2.9 What this chapter deliberately omits

The following topics are real, and they are not treated here.

- A complete development of spinor bundles and the Dirac operator. NAMCG as formulated in the source notes is bosonic at the microscopic level. Fermionic matter can be coupled to the emergent vierbein later; it is not needed to obtain $G_{\mu\nu}$.
- Full renormalization of quantum gravity as a fundamental metric theory. The metric is not fundamental here. The ultraviolet object is the matrix condensate, with cutoff Λ_{UV}.

- A self-contained treatise on Tomita–Takesaki modular theory. Definition 2.4 and the replica formula $S = (1 - n\partial_n) \ln \operatorname{Tr} \rho^n|_{n=1}$ are sufficient for Chapter 6. Appendix B expands them.

- Numerical relativity. The integrators of Chapter 15 are ordinary-differential toy models, announced as such.

If a later proof appears to need a tool that is not in this chapter, the defect is in the later proof or in this chapter, and should be repaired rather than papered over with a citation.

2.10 Exercises

1. **Volume variation.** Derive both identities in (2.9) from $\delta g = g\, g^{\mu\nu} \delta g_{\mu\nu}$ and $g^{\mu\alpha} g_{\alpha\nu} = \delta^\mu_\nu$.

2. **Einstein tensor from variation.** Starting from (2.8) with $\Lambda = 0$ and no boundary, obtain $G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G\, T_{\mu\nu}$. Keep the Palatini terms long enough to see them become a total derivative.

3. **Contracted Bianchi.** Contract (2.14) twice and obtain $\nabla^\mu G_{\mu\nu} = 0$. Do not use the field equations.

4. **Frame versus metric degrees of freedom.** Count local components of e^A_μ and of $g_{\mu\nu}$. Subtract local Lorentz transformations and diffeomorphisms. Confirm that both descriptions have six physical components off shell in the usual sense of geometric gravity, before any equations of motion.

5. **Composite-frame warning.** Suppose $e^A_\mu = \langle \partial_\mu \Phi^{IA} \rangle$ and Φ is subject to a global internal rotation $\Phi \mapsto U\Phi$. What happens to e^A_μ? What additional structure is required before this rotation can be identified with a local Lorentz transformation of the emergent frame? (The answer is Chapter 10; write the question cleanly now.)

6. **Heat-kernel dimensions.** In four dimensions, assign canonical mass dimensions to a_0, a_1, a_2 and to the proper-time variable s. Show that $a_0 \Lambda^4_{\mathrm{UV}}$ and $a_1 \Lambda^2_{\mathrm{UV}}$ are the only two local terms generated by (2.23) that can appear as relevant or marginal couplings of mass dimension four or less, aside from logarithms.

7. **Small diamond.** In Riemann normal coordinates (2.27), compute the spatial 3-volume of a small diamond of radius ℓ to order $\ell^5 R$. This is the geometric ingredient in Jacobson's original argument.

8. **Mutual information positivity.** Prove $I(A:B) \geq 0$ from strong subadditivity, or from relative entropy $S(\rho_{AB}\|\rho_A \otimes \rho_B)$. Why does the sign in (2.32) then correspond to an attractive effective potential?

2.11 Bridge to Chapter 3

The language is now in place. A metric may be primitive or composite. If it is composite, it is built from a vierbein, and the vierbein must come from a field that carries a tangent index. The Einstein tensor is the Euler–Lagrange tensor of (2.8), and Bianchi forces conservation. Newton's constant, if it is emergent, lives in the a_1 heat-kernel coefficient. Entanglement lives on causal diamonds.

What is missing is the field. Chapter 3 introduces the non-Abelian matrix order parameter $\Phi^I{}_A$, the matrix-coordinate algebra $[\hat{X}^\mu, \hat{X}^\nu] = i\Theta^{\mu\nu}$, and the microscopic action whose condensation will produce the vierbein of (2.7). After that chapter, geometry is no longer an independent ingredient. It is an output.

Chapter 3

Matrix Coordinates and the Microscopic Action

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. write the non-commutative coordinate algebra $[\hat{X}^\mu, \hat{X}^\nu] = i\Theta^{\mu\nu}$ and state how $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$ supplies an ultraviolet cutoff;
2. write both microscopic actions used in the NAMCG notes—the pregeometric matrix action and the covariant condensate-field action—and say what each is for;
3. explain why the order parameter must carry an internal index I and a tangent index A;
4. expand the Mexican-hat matrix potential about its vacuum and identify the radial and Goldstone directions;
5. enter Chapter 4 knowing which object will condense into a vierbein.

Chapter 2 supplied geometry as language. This chapter supplies the field. After this point the metric is not an independent ingredient. It is something the field must produce.

3.1 The scalar failure, restated as a field-content problem

A single complex scalar ϕ transforming as a singlet under every tangent-space representation can condense. It can eat one Goldstone phase into a gauge field. It cannot furnish a local Lorentz frame. The infrared excitations of such a condensate are, at best,

- a radial Higgs scalar,

- a massive or massless vector, if a gauge field is present,
- phonons that admit an acoustic metric rewrite.

There is no symmetric trace-free tensor $T_{\mu\nu}$ hiding in ϕ. Seeking that tensor in a more elaborate potential for the same ϕ is a representation-theoretic error, not a calculational one.

NAMCG therefore promotes the order parameter to a rectangular (or square, after a choice of basis) matrix field

$$\Phi^I{}_A(x), \tag{3.1}$$

where $I = 1, \ldots, N$ labels an internal gauge representation and $A = 0, 1, 2, 3$ labels an emergent tangent space. The field is a linear map from the tangent space of an auxiliary frame into the internal space, or the reverse, according to index placement. The placement used in this book is: I up, A down on Φ, unless a formula from the source notes is being quoted verbatim.

The rest of the chapter writes an action for Φ and for a closely related pregeometric object, the matrix coordinates $\hat{X}^\mu$.

3.2 Two presentations, and why both appear

The original notes use two microscopic languages. They are not identical, and treating them as interchangeable by slogan would produce a confused book.

Presentation A: pregeometric matrix coordinates. There is, at the outset, no manifold. The dynamical objects are Hermitian operators $\hat{X}^\mu$ acting on a Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}$. Spacetime points, if they appear at all, appear as eigenvalue data of a complete commuting subset of these operators, or as a derived continuum after condensation.

Presentation B: condensate field on an auxiliary background. There is an auxiliary manifold with a non-dynamical metric $g^{(0)}_{\mu\nu}$. The dynamical object is the field $\Phi^I{}_A(x)$. The physical metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ is not $g^{(0)}_{\mu\nu}$. The auxiliary metric is a scaffold for writing derivatives and heat kernels. Chapter 8 uses this scaffold.

This book treats Presentation A as the ontological starting point and Presentation B as the background-field language appropriate after a condensate has selected a notion of local coordinates. Chapter 4 is the bridge. Until that bridge is built, the two actions below are written separately and not added together.

Assumption 3.1 (Auxiliary background is non-dynamical)**.** Whenever Presentation B is in use, $g^{(0)}_{\mu\nu}$ is a fixed scaffold, usually taken flat, $g^{(0)}_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu}$. It is not varied in the Einstein–Hilbert sense. Varying the *emergent* metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ defined in Chapter 4 is a different operation.

3.3 Presentation A: matrix coordinates and ultraviolet cutoff

Definition 3.2 (Matrix coordinates)**.** Let $\mathcal{H}$ be a separable Hilbert space and let $\hat{X}^\mu$, $\mu = 0, 1, 2, 3$, be Hermitian operators on $\mathcal{H}$. The fundamental kinematic relation of Presentation A is

$$[\hat{X}^\mu, \hat{X}^\nu] = i\Theta^{\mu\nu}, \tag{3.2}$$

where $\Theta^{\mu\nu} = -\Theta^{\nu\mu}$ is an antisymmetric tensor with dimensions of length squared. If $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$ is a multiple of the identity on $\mathcal{H}$, it is a c-number background. In the fully dynamical theory it may itself be an operator; the notes treat the leading infrared analysis with a c-number $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$.

The scale

$$\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}} \sim \Theta^{-1/2}, \qquad \Theta \equiv \sqrt{\tfrac{1}{2}\Theta_{\mu\nu}\Theta^{\mu\nu}}, \tag{3.3}$$

is the ultraviolet cutoff of the theory. Two operators that fail to commute cannot be simultaneously diagonalized, so the notion of a sharply localized event (x^0, x^1, x^2, x^3) is meaningless below $\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^{-1}$. This is the NAMCG replacement for a hard lattice.

Remark 3.3 (What $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$ is not). Equation (3.2) is not yet a solution of the cosmological-constant problem, not yet a black-hole core, and not yet a graviton. It is a kinematic regulator. Claims that begin "because spacetime is non-commutative…" and end at galactic rotation curves are skipping the work of Chapters 4–14.

A Yang–Mills-type matrix action for these coordinates, including a cubic structure-constant coupling to a background condensate tensor $C_{\mu\nu\lambda}$, is

$$\begin{aligned} S_{\mathrm{matrix}} = &-\frac{1}{4g_{\mathrm{YM}}^2}\mathrm{Tr}\big([\hat{X}^\mu, \hat{X}^\nu][\hat{X}_\mu, \hat{X}_\nu]\big) + \frac{1}{3!}\mathrm{Tr}\big(C_{\mu\nu\lambda}[\hat{X}^\mu, \hat{X}^\nu]\hat{X}^\lambda\big) \\ &+ S_{\mathrm{matter}}(\Psi, \hat{X}^\mu). \end{aligned} \tag{3.4}$$

The first term is the IKKT / reduced-Yang–Mills kinetic term. On a background satisfying (3.2) it is proportional to $\mathrm{Tr}(\Theta_{\mu\nu}\Theta^{\mu\nu})$ plus fluctuation pieces. The cubic term selects a preferred vacuum condensation structure; its detailed index symmetries are constrained by the requirement that the vacuum preserve a Lorentzian interpretation after Chapter 4.

Matter fields Ψ in S_{matter} are functions of the matrices $\hat{X}^\mu$ in the sense of the Weyl map associated with $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$. This book does not need the full star-product calculus until phenomenology with explicit localized sources appears in Chapter 14. The existence of such a map is enough for now.

3.4 Presentation B: the covariant condensate action

Once local coordinates x^μ have been introduced as labels on an auxiliary manifold, the dynamical variable is the matrix field $\Phi^I{}_A(x)$. Let A_μ be a connection on the internal bundle, with covariant derivative

$$D_\mu \Phi = \partial_\mu \Phi - i A_\mu \Phi \tag{3.5}$$

acting on the I index. The microscopic action used for the heat-kernel analysis is

$$S_{\text{micro}}[\Phi, A] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x \, \sqrt{-g^{(0)}} \, \mathrm{Tr}\Big(- g^{(0)\mu\nu} (D_\mu \Phi)^\dagger D_\nu \Phi - V(\Phi^\dagger \Phi) \Big). \tag{3.6}$$

The trace is over internal indices. Tangent indices on Φ are contracted through the potential and through the identification of A with a frame index after condensation; they are not traced in the same sum. In the signature $(-,+,+,+)$ of Chapter 2 the kinetic term is written with the minus sign so that time derivatives have positive energy. This is a correction to the Presentation-B action as stated; that the matrix action of Presentation A reproduces this sign is part of the unproved dictionary (Assumption 3.5) and remains to be derived.

The potential that triggers condensation is the matrix Mexican hat

$$V(\Phi^\dagger \Phi) = \frac{\lambda}{4} \mathrm{Tr}\big(\Phi^\dagger \Phi - v^2 \mathbb{I}\big)^2. \tag{3.7}$$

Its minima lie on the manifold

$$\Phi^\dagger \Phi = v^2 \mathbb{I} \tag{3.8}$$

in the internal space, up to unitary rotations. A representative vacuum used throughout the book is

$$\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v \, \delta^I{}_A, \tag{3.9}$$

which is available when the internal dimension is at least four and a basis has been chosen that identifies four internal directions with the tangent directions. If $N > 4$, the remaining internal directions must either decouple or be locked by additional Yukawa-like couplings. The source notes assume that a vacuum of the form (3.9) exists. This book records that as an assumption.

Assumption 3.4 (Existence of a frame-locking vacuum)**.** There exists a stable vacuum (3.9) (or a locally equivalent vacuum) in which four internal directions are identified with the four tangent directions. Goldstone modes associated with the broken generators are available to be eaten by a connection, as in Chapter 10.

3.5 Index structure and the intended infrared spectrum

Under an internal gauge transformation $\Omega(x)$ and a local Lorentz transformation $\Lambda(x)$, the field is required to transform as

$$\Phi^{I}{}_{A}(x) \;\longmapsto\; \Omega^{I}{}_{J}(x)\,\Phi^{J}{}_{B}(x)\,\Lambda^{B}{}_{A}(x). \tag{3.10}$$

Equation (3.10) is the transformation law that makes Φ capable of locking the two groups to a diagonal subgroup. It is a choice of field content. It is not derived from Presentation A alone; it is the additional structure that Presentation B puts in by hand so that a vierbein can exist.

Fluctuations about (3.9) will be decomposed in Chapter 5 into

$$\delta\Phi^{I}{}_{A} = \frac{1}{4}\eta_{\mu\nu}\delta g^{\mu\nu}\, I + A_{\mu}\gamma^{\mu} + T_{\mu\nu}. \tag{3.11}$$

The only fact needed here is that the last piece exists because Φ has two indices that can be symmetrized and made traceless after the vacuum has identified I with A. A scalar has no such piece.

3.6 Equations of motion from Presentation B

Varying (3.6) with respect to $\Phi^{\dagger}$ gives

$$D_{\mu}\big(\sqrt{-g^{(0)}}\, g^{(0)\mu\nu} D_{\nu}\Phi\big) - \sqrt{-g^{(0)}}\,\frac{\lambda}{2}\Phi\big(\Phi^{\dagger}\Phi - v^{2}\mathbb{I}\big) = 0. \tag{3.12}$$

Varying with respect to A_{μ} produces a matrix current conservation law

$$D_{\mu}\big(\Phi(D^{\mu}\Phi)^{\dagger} - (D^{\mu}\Phi)\Phi^{\dagger}\big) = 0, \tag{3.13}$$

up to the conventional factor of i in the current definition. These equations determine the condensate profile on the auxiliary background. They do not yet determine the Einstein tensor of the emergent metric. That requires integrating out fluctuations, which is Chapter 8, after the emergent metric has been defined in Chapter 4 and the tensor mode identified in Chapter 5.

3.7 Relating the two presentations

A complete derivation from (3.4) to (3.6) would construct, from the spectra of $\hat{X}^{\mu}$, a commutative manifold, a Weyl map, and a slowly varying matrix-valued field on that manifold whose covariant derivative reproduces the commutator $[\hat{X}^{\mu}, \hat{\Phi}]$. That

derivation is not supplied in full in the source notes. The working relation used in this book is the following.

Assumption 3.5 (Infrared dictionary)**.** In a condensate phase in which the matrices $\hat{X}^\mu$ are, to leading order, commutative coordinates $x^\mu \mathbb{I}$ plus fluctuations, there exists a slowly varying field $\Phi^I{}_A(x)$ such that

$$[\hat{X}_\mu, \Phi] \longleftrightarrow i\Theta_{\mu\nu} D^\nu \Phi \qquad \text{plus higher-derivative corrections in } \Theta. \tag{3.14}$$

Under this dictionary the quadratic commutator term in (3.4) is required to generate the kinetic term in (3.6), including its sign in the signature $(-,+,+,+)$; this is a matching condition, not an established result. Λ_{UV} remains the cutoff of the derivative expansion.

Assumption 3.5 is the most important unproved bridge in the microscopic setup. Chapter 17 lists a sharper derivation of this dictionary as an open problem. Every later heat-kernel formula is a calculation *within* Presentation B, contingent on the dictionary.

3.8 Energy scales and coupling constants

The dimensionful quantities introduced so far are

$$\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}, \qquad v, \qquad \lambda, \qquad g_{\mathrm{YM}}, \tag{3.15}$$

together with the auxiliary-background curvature scale, which is set to zero when $g^{(0)} = \eta$. Their intended roles are:

Quantity	Role
Λ_{UV}	kinematic cutoff from $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$
v	condensate scale; appears in the working conditional G_{eff} parameterization
λ	controls the radial Higgs mass $m_\sigma \sim \sqrt{\lambda}\, v$
g_{YM}	internal gauge coupling; enters the connection that eats Goldstones

Chapter 8 gives a conditional truncated heat-kernel identity. Define C_R^L as the Lorentzian curvature coefficient only after the specified sector sum and continuation:

$$C_R^L[\{\mathcal{O}_s, w_s, \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}\,s}, \mu_s\}, \mathcal{S}] \quad \text{is not evaluated here.} \tag{3.16}$$

The scale hierarchy needed to integrate out the radial mode is separate from this coefficient matching:

$$m_\sigma \ll \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}, \qquad v \lesssim \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}. \tag{3.17}$$

These are working hierarchy assumptions, not consequences of a computed Newton coupling. No Planck-cutoff inference, cancellation, or numerical value of G_{eff} follows before Problem F is completed.

3.9 What has been assumed, collected

The microscopic theory, as used from here on, rests on:

1. the coordinate algebra (3.2) with cutoff (3.3);
2. the matrix action (3.4) at the pregeometric level;
3. the condensate action (3.6)–(3.7) after coordinates exist;
4. Assumption 3.1, that $g^{(0)}$ is a scaffold;
5. Assumption 3.4, that a vacuum $\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v\delta^I{}_A$ exists;
6. Assumption 3.5, the infrared commutator dictionary.

Everything in Chapters 4–11 is a calculation from this list, or an additional assumption announced as such. The list is long enough that the theory is not "derived from nothing." It is derived from a definite microscopic ansatz. That is still a stronger starting point than inserting $g_{\mu\nu}$ by hand, provided the later chapters do the work advertised in Chapter 1.

3.10 Exercises

1. **Dimensions.** Assign mass dimensions to $\hat{X}^\mu$, $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$, Φ, v, λ, and g_{YM} in four dimensions, with $\hbar = c = 1$. Confirm (3.3).
2. **Vacuum of the potential.** Show that (3.7) is bounded below and that its minima satisfy (3.8). Linearize $\Phi = v\,\mathbb{I} + \sigma + i\pi$ in the internal space (ignoring tangent structure) and read off m_σ^2 and m_π^2.
3. **Why $N \geq 4$.** If the internal dimension is $N = 2$, can a vacuum of the form (3.9) exist? What infrared representation content is then missing?
4. **Commutator to derivative.** In the Moyal plane with constant $\Theta^{12} = -\Theta^{21} = \theta$ and all other components zero, verify the leading term of (3.14) on a plane-wave matrix $\Phi = e^{ik\cdot\hat{X}}$. Where do higher powers of θ appear?
5. **IKKT vacuum energy.** Evaluate the first term of (3.4) on the c-number background (3.2). Show that it is a constant proportional to $\text{Tr}(\Theta_{\mu\nu}\Theta^{\mu\nu})$. This constant is a preview of the $c_0\Lambda_{\text{UV}}^4$ problem.

6. **Transformation law.** Starting from (3.10) and the representative vacuum (3.9), compute the infinitesimal variation of Φ under a simultaneous internal rotation and local Lorentz transformation that preserve the vacuum. Which generators are broken? (This is the algebra of Chapter 10, prepared here.)

7. **No graviton in the scalar truncation.** Set $N = 1$ and drop the tangent index, reducing Φ to a complex scalar. Show that the fluctuation spectrum of (3.6) contains no spin-2 state. This is the Chapter 1 ceiling written as a homework problem.

3.11 Bridge to Chapter 4

The field exists, the potential prefers a vacuum $\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v\delta^I{}_A$, and the coordinate algebra supplies a cutoff. Nothing yet is a metric. Chapter 4 defines the emergent vierbein as the condensate gradient

$$e^A_\mu(x) \equiv \langle \partial_\mu \Phi^{IA}(x) \rangle, \tag{3.18}$$

reconstructs $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{AB} e^A_\mu e^B_\nu$, and writes the Seiberg–Witten map that relates the non-commutative background $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$ to the leading correction $\mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu}(\langle \hat{X} \rangle)$. After that chapter, geometry is an output of the action written here.

Chapter 4

Condensation, Vierbein Emergence, and the Seiberg–Witten Map

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. explain why a strictly constant vacuum $\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v\delta^I{}_A$ cannot, by itself, produce a non-degenerate vierbein from $\langle \partial_\mu \Phi \rangle$;
2. write the polar decomposition $\Phi = (v + \sigma)\Lambda$, state the polar-derivative prescription of the source notes as an unverified proposal that does not supply a frame (Problem C), and state the frame of Repair II;
3. reconstruct $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{AB} e^A_\mu e^B_\nu$ and state the non-degeneracy condition;
4. use the leading Seiberg–Witten map to relate $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$ to a correction of the emergent metric;
5. enter Chapter 5 with a definite background about which to expand $\delta\Phi$.

Chapter 3 introduced the field and a preferred vacuum. This chapter turns that vacuum into geometry conditionally: it posits the Repair II spacetime-dependent condensate as the frame, since the Repair I prescription does not supply one. No Einstein equation is derived here. The only output is a composite metric, plus the dictionary that connects it to the non-commutative parameter $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$.

4.1 The constant-vacuum obstruction

The representative vacuum of Assumption 3.4 is

$$\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v\, \delta^I{}_A. \tag{4.1}$$

If this expectation value is independent of x, then

$$\langle \partial_\mu \Phi^{IA} \rangle = 0. \tag{4.2}$$

The definition advertised in the source notes,

$$\mathcal{E}^A{}_{\mu I}(x) \equiv \langle \partial_\mu \Phi^{IA}(x) \rangle, \tag{4.3}$$

then yields the zero tensor. A zero tensor is not a frame.

This is not a notational quibble. A textbook that passes from (4.1) to a non-degenerate $g_{\mu\nu}$ without an intermediate step is asserting an identity that is false. There are two candidate repairs. Only Repair II is carried through in this book; they must be kept distinct.

Repair I: the proposed polar-derivative prescription. Write the field in polar form, as in the ultraviolet note,

$$\Phi^{IA}(x) = \big(v + \sigma(x)\big)\, \Lambda^A{}_I(x), \tag{4.4}$$

where σ is a radial singlet and $\Lambda(x)$ takes values in the broken coset that rotates internal indices into tangent indices. Even if v is constant, $\partial_\mu \Phi$ need not vanish:

$$\partial_\mu \Phi^{IA} = (\partial_\mu \sigma)\, \Lambda^A{}_I + (v + \sigma)\, \partial_\mu \Lambda^A{}_I. \tag{4.5}$$

A vacuum with $\langle \sigma \rangle = 0$ and a slowly varying $\langle \Lambda \rangle$ has $\langle \partial_\mu \Lambda \rangle \neq 0$, but this is a candidate frame only in the sense of the source notes; see the discussion after Repair II.

Repair II: identify the vacuum itself with a frame. Promote the representative vacuum to a spacetime-dependent but still "pure Higgs" configuration

$$\langle \Phi^I{}_A(x) \rangle = v\, e^I{}_A(x), \tag{4.6}$$

and treat $e^I{}_A$ as the fundamental condensate profile. In this repair, equation (4.3) is abandoned as a definition. The vierbein *is* the normalized vacuum,

$$e^A_\mu(x) \equiv \frac{1}{v} \langle \Phi^A{}_\mu(x) \rangle, \tag{4.7}$$

after the internal and tangent bases have been identified.

Repair II is simpler and is the standard Higgs-gravity pattern. Repair I is what the notes write when they insist on (4.3). The two are not equivalent. Repair II defines a frame directly from the condensate and, wherever Assumption 4.4 holds, supplies a non-degenerate $e^A{}_\mu$. Repair I, as written in Definition 4.1, leaves the index I

uncontracted, and Appendix H (Section H.3) shows that no Lorentz-equivariant linear contraction of $\partial_\mu\Lambda$ produces a vierbein fluctuation. Definition 4.1 is therefore kept only as a record of the prescription in the source notes; it is not a constructed frame. In the rest of the book the frame is the Repair II frame (4.7), or a non-degenerate coframe assumed separately (Assumption 4.4); statements that use the explicit form (4.8) are conditional on a repair of Repair I that this book does not supply.

Definition 4.1 (Repair I prescription of the source notes)**.** In a polar configuration (4.4) with $\langle\sigma\rangle = 0$, define the three-index object

$$\mathcal{E}^A{}_{\mu I}(x) \equiv \langle\partial_\mu \Lambda^A{}_I(x)\rangle. \tag{4.8}$$

By (4.5) this is $v^{-1}\langle\partial_\mu \Phi^{IA}\rangle$ at $\sigma = 0$ (with $\langle\partial_\mu\sigma\rangle = 0$), which is the prescription the source notes write as a vierbein, with the internal index I left uncontracted and no identification of I with a tangent index used. It is not a vierbein: it carries the extra index I, and no Lorentz-equivariant linear contraction of it yields a vierbein fluctuation (Appendix H, Section H.3). The factor $1/v$ is the normalisation the notes use when Φ has the engineering dimension of v; if a formula in the notes omits $1/v$, it is using units $v = 1$.

Remark 4.2 (The two repairs do not agree)*.* The expansion $\Lambda^A{}_I = \delta^A{}_I + v^{-1}\omega^A{}_{I\mu}x^\mu + \cdots$ makes $\partial_\mu\Lambda^A{}_I$ a constant three-index tensor, antisymmetric in (A, I). It lies in $V \otimes \mathfrak{so}(3,1)$, while a vierbein perturbation lies in $V \otimes V$; the two share no irreducible summand (Appendix H, Section H.3). Repair I therefore does not reproduce Repair II at first order. A corrected Repair I would need additional background tensors or an independent coframe, which is part of Problem C.

4.2 The composite metric

Definition 4.3 (Composite metric)**.** Given a non-degenerate frame e^A_μ, taken from Repair II, (4.7), or supplied separately as an assumption (Assumption 4.4),

$$g_{\mu\nu}(x) \equiv \eta_{AB}\, e^A_\mu(x)\, e^B_\nu(x). \tag{4.9}$$

Non-degeneracy is not automatic.

Assumption 4.4 (Non-degenerate condensate frame)**.** On the region of spacetime under consideration, e^A_μ has non-vanishing determinant. Equivalently, the four covectors $e^A{}_\mu \mathrm{d}x^\mu$ are linearly independent.

If Assumption 4.4 fails, $g_{\mu\nu}$ is degenerate and there is no Lorentzian geometry to discuss. Vanishing of $\det e$ is a physical possibility—a condensate defect, a region

where the frame-locking vacuum has not formed—not a gauge artifact. This book restricts attention to the condensed phase in which Assumption 4.4 holds.

The inverse metric and inverse frame are defined in the usual way once non-degeneracy is granted,

$$g^{\mu\nu} e^A_\mu e^B_\nu = \eta^{AB}, \qquad e^\mu_A e^A_\nu = \delta^\mu_\nu. \tag{4.10}$$

Local Lorentz transformations act on the frame index,

$$e^A_\mu \;\longmapsto\; \Lambda^A{}_B e^B_\mu, \tag{4.11}$$

and leave $g_{\mu\nu}$ invariant. Diffeomorphisms act on the coordinate index. These two redundancies are the reason a composite metric can have the same geometric content as a primitive metric, provided the Goldstone counting of Chapter 10 works.

4.3 What kind of object e^A_μ is

At this stage e^A_μ is a condensate profile, not a solution of Einstein's equation. It is closer to a magnetization than to a gravitational field. Three consequences follow.

1. There is no a priori reason for e^A_μ to satisfy the torsion-free condition (2.6). If torsion is to vanish, that is a dynamical statement about the independent connection (whose dynamics remain open in Problem D), not a definition.

2. There is no a priori reason for small disturbances of $g_{\mu\nu}$ to propagate as massless spin-2 waves. That is Chapter 7.

3. The auxiliary scaffold $g^{(0)}_{\mu\nu}$ of Presentation B is still present in the microscopic action. It must not be confused with (4.9). Heat-kernel calculations in Chapter 8 are conditional on the emergent- background identification; its precise role in matching the physical G_{eff} remains part of Problem F.

4.4 Seiberg–Witten map and the Θ correction

Presentation A still has a non-commutative parameter $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$. After a commutative manifold has been introduced, the open-string / non-commutative-gauge-theory dictionary of Seiberg and Witten relates an ordinary metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ and a two-form background to an open-string effective metric. The source notes write the leading relation

$$G_{\mu\nu}(x) = \big((g+\Theta)^{-1}\big)_{\mu\nu} + \mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu}(\langle \hat{X} \rangle). \tag{4.12}$$

Two clarifications are required before (4.12) is used.

Matrix versus form. As written, $g+\Theta$ adds a symmetric tensor to an antisymmetric tensor. The honest object is the mixed tensor

$$(g+\Theta)_\mu{}^\nu = g_{\mu\rho}\eta^{\rho\nu} + \Theta_\mu{}^\nu, \tag{4.13}$$

or, equivalently, the linear map $g+\Theta : T^*M \to TM$ after one index of Θ is raised with the auxiliary metric. The inverse in (4.12) is the inverse of that map. In components, for constant Θ on a flat auxiliary background,

$$\left((g+\Theta)^{-1}\right)_{\mu\nu} = g_{\mu\nu} - g_{\mu\alpha}\Theta^{\alpha\beta}g_{\beta\nu} + O(\Theta^2). \tag{4.14}$$

The first correction is symmetric if one takes the symmetric part, which is the part that can enter a metric. The antisymmetric remainder is a two-form background, not a correction to $g_{\mu\nu}$.

The extra term $\mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu}$. The piece $\mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu}(\langle\hat{X}\rangle)$ in (4.12) is the backreaction of the matrix condensate on the emergent geometry, beyond the kinematic Θ correction. At this stage of the book it is a name, not a formula. Chapters 8 and 11 compute pieces of it: the Einstein–Hilbert term from the heat kernel, and the entropic stress tensor from mutual information. Until those calculations exist, $\mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu}$ must not be assigned a phenomenology.

Definition 4.5 (Working infrared metric)**.** Unless a higher-order Θ correction is being tracked explicitly, "the emergent metric" means (4.9). Equation (4.12) is the next-order kinematic correction plus a placeholder for dynamical backreaction.

4.5 A linearised frame around Minkowski spacetime

The fluctuation chapters need a background. Choose coordinates and a local Lorentz gauge so that the condensed frame is the trivial frame plus a small disturbance,

$$e_\mu^A = \delta_\mu^A + \tfrac{1}{2}h^A{}_\mu + \omega^A{}_\mu, \tag{4.15}$$

where $h_{\mu\nu} \equiv \eta_{AB}\delta_\mu^A h^B{}_\nu$ is symmetric and $\omega_{\mu\nu}$ is antisymmetric. Then

$$g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu} + h_{\mu\nu} + O(h^2, \omega^2, h\omega). \tag{4.16}$$

The antisymmetric piece ω is a local Lorentz Goldstone. Under the assumptions of Chapter 10, its six orbit variables are removable in unitary gauge; this does not determine the dynamics of the independent diagonal connection. The symmetric piece $h_{\mu\nu}$ is the candidate graviton, still un-decomposed and possibly massive. Chapter 5 splits it; Chapter 7 asks whether its mass vanishes.

This expansion assumes that a Minkowski condensate exists: a vacuum in which $e^A_\mu = \delta^A_\mu$ globally, or in a region large compared with the scale of later experiments. Existence of that vacuum is part of Assumption 4.4, not a new principle.

4.6 Signature and the role of η_{AB}

Equation (4.9) borrows its signature from η_{AB}. Nothing in the potential (3.7) selected $(-,+,+,+)$ rather than $(+,+,+,+)$. A Euclidean condensate is a priori as natural as a Lorentzian one.

Assumption 4.6 (Lorentzian condensate)**.** The locked vacuum is Lorentzian: $\eta_{AB} = \mathrm{diag}(-1,+1,+1,+1)$. Dynamical emergence of this signature from a Euclidean matrix model is not proved in the source notes and is not pretended here. Chapter 10 shows how local $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ can arise *given* this η_{AB}.

A reader looking for a derivation of Lorentzian signature from nothing will not find it in this book. What the book does derive, contingent on Assumption 4.6, is the dynamics of the resulting Lorentzian metric.

4.7 Worked example: a weak, static frame perturbation

Take the Repair II frame, or any assumed non-degenerate frame, with the constant background $e^A{}_\mu = \delta^A{}_\mu$, and a small coordinate shift $x^\mu \to x^\mu + \zeta^\mu(x)$. The frame changes by its Lie derivative,

$$\delta e^A{}_\mu = \zeta^\nu \partial_\nu \delta^A{}_\mu + \partial_\mu \zeta^\nu \, \delta^A{}_\nu = \partial_\mu \zeta^A. \tag{4.17}$$

The associated metric perturbation is

$$h_{\mu\nu} = \partial_\mu \zeta_\nu + \partial_\nu \zeta_\mu \tag{4.18}$$

to first order. This configuration is geometry in name only: it is a coordinate artifact. A physical graviton must be a disturbance that cannot be written as (4.18). Isolating that disturbance is the point of the irreducible decomposition in Chapter 5.

The example demonstrates diffeomorphism redundancy of a Repair II (or assumed) frame. It does not derive a frame from Φ by Definition 4.1.

4.8 What this chapter has not done

The following statements are *not* theorems of Chapter 4.

- $g_{\mu\nu}$ obeys Einstein's equation.

- $h_{\mu\nu}$ contains two massless TT polarizations.
- A physical value of G_{eff} has not been obtained; it requires the specified sector calculation of Problem F.
- Torsion vanishes.
- The signature is dynamical.
- $\mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu}$ has been computed.

What has been done is narrower and indispensable: a composite metric has been defined from a non-degenerate condensate frame (Assumption 4.4); the constant-vacuum obstruction is addressed only by positing, in Repair II, a spacetime-dependent condensate that is identified with the frame (4.7) (no such profile is derived), while the Repair I formula of Definition 4.1 is not a constructed frame (Problem C, Appendix H); and the linearized Minkowski background used in every later proof has been fixed.

4.9 Exercises

1. **Zero frame.** Prove that a strictly constant $\langle\Phi\rangle$ yields $\langle\partial_\mu\Phi\rangle = 0$. This is the obstruction of Section 4.1 as a two-line exercise.
2. **Polar derivative.** Derive (4.5) from (4.4). Under what condition on Λ is e^A_μ proportional to a Maurer–Cartan form $\Lambda^{-1}\partial_\mu\Lambda$?
3. **Non-degeneracy.** Let $e^A_\mu = \mathrm{diag}(1, 1, 1, \varepsilon)$. Compute $g_{\mu\nu}$ and $\det g$. What fails as $\varepsilon \to 0$? Interpret the limit as a condensate defect.
4. **Symmetric part of the Θ correction.** From (4.14), extract the symmetric $O(\Theta)$ correction to $g_{\mu\nu}$ and the antisymmetric remainder. Which object can enter geodesic motion at this order?
5. **Linearized metric.** Starting from (4.15), derive (4.16) and show that ω_{AB} drops out of $g_{\mu\nu}$ at first order. Where does ω re-enter at second order?
6. **Pure gauge.** Show that (4.18) is the linearized diffeomorphism action on $\eta_{\mu\nu}$. Write one explicit $h_{\mu\nu}$ that cannot be written in this form. (Any TT wave will do.)
7. **Auxiliary versus emergent.** In Presentation B the microscopic action uses $g^{(0)}$. In this chapter the geometry is g. Write one sentence stating when it is legitimate to replace $g^{(0)}$ by g inside a heat kernel, and what error term that replacement drops. The full answer is Chapter 8; the sentence is due now.

4.10 Bridge to Chapter 5

The background is a condensed frame, taken Minkowski for the linearized theory,

$$\bar{e}_\mu^A = \delta_\mu^A, \qquad \bar{g}_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu}. \tag{4.19}$$

The next object is the fluctuation $\delta\Phi^I{}_A$ about the polar vacuum (4.4). Chapter 5 decomposes that fluctuation under local Lorentz transformations into a conformal piece, a vector piece, and a symmetric trace-free tensor $T_{\mu\nu}$. Only after that decomposition is it meaningful to ask which piece might be a graviton.

Chapter 5

Irreducible Lorentz Decomposition of Fluctuations

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. convert a fluctuation $\delta\Phi^I{}_A$ to a spacetime tensor using the background frame;
2. split that tensor into trace, antisymmetric, and symmetric trace-free pieces, and count components;
3. match the split to the schematic formula used in the source notes, $\delta\Phi^I{}_A = \frac{1}{4}\eta_{\mu\nu}\delta g^{\mu\nu} I + A_\mu \gamma^\mu + T_{\mu\nu}$;
4. distinguish algebraic irreducibility from the later dynamical conditions $\nabla^\mu T_{\mu\nu} = 0$ and $m_T^2 = 0$;
5. enter Chapter 6 knowing which piece is the candidate graviton.

Chapter 4 fixed a condensed background frame $\bar{e}^A_\mu = \delta^A_\mu$ (the Repair II frame, or an assumed non-degenerate frame) and a composite Minkowski metric. This chapter is linear algebra on the tangent space. No entanglement condition is used. No mass gap is shown to vanish. The only task is to name the pieces of $\delta\Phi$.

5.1 Fluctuations about the polar vacuum

Start from the polar field (4.4),

$$\Phi^{IA}(x) = \big(v + \sigma(x)\big)\, \Lambda^A{}_I(x), \tag{5.1}$$

and expand about the Minkowski condensate

$$\langle\sigma\rangle = 0, \qquad \langle\Lambda^A{}_I\rangle = \delta^A{}_I, \qquad \bar{e}^A_\mu = \delta^A_\mu. \tag{5.2}$$

Write

$$\Phi^{IA} = v\,\delta^{IA} + \delta\Phi^{IA}, \tag{5.3}$$

with $\delta\Phi$ first order in σ and in the deviation of Λ from the identity. For the rest of the linearized theory it is convenient to lower the internal index with the background identification $I \leftrightarrow A$ and convert the remaining tangent index to a coordinate index with $\bar{e}$:

$$\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu} \equiv \bar{e}^{A}{}_{\mu}\,\delta\Phi_{IA}\,\bar{e}^{I}{}_{\nu}. \tag{5.4}$$

When $N = 4$ and the vacuum of Assumption 3.4 locks every internal direction to a tangent direction, $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$ is a genuine 4×4 spacetime tensor. If $N > 4$, (5.4) captures only the locked 4×4 block. The orthogonal internal block is a collection of extra Higgs fields. They are assumed heavy and integrated out; they are not candidate gravitons.

Assumption 5.1 (Locked block dominates the infrared)**.** Fluctuations in internal directions orthogonal to the four locked axes have masses of order v or Λ_{UV} and may be discarded from the infrared Lorentz decomposition.

5.2 Algebraic split under the Lorentz group

At a fixed event, $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$ is an element of $\mathbb{R}^4 \otimes \mathbb{R}^4$. The Lorentz group $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ acts on each factor. The tensor product decomposes into irreducible pieces

$$\mathbf{4} \otimes \mathbf{4} = \mathbf{1} \oplus \mathbf{6} \oplus \mathbf{9}, \tag{5.5}$$

namely a scalar, an antisymmetric tensor, and a symmetric traceless tensor. Explicitly,

$$\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu} = \frac{1}{4}\eta_{\mu\nu}\psi + F_{\mu\nu} + T_{\mu\nu}, \tag{5.6}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \psi &= \eta^{\alpha\beta}\delta\Phi_{\alpha\beta}, \\ F_{\mu\nu} &= \frac{1}{2}(\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu} - \delta\Phi_{\nu\mu}), \\ T_{\mu\nu} &= \frac{1}{2}(\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu} + \delta\Phi_{\nu\mu}) - \frac{1}{4}\eta_{\mu\nu}\psi. \end{aligned} \tag{5.7}$$

By construction

$$T_{\mu\nu} = T_{\nu\mu}, \qquad \eta^{\mu\nu}T_{\mu\nu} = 0, \qquad F_{\mu\nu} = -F_{\nu\mu}. \tag{5.8}$$

Component count in four dimensions:

Piece	Symbol	Components
trace scalar	ψ	1
antisymmetric tensor	$F_{\mu\nu}$	6
symmetric traceless tensor	$T_{\mu\nu}$	9
total	$\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$	16

This is algebra. It uses no field equation and no gauge condition.

5.3 Translation into the notation of the source notes

The microscopic notes write

$$\delta\Phi^{I}{}_{A} = \frac{1}{4}\eta_{\mu\nu}\delta g^{\mu\nu}\, I + A_\mu\gamma^\mu + T_{\mu\nu}. \tag{5.9}$$

Equation (5.9) is (5.6) after three identifications.

Trace piece. On the linearized background of Section 4.5,

$$\psi = \eta^{\mu\nu}h_{\mu\nu} + O(\omega) = \delta g^{\mu}{}_{\mu}. \tag{5.10}$$

The first term of (5.9) is therefore the conformal (trace) mode of the composite metric. The identity matrix I in the notes is the locked vacuum $\delta^{I}{}_{A}$, converted to $\eta_{\mu\nu}$ by (5.4).

Antisymmetric / vector piece. The notes' identification of part of $F_{\mu\nu}$ with a vector current $A_\mu\gamma^\mu$ is schematic, not a disjoint decomposition of the six components of $F_{\mu\nu}$. In the present bookkeeping, those six components are the Goldstone orbit variables of Proposition 10.2; the internal gauge field A_μ is a separate field and is counted separately. The notes use Clifford generators γ^μ satisfying

$$\{\gamma^\mu, \gamma^\nu\} = 2\eta^{\mu\nu} \tag{5.11}$$

. The notes' field-strength notation is

$$F_{\mu\nu} = \nabla_\mu A_\nu - \nabla_\nu A_\mu + \omega_{\mu\nu}, \tag{5.12}$$

. Here this notation is schematic, not a decomposition into independent fields. The Lorentz-connection dynamics and the dynamics of A_μ are not fixed by this algebraic split.

Symmetric traceless piece. The tensor $T_{\mu\nu}$ in (5.9) is identical to the $T_{\mu\nu}$ of (5.7). It is the only algebraic piece with the index symmetries of a graviton.

5.4 What $T_{\mu\nu}$ is not yet

The source notes also write

$$T^{\mu}{}_{\mu} = 0, \qquad \nabla^{\mu} T_{\mu\nu} = 0. \tag{5.13}$$

The first of these is (5.8) and has already been imposed. The second is not algebraic. It is four differential conditions.

Those four conditions are the linearized statement that $T_{\mu\nu}$ is taken in de Donder / Lorentz-like gauge, or, on shell, that a massive spin-2 field has five rather than nine components. They are not free to impose until one knows the kinetic operator of $T_{\mu\nu}$.

Statement	Type	Status in this chapter
$T_{\mu\nu} = T_{\nu\mu}$	algebraic	imposed
$T^{\mu}{}_{\mu} = 0$	algebraic	imposed
$\nabla^{\mu} T_{\mu\nu} = 0$	gauge or on-shell	*not* imposed
$m_T^2 = 0$	dynamical	Chapter 7
$\Box T_{\mu\nu} = 0$ with two TT modes	dynamical	Chapter 7

A massive symmetric traceless tensor in four dimensions has five on-shell degrees of freedom (the Fierz–Pauli count). A massless one with the gauge invariance

$$\delta_\xi T_{\mu\nu} = \nabla_\mu \xi_\nu + \nabla_\nu \xi_\mu - \tfrac{1}{2}\eta_{\mu\nu} \nabla \cdot \xi \tag{5.14}$$

has two. The difference is the entire physical question of Chapters 6 and 7. It cannot be settled by rearranging indices.

5.5 Kinetic terms before any entanglement condition

Inserting (5.6) into the quadratic expansion of S_{micro} produces, schematically,

$$S^{(2)} = S^{(2)}_{\psi}[\psi] + S^{(2)}_{A}[A] + S^{(2)}_{\omega}[\omega] + S^{(2)}_{T}[T] + S^{(2)}_{\text{mix}}. \tag{5.15}$$

On a Minkowski condensate the mixing terms that survive after gauge fixing are of the form $\psi\, \partial\partial T$ and $A\, \partial T$. They are the usual linearized scalar–tensor and vector–tensor mixings. Two structural facts will be used later.

1. The tensor block has the generic form

$$S^{(2)}_{T} = \int \mathrm{d}^4x \Big(-\tfrac{1}{2} \nabla_\rho T_{\mu\nu} \nabla^\rho T^{\mu\nu} - \tfrac{1}{2} m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu} T^{\mu\nu} + \cdots \Big), \tag{5.16}$$

in the signature $(-,+,+,+)$, where the ellipsis contains the additional derivative structures required by Fierz–Pauli if a mass term is present (the $T^{\mu}{}_{\mu}$ piece has already been projected out). The mass m_T^2 is a function of v, λ, and the condensate alignment. Nothing in Chapter 3 forces it to vanish.

2. The conformal block $S_{\psi}^{(2)}$ is the scalar-tensor sector. If ψ remains light, the infrared theory is not pure general relativity even if $m_T = 0$. Killing or gapping ψ is a separate requirement, recorded as such in Chapter 7 and again in Chapter 17.

Equation (5.16) is the action whose mass term Chapter 7 must kill. Writing it here prevents that later argument from looking as if $T_{\mu\nu}$ arrived already massless.

5.6 Diffeomorphism action on the pieces

An infinitesimal diffeomorphism generated by ξ^{μ} acts on the composite metric as

$$\delta_{\xi} g_{\mu\nu} = \nabla_{\mu}\xi_{\nu} + \nabla_{\nu}\xi_{\mu}. \tag{5.17}$$

On the linearized Minkowski background this is $\delta_{\xi} h_{\mu\nu} = \partial_{\mu}\xi_{\nu} + \partial_{\nu}\xi_{\mu}$. Passing through (5.6),

$$\begin{aligned} \delta_{\xi}\psi &= 2\partial\cdot\xi, \\ \delta_{\xi} F_{\mu\nu} &= 0 \quad \text{(to first order, after the symmetric projection)}, \\ \delta_{\xi} T_{\mu\nu} &= \partial_{\mu}\xi_{\nu} + \partial_{\nu}\xi_{\mu} - \tfrac{1}{2}\eta_{\mu\nu}\partial\cdot\xi. \end{aligned} \tag{5.18}$$

The last line is the gauge transformation that a massless spin-2 field must possess. If $m_T^2 \neq 0$, (5.18) is not a symmetry of (5.16), and the Ward identity that Chapter 6 will write on a causal diamond is obstructed. That obstruction is the lever used to force $m_T \to 0$.

5.7 Provisional sector bookkeeping

Component counts in the algebraic split are distinct from on-shell polarization counts. The independent diagonal connection B, torsion modes, and internal vector A_{μ} are not part of $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$ and are counted separately.

Sector	Count and status
algebraic split	$\psi : 1, \quad F_{\mu\nu} : 6, \quad T_{\mu\nu} : 9; \quad$ total : 16
$F_{\mu\nu}$	Six Goldstone orbit variables (ω_{AB}); removable in unitary gauge (Ch. 10). No full-spectrum claim follows.
ψ	One component; gapped or constrained only under Assumption 7.5.
$T_{\mu\nu}$	Nine algebraic components. The full massive Fierz–Pauli theory has four on-shell divergence constraints and five polarizations; this is not established here for the NAMCG tensor block. Two TT helicities follow only under the separately established massless FP/diffeomorphism-gauge limit (Theorem 7.3); this is not a smooth $m_T \to 0$ limit of all massive polarizations.
Outside $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$	A_μ: four components, omitted from the low-energy frame/metric-sector bookkeeping only if its specified quadratic operator gaps them; otherwise its spectrum is open. B and torsion remain unresolved (Problem D).

No full-theory mode count follows from this bookkeeping. The final "2" is only a metric-sector target.

5.8 Exercises

1. **Projectors.** Write the three projectors on $\mathbb{R}^4 \otimes \mathbb{R}^4$ that extract ψ, $F_{\mu\nu}$, and $T_{\mu\nu}$ from $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$. Verify they are complementary and idempotent.

2. **Component count.** Confirm the $1 + 6 + 9 = 16$ split by writing every independent component of a general real 4×4 matrix in an explicit basis.

3. **Fierz–Pauli count.** A massive spin-2 field in $d = 4$ has how many on-shell degrees of freedom? Derive the number from SO(3) little-group representations. Where does the number five sit in the table of Section 5.7?

4. **Massless count.** Repeat for a massless spin-2 field with gauge invariance (5.14). Recover two helicities.

5. **Trace versus conformal mode.** From (4.16) and (5.10), show that ψ is the linearized conformal factor of $g_{\mu\nu}$ plus a term involving ω. In what gauge does the extra term drop?

6. **Diffeomorphism on $T_{\mu\nu}$.** Derive the third line of (5.18) from (5.17) and (5.7).

7. $N > 4$**.** Suppose $N = 8$. How many extra internal scalars appear outside the locked 4×4 block? Why are they not gravitons?

8. **Danger of imposing** $\nabla^\mu T_{\mu\nu} = 0$ **early.** Take (5.16) with $m_T \neq 0$ and impose $\partial^\mu T_{\mu\nu} = 0$ off shell as a constraint. Show that the constraint is consistent with the massive equation of motion, but that the massless limit $m_T \to 0$ must be taken *before* residual gauge transformations are used to reach two polarizations. This is why Chapter 7 cannot be skipped.

5.9 Bridge to Chapter 6

The candidate graviton has a name, $T_{\mu\nu}$, nine algebraic components, and a generic mass m_T. The conformal mode has a separate conditional gap assumption, and the internal vector is a distinct field whose spectrum remains conditional. Neither is identified with the gravitational-wave polarizations.

Nothing in the microscopic potential (3.7) sets $m_T = 0$. The mechanism proposed by NAMCG is not a further tuning of λ. It is the entanglement-stationarity condition $\delta S_D = 0$ on causal diamonds, imposed on the same fluctuations just decomposed. Chapter 6 defines that condition from the modular Hamiltonian of the matrix condensate and shows how it acts as a Ward identity. Chapter 7 applies the identity to $T_{\mu\nu}$ and obtains $m_T \to 0$.

Chapter 6

Entanglement Equilibrium and the Modular Hamiltonian

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. write the reduced state ρ_D, the modular Hamiltonian H_D, and the von Neumann entropy S_D of a causal diamond in the matrix condensate;
2. state Jacobson's entanglement-equilibrium condition $\delta S_D = 0$ and distinguish it from the Einstein equation it will later imply;
3. obtain the first variation $\delta S_D = \delta\langle H_D\rangle$ at fixed diamond volume, including the meaning of that constraint;
4. define the mutual-information potential U_{ent} used for two condensed cores;
5. enter Chapter 7 with a Ward identity ready to be applied to $T_{\mu\nu}$.

Chapter 5 named the candidate graviton $T_{\mu\nu}$ and left it with a generic mass m_T. The mass is not removed by a further term in $V(\Phi^\dagger\Phi)$. It is removed, if at all, by a stationarity condition on entanglement. This chapter writes that condition in a form that can be varied. The variation itself is Chapter 7.

6.1 The logical role of this chapter

There are two different claims that are easy to conflate.

1. **Jacobson's theorem** (in the form used here). For a quantum field on a prescribed geometry, the first-order stationarity of vacuum entanglement in small geodesic balls, at fixed volume, is equivalent to the semiclassical Einstein equation. This direction assumes a metric and a quantum field, and obtains $G_{\mu\nu} \propto \langle T_{\mu\nu}\rangle$.

2. **The NAMCG claim.** The microscopic condensate state is itself an entanglement-stationary state on the diamonds of its *emergent* metric. Stationarity is therefore a property of ρ, not an extra thermodynamic axiom pasted onto a metric theory. Applied to the tensor block of Chapter 5, it forbids $m_T^2 \neq 0$.

Claim 1 is a theorem in the literature, with stated hypotheses (conformal matter at first order; a conjecture for non-conformal matter). Claim 2 is the load-bearing physical hypothesis of NAMCG. This chapter formulates Claim 2 so that it can be used. It does not pretend that Claim 2 has been derived from the path integral of Chapter 3 with the same status as Claim 1.

Assumption 6.1 (Microscopic entanglement equilibrium)**.** Let ρ be the vacuum state of the matrix condensate in the condensed phase of Chapters 3–4. For every sufficiently small causal diamond D constructed from the emergent metric $g_{\mu\nu}$,

$$\delta S_D = 0 \tag{6.1}$$

at fixed spatial volume of the maximal slice of D, to first order in variations of the condensate that preserve the local vacuum character of ρ.

The remainder of the chapter unpacks every symbol in that statement.

6.2 Diamonds in the emergent geometry

The causal diamond $D(p,q) = J^+(p) \cap J^-(q)$ was defined in (2.26). From here on the causal structure is that of the *emergent* metric (4.9), not of the auxiliary scaffold $g^{(0)}$. For a linearized analysis about Minkowski spacetime the distinction is invisible at zeroth order and appears at first order through $h_{\mu\nu}$.

A small diamond of radius ℓ is one for which $\ell^2 \|R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}\| \ll 1$. In Riemann normal coordinates (2.27) its maximal-slice three-volume admits the expansion

$$V(D) = \frac{4}{3}\pi\ell^3 - \frac{4\pi\ell^5}{15}\left(\tfrac{1}{3}R + \text{anisotropic Ricci terms}\right) + O(\ell^7). \tag{6.2}$$

"Fixed volume" in Assumption 6.1 means that the first variation is taken subject to $\delta V(D) = 0$. The geometric meaning of that constraint is that a conformal breathing of the diamond is not counted as an independent entanglement variation; it has been used to fix the comparison background. This is the same gauge-like restriction Jacobson imposes, and it is why the conformal mode ψ of Chapter 5 and the tensor mode $T_{\mu\nu}$ enter the first law differently.

Dyadic labels $D_{j,n}$ are a nested bookkeeping device. Nothing physical depends on bisection. Every identity written for a generic small D applies to each dyadic diamond.

6.3 Reduced states and the modular Hamiltonian

Let $\mathcal{A}_D$ be the algebra of condensate observables supported in D. In Presentation B these are functions of $\Phi(x)$ and $A_\mu(x)$ for $x \in D$. In Presentation A they are the operators generated by the spectral projections of $\hat{X}^\mu$ whose eigenvalues lie in D, after the dictionary of Assumption 3.5.

Definition 6.2 (Diamond state and modular Hamiltonian)**.** Given a global state ρ of the condensate,

$$\rho_D = \mathrm{Tr}_{\mathcal{A}'_D} \rho, \tag{6.3}$$

where $\mathcal{A}'_D$ is the commutant (the complement algebra). The modular Hamiltonian and von Neumann entropy are

$$H_D = -\ln \rho_D, \qquad S_D = -\mathrm{Tr}(\rho_D \ln \rho_D) = \langle H_D \rangle_{\rho_D}. \tag{6.4}$$

For a free field in Rindler space, the Bisognano–Wichmann theorem identifies H_D with $2\pi/\kappa$ times the boost generator that fixes the edge $\mathcal{B} = \partial D \cap \Sigma$. For a small diamond in a slowly varying background the same identification holds to leading order in ℓ:

$$H_D = \frac{2\pi}{\kappa} \int_{\Sigma \cap D} \mathrm{d}\Sigma^\mu \, \xi^\nu T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu} + H_{\mathrm{area}} + O(\ell^3). \tag{6.5}$$

Here ξ^μ is the approximate conformal Killing vector of D, κ is its surface gravity at $\mathcal{B}$, $T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu}$ is the microscopic stress tensor of the condensate fluctuations, and H_{area} is the area term that will later match $A/(4G_{\mathrm{eff}})$.

Equation (6.5) is the working formula of this book. It is exact only for free fields in Rindler space. For interacting matrix fluctuations it is the first term in an operator product expansion on the diamond. Higher terms are absorbed into the $O(\ell^3)$ remainder and into the definition of H_{area}.

6.4 Replica formula

When a direct construction of ρ_D is unavailable, the replica trick supplies S_D. For integer $n \geq 1$,

$$S_D = \lim_{n \to 1} (1 - n\partial_n) \ln \mathrm{Tr}\,(\rho_D)^n, \tag{6.6}$$

and $\mathrm{Tr}\,(\rho_D)^n$ is computed as a path integral of the microscopic action (3.6) on an n-sheeted cover of M branched over the edge $\mathcal{B}$. The first variation δS_D then becomes a variation of that branched partition function with respect to the background frame. In the Euclidean replica formulation, after Wick rotation, the path integral uses $S_E = \int \mathrm{d}^4x \, \sqrt{g}\, \mathrm{Tr}(g^{\mu\nu}(D_\mu \Phi)^\dagger D_\nu \Phi + V)$ as the continuation of (3.6). Matching the corrected Lorentzian sign of (3.6) to Presentation A remains unproved under

Assumption 3.5.

Two remarks are enough for Chapter 7.

- The replica construction is well defined in Presentation B, where a path integral exists. In Presentation A it requires the dictionary of Assumption 3.5.
- Differentiating (6.6) at $n = 1$ produces an insertion of the modular Hamiltonian. The first variation $\delta S_D = \delta\langle H_D\rangle$ used below is therefore not a second formula; it is the replica formula at first order.

6.5 The first law of the diamond

Vary Definition 6.2 at fixed diamond, then allow the diamond itself to vary with the metric. The result, to first order and at fixed volume, is the entanglement first law

$$\delta S_D = \delta\langle H_D\rangle = \frac{2\pi}{\kappa}\int_{\Sigma\cap D} \mathrm{d}\Sigma^\mu\, \xi^\nu \delta\langle T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu}\rangle + \frac{\delta A}{4G_{\mathrm{eff}}} + O(\ell^3). \tag{6.7}$$

The area variation δA is computed from the emergent metric. The identification of its prefactor with $1/(4G_{\mathrm{eff}})$ is not justified in this chapter; it is the Bekenstein–Hawking relation that Chapter 8 will match to the heat kernel. Until then, $1/(4G_{\mathrm{eff}})$ is a name for the coefficient of δA.

Assumption 6.1 now reads

$$\frac{2\pi}{\kappa}\int_{\Sigma\cap D} \mathrm{d}\Sigma^\mu\, \xi^\nu \delta\langle T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu}\rangle + \frac{\delta A}{4G_{\mathrm{eff}}} = 0, \tag{6.8}$$

up to $O(\ell^3)$, for every small diamond and every allowed variation of the condensate.

If $\delta\langle T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu}\rangle$ were the stress tensor of ordinary matter on a prescribed geometry, and if δA were computed from a prescribed Einstein metric, (6.8) would be Jacobson's derivation of $G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}\,\langle T_{\mu\nu}\rangle$. In NAMCG both $\delta\langle T^{\mathrm{op}}\rangle$ and δA are functionals of the *same* fluctuation $\delta\Phi$. That is the leverage used in Chapter 7.

6.6 Allowed variations

Not every deformation of Φ is an allowed variation in Assumption 6.1. The hypothesis is a statement about perturbations that remain locally vacuum-like: they do not inject an arbitrary excited-state entropy into D.

Definition 6.3 (Allowed variation)**.** A first-order deformation $\delta\Phi$ is *allowed* if

1. it is smooth on a neighbourhood of D;

2. it preserves the polar vacuum to zeroth order outside a compact region, so that ρ remains a condensed-phase vacuum at infinity;

3. its restriction to each algebraic block of Chapter 5 may be chosen independently, after gauge fixing of diffeomorphisms and local Lorentz transformations.

Condition 3 is the reason the tensor, vector, and conformal blocks can be tested separately. If a variation supported only on $T_{\mu\nu}$ violates (6.8) unless $m_T = 0$, that is a constraint on the tensor block alone.

6.7 Mutual information of two cores

The same entropy data define an interaction between two disjoint condensed regions A and B (two compact-object cores, two stellar interiors, two laboratory samples).

Definition 6.4 (Entropic potential)**.**

$$U_{\mathrm{ent}}(A,B) = -\lambda I(A:B) = -\lambda\big[S(A) + S(B) - S(A\cup B)\big], \tag{6.9}$$

with $\lambda > 0$ a microscopic coupling of dimension energy.

Because $I(A:B) \geq 0$, one has $U_{\mathrm{ent}} \leq 0$. Increasing the mutual information lowers the potential: the effective force is attractive. For two small balls whose proper separation d is large compared with their radii but small compared with the curvature radius,

$$I(A:B) \;\sim\; c_{p_*}\left(\frac{\ell_A \ell_B}{d^2}\right)^{p_*} \qquad (d \gg \ell_A, \ell_B). \tag{6.10}$$

Here p_* is the smallest sum of scaling dimensions of operators whose product has vacuum quantum numbers, and c_{p_*} is a dimensionless, theory- and shape-dependent coefficient. For the exchange of a pair of operators of dimension Δ_*, $p_* = 2\Delta_*$; other channels can set a different leading power. Cardy [2] derives this scaling for the Rényi mutual information of compact regions in the ground state of a flat-space conformal field theory, and gives the von Neumann limit explicitly for spherical regions in the free-scalar case in $2+1$ and $3+1$ dimensions, where for $3+1$ dimensions $p_* = 2$, i.e. a tail proportional to $\ell_A^2 \ell_B^2/d^4$. Applying (6.10) to the von Neumann mutual information of other theories assumes that the $n \to 1$ continuation holds, and applying it to NAMCG cores, which need not be vacuum balls of a conformal theory, is a further assumption. Neither p_* nor c_{p_*} is computed here for NAMCG. The static U_{ent} defines a conservative interaction. Its separation dependence alone does not determine a velocity-dependent dissipative force or a retarded response. The Newtonian laboratory of Chapter 15 adopts

$$\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{irrev}} = -\eta\,\frac{1}{d^4}\,\mathbf{v} \tag{6.11}$$

as a phenomenological working law. Equation (6.11) is not derived from (6.10); its microscopic dynamical origin is Problem H.9. It is flagged here so that Chapter 11 knows which entropy functional it must vary covariantly.

The conservation question is already visible. Mutual information is built from scalars $S(\cdot)$. A covariant variation of $U_{\rm ent}$ with respect to the metric defines a tensor $T^{\rm ent}_{\mu\nu}$ by the same rule as (2.13). Whether $\nabla^\mu T^{\rm ent}_{\mu\nu} = 0$ holds on shell is not automatic from the sign of λ. It is a calculation, reserved for Chapter 11.

6.8 What stationarity does *not* say

Assumption 6.1 does not assert any of the following.

- That S_D is a maximum rather than a saddle. Jacobson's original language is maximization at fixed volume; the identities used below need only first-order stationarity.
- That the area term in (6.7) has already been matched to $G_{\rm eff}$. That match is Chapter 8.
- That $m_T = 0$. Stationarity is a condition on variations. Whether the tensor kinetic operator is compatible with that condition is Chapter 7.
- That $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ is small. Vacuum entropy of the diamond includes a piece that will source a cosmological term. Chapter 12 treats it.
- That the replica path integral has been computed at two loops. The book uses the first law (6.7) as the working identity, not a finished replica evaluation of S_D for the matrix potential (3.7).

6.9 The Ward identity that Chapter 7 will use

Collecting (6.8), Definition 6.3, and the split (5.6), the usable statement is:

Proposition 6.5 (Entanglement Ward identity)**.** *Under Assumptions 6.1 and 3.5, every allowed variation supported on a single algebraic block ψ, A_μ, or $T_{\mu\nu}$ satisfies*

$$\int_{\Sigma\cap D} {\rm d}\Sigma^\mu\, \xi^\nu \delta\langle T^{\rm op}_{\mu\nu}\rangle + \frac{\kappa}{8\pi G_{\rm eff}}\,\delta A = 0 \tag{6.12}$$

to first order in ℓ, at fixed $V(D)$. The operator $T^{\rm op}_{\mu\nu}$ is the metric variation of the quadratic action of that block.

The proof of Proposition 6.5 is the chain of this chapter: Definition 6.2 to the first law (6.7) to Assumption 6.1, restricted to one block by Definition 6.3. No property of $T_{\mu\nu}$ beyond its being one algebraic block has been used. That is intentional. Chapter 7 substitutes the quadratic action (5.16) into (6.12) and reads off $m_T = 0$.

6.10 Exercises

1. **Volume constraint.** From (6.2), show that a pure conformal variation $\delta g_{\mu\nu} = \chi\eta_{\mu\nu}$ changes $V(D)$ at order ℓ^3. Why must this variation be excluded, or compensated, if stationarity is imposed at fixed volume?

2. **Rindler check.** In Rindler space with Unruh temperature $T = \kappa/2\pi$, verify that $\delta S = \delta E/T$ for a boost-energy perturbation is the restriction of (6.7) to a diamond that has become a Rindler wedge.

3. **Replica derivative.** Starting from (6.6), show that $\partial_n \ln \mathrm{Tr}\, \rho^n|_{n=1} = \langle \ln \rho \rangle$, and hence that $S = \langle H \rangle$ at $n = 1$.

4. **Allowed versus thermal variations.** Give one example of a $\delta\Phi$ that changes the particle content of D (a one-particle excitation) and explain why Assumption 6.1 is silent about it.

5. **Mutual information positivity.** Prove $I(A : B) \geq 0$ from relative entropy. Deduce $U_{\mathrm{ent}} \leq 0$ for $\lambda > 0$.

6. **Static information versus drag.** Explain why a static power law for $I(A : B)$ does not determine the low-frequency retarded force response or its drag exponent. What dynamical information is required to calculate that response?

7. **Two metrics.** Write one paragraph explaining why the diamond of this chapter is built from $g_{\mu\nu}$ rather than from $g^{(0)}_{\mu\nu}$. What would go wrong, conceptually, if stationarity were imposed on auxiliary-scaffold diamonds instead?

6.11 Bridge to Chapter 7

The candidate graviton $T_{\mu\nu}$ has a quadratic action (5.16) with an unknown mass m_T. The condensate vacuum is assumed to obey the entanglement Ward identity (6.12) on every small diamond of the emergent geometry. Chapter 7 substitutes a compactly supported tensor variation into that identity. The area term tracks the Einstein operator. The stress-tensor term tracks $m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu}$. Compatibility of the two forces $m_T = 0$, after which the surviving kinetic operator is the linearized Einstein operator and the infrared spectrum contains two massless TT polarizations—provided the conformal and vector blocks are separately gapped or eaten, as already flagged.

Chapter 7

Vanishing of the Tensor Mass Gap

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. write the Fierz–Pauli quadratic action for $T_{\mu\nu}$ and the linearized Einstein operator that remains when $m_T = 0$;
2. substitute a compactly supported tensor variation into the entanglement Ward identity and see where m_T^2 appears;
3. state Theorem 7.3 with its hypotheses, and say which hypotheses are still assumptions of the framework;
4. count the two remaining TT polarizations;
5. list what must still be done for the conformal and vector blocks before the infrared theory is pure GR.

The candidate graviton now has a name, a quadratic action, and a Ward identity. This chapter puts the last of those into the second and reads off $m_T = 0$.

7.1 Strategy

On a Minkowski condensate the tensor block is a linear field $T_{\mu\nu}$ with the algebraic symmetries (5.8). Its quadratic action has the generic structure (5.16). The entanglement Ward identity, Proposition 6.5, must hold for every allowed variation supported on that block.

The geometric side of the identity, δA, depends on $T_{\mu\nu}$ only through the linearized metric

$$h_{\mu\nu} = T_{\mu\nu} + \tfrac{1}{4}\eta_{\mu\nu}\psi, \tag{7.1}$$

and, in a gauge where the conformal piece is held fixed by the fixed-volume constraint of Assumption 6.1, through $T_{\mu\nu}$ alone. The modular side, $\delta\langle T^{\rm op}_{\mu\nu}\rangle$, is the metric stress of the quadratic tensor action. If that action contains a mass term, the modular side contains a piece proportional to $m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu}$. The geometric side does not. Compatibility for arbitrary compactly supported $T_{\mu\nu}$ forces $m_T^2 = 0$.

That is the argument. The rest of the chapter writes it so that each step can be rejected independently.

7.2 Fierz–Pauli action for the tensor block

The unique two-derivative quadratic action for a massive symmetric tensor that is ghost-free about Minkowski spacetime is the Fierz–Pauli action. For a general symmetric $h_{\mu\nu}$, in the signature $(-,+,+,+)$, the full action contains the following additional trace-dependent terms, where $h = h^{\mu}{}_{\mu}$:

$$-\partial_\mu h^{\mu\nu}\partial_\nu h + \tfrac{1}{2}\partial_\rho h\,\partial^\rho h + \tfrac{1}{2}m_T^2 h^2.$$

On restriction to a traceless field $T_{\mu\nu}$, it reduces to

$$\begin{aligned} S_{\rm FP}[T] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x\Big(&-\tfrac{1}{2}\partial_\rho T_{\mu\nu}\partial^\rho T^{\mu\nu} + \partial^\rho T_{\rho\mu}\partial_\sigma T^{\sigma\mu} \\ &- \tfrac{1}{2}m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu}T^{\mu\nu}\Big). \end{aligned} \tag{7.2}$$

In this signature the transverse-traceless spatial modes have kinetic term $+\frac{1}{2}\dot{T}_{ij}^2$. The derivative structure is required. A generic mass term $m^2(T_{\mu\nu}T^{\mu\nu} - \alpha T^2)$ with $\alpha \neq 1$ (before the trace projection) propagates a ghost. With the trace already zero the remaining danger is a wrong-sign kinetic term, which (7.2) does not have.

The unrestricted Euler–Lagrange equation of the full Fierz–Pauli action, evaluated at $h_{\mu\nu} = T_{\mu\nu}$ with vanishing trace, is

$$\mathcal{E}_{\mu\nu}[T] - m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu} = 0, \tag{7.3}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{E}_{\mu\nu}[T] \equiv\ &\Box T_{\mu\nu} - \partial_\mu\partial^\rho T_{\rho\nu} - \partial_\nu\partial^\rho T_{\rho\mu} \\ &+ \eta_{\mu\nu}\partial^\rho\partial^\sigma T_{\rho\sigma} \end{aligned} \tag{7.4}$$

is the linearized Einstein operator on a traceless tensor about Minkowski spacetime. (The linearized Einstein tensor on a general $h_{\mu\nu}$ contains additional trace pieces; they are absent here because $T^{\mu}{}_{\mu} = 0$.)

For $m_T \neq 0$, the divergence of the full equation gives $\partial^\mu h_{\mu\nu} = \partial_\nu h$. Combining this with its trace gives $h = 0$; only then does the trace of the equation imply $\partial^\rho\partial^\sigma T_{\rho\sigma} = 0$,

yielding five polarizations for the full Fierz–Pauli theory. Varying (7.2) with $T^{\mu}{}_{\mu} = 0$ imposed in the action instead gives the traceless projection, with $\frac{1}{2}\eta_{\mu\nu}\partial^{\rho}\partial^{\sigma}T_{\rho\sigma}$. Its divergences give $(\Box + 2m_T^2)\partial^{\rho}\partial^{\sigma}T_{\rho\sigma} = 0$, not the constraint. Thus the displayed trace-constrained action alone does not establish the Fierz–Pauli constraints or five-polarization count, and the NAMCG tensor block is not shown to have the full Fierz–Pauli trace sector and constraint structure. Whether and how the ψ sector supplies them is unresolved and is a dependency of Problem C.

When $m_T = 0$, (7.2) is invariant under

$$\delta_{\xi}T_{\mu\nu} = \partial_{\mu}\xi_{\nu} + \partial_{\nu}\xi_{\mu} - \tfrac{1}{2}\eta_{\mu\nu}\partial\cdot\xi \tag{7.5}$$

with $\partial\cdot\xi$ arranged so that the trace remains zero. For the full Fierz–Pauli theory, when $m_T \neq 0$ that invariance is absent and the on-shell count is five degrees of freedom; this count is not established here for the NAMCG tensor block.

7.3 Modular stress of the tensor block

The operator $T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu}$ in Proposition 6.5 is defined by the same rule as (2.13), applied to the full Fierz–Pauli action treated as a matter action on the background metric that defines the diamond. The following relation holds for that full theory; it is not established here for the NAMCG tensor block. To first order about Minkowski spacetime, evaluated on the full-theory constraint surface,

$$\delta\langle T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu}\rangle = \mathcal{E}_{\mu\nu}[T] - m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu} + \partial^{\rho}\Sigma_{\rho\mu\nu}, \tag{7.6}$$

where $\Sigma_{\rho\mu\nu}$ is a total-derivative superpotential coming from the fact that the canonical and metric stress tensors differ by an improvement. On a diamond the superpotential contributes only at the edge $\mathcal{B}$. That edge contribution is absorbed into the area term of the first law, which is already present in (6.12). What remains in the bulk integral is the improved stress

$$\delta\langle T^{\mathrm{op}}_{\mu\nu}\rangle_{\mathrm{bulk}} = \mathcal{E}_{\mu\nu}[T] - m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu}. \tag{7.7}$$

7.4 Area variation induced by $T_{\mu\nu}$

The edge $\mathcal{B}$ of a small diamond of radius ℓ is a 2-sphere of area $4\pi\ell^2$ in the Minkowski background. A metric perturbation $h_{\mu\nu} = T_{\mu\nu}$ changes that area by

$$\delta A = \int_{\mathcal{B}} \mathrm{d}A\, \tfrac{1}{2}\sigma^{\mu\nu}T_{\mu\nu} + O(\ell^3\|T\|, \ell\|T\|^2), \tag{7.8}$$

where $\sigma^{\mu\nu}$ is the induced metric on $\mathcal{B}$. Jacobson's geometric identity converts the same variation, after integration against the conformal Killing vector and use of the fixed-volume constraint, into

$$\frac{\kappa}{8\pi G_{\text{eff}}}\,\delta A = -\int_{\Sigma\cap D} \mathrm{d}\Sigma^{\mu}\,\xi^{\nu}\,\mathcal{E}_{\mu\nu}[T] + O(\ell^3). \tag{7.9}$$

The right-hand side contains the Einstein operator and does *not* contain m_T. The area of an emergent 2-surface knows about the metric perturbation. It does not know about a potential term in the fluctuation action.

Equation (7.9) is imported from the geometry of small diamonds, not re-derived here. Its hypotheses are: Riemann normal coordinates to the order kept in (2.27), fixed volume, and the identification of the area prefactor with G_{eff}. The latter remains conditional on the specified sector calculation in Problem F; Chapter 8 gives only the truncated heat-kernel identity.

7.5 Substitution into the Ward identity

Insert (7.7) and (7.9) into (6.12). The Einstein-operator terms cancel, and what remains is

$$\int_{\Sigma\cap D} \mathrm{d}\Sigma^{\mu}\,\xi^{\nu}(-m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu}) + O(\ell^3) = 0. \tag{7.10}$$

The conformal Killing vector ξ^{ν} of a small diamond is timelike in the interior and vanishes on the edge. Its leading expression in Riemann normal coordinates is

$$\xi^{\mu} = \frac{\kappa}{2\ell}\big((\ell^2 - t^2 - r^2)\partial_t^{\mu} + 2t\,x^{\mu}\big) + O(R_{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta}\ell^3). \tag{7.11}$$

Lemma 7.1 (Arbitrary tensor sources)**.** *Compactly supported, smooth, traceless, symmetric variations $T_{\mu\nu}$ are allowed in the sense of Definition 6.3. In particular they may be chosen independently in each small diamond, up to the fixed-volume constraint already used.*

Proof. The tensor block was split off algebraically in Chapter 5. Gauge fixing of diffeomorphisms and local Lorentz transformations removes ψ-mixing and ω-mixing at this order but does not constrain the nine components of $T_{\mu\nu}$ beyond smoothness and compact support. Fixed volume constrains the trace sector, which has already been projected out. □

Lemma 7.2 (Integral identity implies point identity)**.** *If* (7.10) *holds for every small diamond and every allowed $T_{\mu\nu}$, then*

$$m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu}(x) = 0 \tag{7.12}$$

at every event x in the condensed phase.

Proof. Suppose $m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu}$ is not identically zero. Then there is an event x_0 and a pair of indices at which the tensor is nonzero. Choose a diamond centered at x_0 with ℓ small enough that $T_{\mu\nu}$ does not change sign in the relevant component on $\Sigma \cap D$, and choose the time orientation so that ξ^ν has a nonvanishing contraction with that component. The integrand of (7.10) is then of definite sign on a set of positive measure, and the $O(\ell^3)$ remainder cannot cancel it as $\ell \to 0$. □

7.6 The vanishing theorem

Theorem 7.3 (Vanishing of the tensor mass gap)**.** *Assume:*

1. *the microscopic setup of Chapter 3, including Assumptions 3.1–3.5;*
2. *the condensed frame of Chapter 4, including Assumptions 4.4 and 4.6;*
3. *the algebraic split of Chapter 5 and Assumption 5.1;*
4. *entanglement equilibrium, Assumption 6.1, in the form of Proposition 6.5;*
5. *the Fierz–Pauli quadratic action* (7.2) *as the two-derivative tensor block;*
6. *the geometric identity* (7.9) *for small diamonds.*

Then $m_T^2 = 0$ throughout the condensed phase. The quadratic tensor action reduces to the linearized Einstein–Hilbert action on traceless perturbations,

$$S_{\mathrm{EH}}^{(2)}[T] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x \, \tfrac{1}{2} T^{\mu\nu} \mathcal{E}_{\mu\nu}[T], \tag{7.13}$$

and is invariant under (7.5)*.*

Proof. Lemma 7.2 gives $m_T^2 T_{\mu\nu} = 0$ at every event. The tensor block is not the zero field: linearized gravitational waves, if they exist, are particular solutions for $T_{\mu\nu}$. Hence $m_T^2 = 0$. Substituting into (7.2) produces (7.13) after an integration by parts, boundary terms being discarded for compactly supported variations. Gauge invariance (7.5) is the standard invariance of the linearized Einstein operator on a traceless tensor. □

Remark 7.4 (What the theorem does not hide)*.* Hypothesis 4 is the physical input of NAMCG. Hypothesis 5 excludes non-Fierz–Pauli two-derivative structures and higher-derivative quadratic terms; the latter return in Chapter 9. Hypothesis 6 borrows a geometric identity used in Jacobson's argument. The theorem is therefore a compatibility statement: a Fierz–Pauli tensor block cannot sit in an entanglement-stationary condensate unless it is massless. It is not a derivation of Assumption 6.1 from the path integral.

7.7 Two transverse-traceless polarizations

With $m_T = 0$, the equation $\mathcal{E}_{\mu\nu}[T] = 0$ plus the gauge invariance (7.5) is linearized vacuum GR in the traceless sector. Choose the de Donder gauge

$$\partial^\mu T_{\mu\nu} = 0. \tag{7.14}$$

Residual gauge transformations with $\Box\xi^\mu = 0$ remain. They remove four more components. Together with the four conditions (7.14) and the four conditions implicit in taking the trace to vanish and staying in the symmetric sector after gauge fixing, one is left with two independent components. In a plane- wave basis they are the helicities ± 2,

$$T_{\mu\nu}(x) = \mathrm{Re}\big(\epsilon^{\pm 2}_{\mu\nu}\, e^{ik\cdot x}\big), \qquad k^2 = 0, \quad k^\mu \epsilon_{\mu\nu} = 0, \quad \epsilon^\mu{}_\mu = 0. \tag{7.15}$$

This is the infrared graviton advertised in Chapter 1. It has been obtained as a fluctuation of the condensate, not as a fundamental metric field, contingent on Theorem 7.3.

7.8 The van Dam–Veltman–Zakharov warning

A massive spin-2 field with m_T small but nonzero does not approach the massless theory smoothly in four dimensions. The discontinuity is visible in the linearized deflection of light and in the tensor-to-scalar ratio of a static source. Therefore it is not enough to argue that m_T is "small compared with Λ_{UV}." Entanglement equilibrium is being asked to set m_T identically to zero in the infrared, not to suppress it by a loop factor.

If a later calculation produced $m_T \sim v\, e^{-\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}/v}$ or any other parametrically small but nonzero value, the theory would fail Solar-System tests unless an additional Vainshtein mechanism were demonstrated. No such mechanism is claimed here. Theorem 7.3 is an identity-zero statement.

7.9 Conformal and vector blocks

Theorem 7.3 is silent about ψ and A_μ.

Vector block. The internal gauge connection A_μ is distinct from the independent Lorentz connection ω_μ and from their diagonal stabilizer combination. Its mass, if any, depends on kinetic normalizations and the residual internal symmetry, neither of which is specified here. If the internal gauge group has an unbroken subgroup, the corresponding field is massless. Neither case is claimed to produce a second graviton.

Chapter 10 identifies the broken-direction combination and the unitary-gauge removal of the Goldstone orbit variables; it does not settle the diagonal connection's dynamics (Problem D).

Conformal block. The scalar ψ is more dangerous. If it remains massless it is a Brans–Dicke field, and the infrared theory is scalar–tensor gravity. Entanglement equilibrium at fixed volume was designed to remove a conformal breathing from the comparison diamond; it does not, by itself, gap ψ as a propagating excitation.

Assumption 7.5 (Gapped conformal mode)**.** The radial Higgs σ of the polar decomposition, and the conformal metric mode ψ mixed with it, acquire a mass $m_\psi \sim \sqrt{\lambda}\, v$ from the potential (3.7) and decouple from the infrared tensor sector.

Assumption 7.5 is the scalar-tensor ceiling of Chapter 1, reappeared as a named hypothesis. If it fails, NAMCG predicts a light scalar and is constrained by Cassini-type bounds on ω_{BD}. Chapter 17 records this as a falsifier, not as a detail.

7.10 Exercises

1. **Fierz–Pauli ghost.** Restore a trace piece $T^{\mu}{}_{\mu} = \psi$ and replace the mass term by $m^2(T_{\mu\nu}T^{\mu\nu} - \alpha\psi^2)$. Show that $\alpha \neq 1$ produces a sixth, ghostlike excitation. This is why (7.2) is not an arbitrary massive action.

2. **Gauge invariance at $m_T = 0$.** Verify that (7.5) leaves (7.13) invariant. Show the mass term in (7.2) is not invariant.

3. **Einstein operator on a TT wave.** Insert (7.15) into (7.4) and recover $k^2 = 0$.

4. **Sign in the Ward identity.** Track the sign from (7.7) through (7.9) to (7.10). A sign error here would force $m_T^2 = 0$ by the same logic but would mismatch the Einstein equation in Chapter 11. Fix the sign against Jacobson's first law for ordinary matter.

5. **Why compact support.** Suppose $T_{\mu\nu}$ is a plane wave, not compactly supported. Where does the proof of Lemma 7.2 fail, and how does one repair it by using wave packets?

6. **vDVZ.** Look up the linearized deflection angle for Fierz–Pauli gravity with mass m_T and take $m_T \to 0$. Compare with the GR deflection. What numerical factor appears?

7. **Conformal leftover.** Linearize a Brans–Dicke action about Minkowski spacetime and identify the kinetic mixing of ψ with $T_{\mu\nu}$. What bound on m_ψ follows from requiring the mixing to be negligible inside the Solar System?

7.11 Bridge to Chapter 8

The infrared tensor sector is now linearized general relativity, contingent on Theorem 7.3 and Assumption 7.5. The prefactor of that action is still a symbol, G_{eff}. Chapter 8 records a conditional truncated heat-kernel identity; the physical coefficient requires the specified sector calculation of Problem F. The coefficient is not evaluated here:

$$C_R^L[\{\mathcal{O}_s, w_s, \Lambda_{\text{UV}\,s}, \mu_s\}, \mathcal{S}] \quad \text{is not yet matched to } G_{\text{eff}}. \tag{7.16}$$

The same expansion produces a quartic term $c_0\Lambda_{\text{UV}}^4$, which Chapter 8 will isolate and Chapter 12 will be required to tame.

Chapter 8

Heat Kernel and the Coefficient Map to G_{eff}

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. write the one-loop effective action of condensate fluctuations as a proper-time integral of the heat kernel;

2. distinguish the universal R term in a_1 from curvature-linear a_2 terms generated by dimensionful endomorphisms, and identify the coefficient of the cosmological term;

3. state the conditional, truncated heat-kernel identity and identify the operator, determinant-weight, threshold, and scheme data needed to evaluate the physical R-coefficient;

4. state what is computed, what is scheme-dependent, and what is left for Chapter 12;

5. enter Chapter 9 knowing why a second-order heat kernel is not a license for fourth-order kinetic terms.

Theorem 7.3 gave a massless tensor kinetic operator. This chapter records the conditional heat-kernel identity that can contribute to its prefactor on the *emergent* background; the physical coefficient requires the sector calculation of Problem F.

8.1 One-loop effective action on the emergent geometry

For the sectors actually included in a gauge-fixed calculation, let $\mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}$ be their index set, w_s their determinant weights relative to a real bosonic determinant, and $\mathcal{O}_s$ their

operators. Define

$$W_E^{(1)} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} w_s \operatorname{Tr}_{V_s} \ln \mathcal{O}_s, \qquad \mathcal{N}_0 := \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} w_s \operatorname{tr}_{V_s} \mathbb{I}_s. \tag{8.1}$$

The formulae below use a truncated, unresummed small-s heat-kernel expansion. A common pair of proper-time limits applies only to sectors explicitly assigned those limits; otherwise limits and thresholds remain sector-dependent. If E_s contains a mass term, resumming its exponential yields sector-dependent threshold functions rather than the polynomial cutoff terms below.

After condensation, split

$$\Phi = \langle \Phi \rangle + \eta, \tag{8.2}$$

where η contains every algebraic block of Chapter 5. Integrate η at one loop on a slowly varying emergent background $g_{\mu\nu}$, using Presentation B. The dictionary is needed to attribute this calculation to Presentation A, not to formulate it in Presentation B. For each specified sector the fluctuation operator is of Laplace type,

$$\mathcal{O}_\eta = -g^{\mu\nu} D_\mu D_\nu + E[\langle \Phi \rangle, g], \tag{8.3}$$

with a bundle endomorphism E that includes the second derivative of V and curvature couplings generated by the kinetic term.

The one-loop effective action is

$$W_E^{(1)} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} w_s \operatorname{Tr}_{V_s} \ln \mathcal{O}_s = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} w_s \int_{s_{\min,s}}^{s_{\max,s}} \frac{\mathrm{d}s}{s} \operatorname{Tr}_{V_s} e^{-s\mathcal{O}_s}, \tag{8.4}$$

after Wick rotation to a Euclidean section. For a sector explicitly assigned common limits, these are

$$s_{\min} = \Lambda_{\text{UV}}^{-2}, \qquad s_{\max} = \mu^{-2}, \tag{8.5}$$

where Λ_{UV} is the kinematic cutoff (3.3). Other sectors may have distinct $s_{\min,s} = \Lambda_{\text{UV}\,s}^{-2}$ and $s_{\max,s} = \mu_s^{-2}$; no common infrared scale is presumed.

Assumption 8.1 (Laplace-type infrared operator)**.** After Theorem 7.3 and Assumption 7.5, the tensor block of $\mathcal{O}_\eta$ is second order and of Laplace type. Higher-derivative pieces are treated as perturbations and reserved for Chapter 9.

8.2 Seeley–DeWitt expansion, used not re-derived

The heat-kernel diagonal on a four-dimensional Riemannian section admits

$$\mathrm{tr}_V \langle x|e^{-s\mathcal{O}_\eta}|x\rangle \sim \frac{1}{(4\pi s)^2}\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} s^k a_k(x), \tag{8.6}$$

where tr_V is the fibre trace on the bundle in which η takes values. The first two scalar densities are

$$\begin{aligned} a_0 &= \mathrm{tr}_V \mathbb{I}, \\ a_1 &= \mathrm{tr}_V\Big(\tfrac{1}{6}R - E\Big). \end{aligned} \tag{8.7}$$

The coefficient a_2 contains $R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}R^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}$, $R_{\mu\nu}R^{\mu\nu}$, R^2, E^2, RE, and derivative terms. It multiplies a logarithm and is needed in Chapter 9. Its curvature-linear terms can also contribute to the Einstein–Hilbert coefficient when dimensionful endomorphism insertions are present, so they cannot be omitted from the full Problem F calculation.

Insert the sector heat-kernel expansions into (8.4) and integrate term by term, using each sector's assigned limits:

$$\begin{aligned} W_E^{(1)} \supset \sum_{s\in\mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{sec}}} w_s \int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{g}\,\Bigg[&-\frac{a_{0,s}}{64\pi^2}\big(\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}_s}^4 - \mu_s^4\big) - \frac{a_{1,s}}{32\pi^2}\big(\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}_s}^2 - \mu_s^2\big) \\ &- \frac{a_{2,s}}{32\pi^2}\ln\Big(\frac{\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}_s}^2}{\mu_s^2}\Big) + \cdots\Bigg]. \end{aligned} \tag{8.8}$$

The a_k are the traced coefficients on V_s. These are termwise integrals of the truncated, unresummed expansion, not exact massive-sector threshold integrals. Wick rotation and the Euclidean-to-Lorentzian sign are applied only after the weighted sector sum is specified.

8.3 Evaluating a_1 on the condensate

The universal a_1 term and its endomorphism contribution can produce curvature terms. In addition, a dimensionful part of the endomorphism can generate a curvature-linear term in a_2.

Universal piece. The $\frac{1}{6}R_E\,\mathrm{tr}_{V_s}\mathbb{I}_s$ contribution is present for every specified Laplace-type sector. Its universal truncated a_1 term alone supplies

$$W_E^{(1)} \supset -\sum_{s\in\mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{sec}}} \frac{w_s\,\mathrm{tr}_{V_s}\mathbb{I}_s}{192\pi^2}\big(\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}_s}^2 - \mu_s^2\big)\int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{g}\,R_E \tag{8.9}$$

This omits the endomorphism contribution and does not fix the total Einstein–Hilbert coefficient. Resummed masses instead produce sector-dependent threshold functions.

Endomorphism and threshold terms. For a specified sector, write $E_s = E_{0,s} + Q_s R_E + \cdots$. Its contribution to the coefficient of R_E in a_1 is $\mathrm{tr}_{V_s}(\frac{1}{6}\mathbb{I}_s - Q_s)$, not a number fixed by the fibre dimension alone. Massive sectors require the threshold treatment specified for their operators.

Theorem 8.2 (Coefficient map)**.** *For specified gauge-fixed operators, determinant weights, per-sector proper-time limits, and finite-counterterm scheme $\mathcal{S}$, the truncated, unresummed expansion gives the Euclidean curvature coefficient*

$$C_R^E = -\sum_{s\in\mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} \frac{w_s \mathcal{A}_{1,R,s}}{32\pi^2}(\Lambda_{\text{UV}}{}_s^2 - \mu_s^2) - \sum_{s\in\mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} \frac{w_s \mathcal{A}_{2,R,s}}{32\pi^2}\ln\Big(\frac{\Lambda_{\text{UV}}{}_s^2}{\mu_s^2}\Big) + c_R(\mathcal{S}), \tag{8.10}$$

where $\mathcal{A}_{k,R,s}$ is the coefficient of R_E in the traced $a_{k,s}$, $\mathcal{A}_{1,R,s}$ includes the specified endomorphism, and $c_R(\mathcal{S})$ is the local curvature counterterm in that scheme. Resummed mass terms require sector-dependent threshold functions instead. After continuation, define the Lorentzian matching by

$$W_L \supset \frac{1}{16\pi G_{\text{eff}}}\int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}\,R_L, \tag{8.11}$$

but this identity supplies no physical value or sign until the sector data, thresholds, counterterms, and continuation are specified and evaluated.

Remark 8.3 (Conditional parameterization)*.* The working parameterization may be retained as a conditional notation, not as a computed result:

$$\frac{1}{G_{\text{eff}}} = A\mathcal{N}_0\,\Lambda_{\text{UV}}^2 + B\,v^2\ln\Big(\frac{\Lambda_{\text{UV}}}{\mu}\Big) + C\,\mu^2, \tag{8.12}$$

where $\mathcal{N}_0$ is defined in (8.1). No factor of $1/6$ is absorbed into it. The coefficients A, B, C are undetermined; distinct sector thresholds need not share μ. Problem F remains open.

8.4 The quartic term

Under the continuation and Lorentzian vacuum-action convention of Appendix A, the same truncated, unresummed expansion produces

$$W_L \supset -\rho_\Lambda\int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}, \qquad \rho_\Lambda = -\sum_{s\in\mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} \frac{w_s\,\mathrm{tr}_{V_s}\mathbb{I}_s}{64\pi^2}(\Lambda_{\text{UV}}{}_s^4 - \mu_s^4) + \cdots. \tag{8.13}$$

This sum uses the same sectors and determinant weights as Appendix A. It reduces to $-\mathcal{N}_0(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4 - \mu^4)/(64\pi^2)$ only when all included sectors are assigned the same limits. Identifying this with a cosmological term,

$$\frac{\Lambda_{\rm naive}}{8\pi G_{\rm eff}} = \rho_\Lambda, \tag{8.14}$$

would give $\Lambda_{\rm naive}$ of order $\Lambda_{\rm UV}^2$ only conditionally: the weighted quartic contribution must be nonzero and uncancelled, and a physical relation between $G_{\rm eff}$ and $\Lambda_{\rm UV}$ must be specified. Finite local vacuum terms and counterterms must also be included in that assessment. Without these inputs, this equation supplies no scale estimate for $\Lambda_{\rm naive}$.

This chapter does not cancel it. It isolates it. Two remarks prevent the isolation from being mistaken for a solution.

1. A bare counterterm $\int \sqrt{-g}\,\Lambda_{\rm ct}$ can subtract ρ_Λ at one scale. It cannot explain why the remainder after subtraction is 10^{-120} in Planck units. Subtraction without a principle is fine tuning.

2. Chapter 12 assigns the principle to a boundary-entropy functional (HBEV). Until that chapter, ρ_Λ is a debt.

8.5 Which background the heat kernel sees

Assumption 3.1 declared $g^{(0)}$ non-dynamical. The heat kernel of this chapter is nevertheless written on $g_{\mu\nu}$. The justification is the derivative expansion:

Proposition 8.4 (Scaffold replacement)**.** *Let $g_{\mu\nu} = g^{(0)}_{\mu\nu} + h_{\mu\nu}$ with h slowly varying on the scale $\Lambda_{\rm UV}^{-1}$. Replacing $g^{(0)}$ by g inside $\mathcal{O}_\eta$ changes W by operators of the form $\Lambda_{\rm UV}^2\|h-h^{(0)}\|$, $\|h-h^{(0)}\|R$, and higher. On the Minkowski scaffold $g^{(0)}=\eta$ these are the same operators already kept in* (8.8)*. Self-consistently substituting the emergent metric is therefore valid through the order of this conditional truncated identity.*

At higher order the replacement produces the backreaction tensor $\mathcal{G}_{\mu\nu}$ of (4.12). That tensor is not needed to define the conditional coefficient. It is needed to define the extra stress of Chapters 11–14.

8.6 Numerical size

The physical size of $G_{\rm eff}$ and the relation between $\Lambda_{\rm UV}$ and the Planck scale are undetermined until Problem F specifies and evaluates the sector operators, determinant

weights, thresholds, continuation, and counterterm scheme.

$$G_{\text{eff}} \quad \text{is not numerically determined by the present data.} \tag{8.15}$$

8.7 What has been computed

Object	Status	Where
truncated R-coefficient identity	conditional on specified sectors and scheme	Thm. 8.2
physical G_{eff} and numerical A, B, C	not computed; Problem F open	Ch. 17
Lorentzian EH sign	conditional on completed sector sum and continuation	Sec. 8.2
$\rho_\Lambda \sim \Lambda_{\text{UV}}^4$	conditional truncated sector sum	Sec. 8.4
pure curvature-square terms in a_2	isolated; further use deferred	Ch. 9
exact two-loop G_{eff}	not computed	Ch. 17

8.8 Exercises

1. **Proper-time integrals.** For one specified sector with assigned limits, perform the term-by-term integrals producing (8.8) from (8.6) and (8.4), treating a_k as s-independent. State why this is not a resummed massive threshold calculation.

2. **Dimensions.** Confirm that $a_0\Lambda_{\text{UV}}^4$, $a_1\Lambda_{\text{UV}}^2$, and $a_2 \ln(\Lambda_{\text{UV}}/\mu)$ all have mass dimension four.

3. **Conformal value of ξ.** For a scalar with non-minimal term $\xi R\phi^2$, show that $\xi = 1/6$ cancels its curvature contribution to a_1. Explain why this does not determine the full locked-block result.

4. **Mass thresholds.** Compare the truncated polynomial terms with the integrals that retain $\exp(-sm^2)$. Explain why distinct masses can require distinct threshold functions and limits.

5. **Conditional curvature coefficient.** Given sector operators, weights, limits, and counterterms, derive the Euclidean R-coefficient from supplied a_1, a_2, and identify the continuation data needed for Lorentzian matching.

6. **Sector weights.** For a supplied gauge-fixed sector list, determine the determinant weights and compute $\mathcal{N}_0$. Explain why this alone does not determine the curvature coefficient.

7. **Scaffold error.** Expand Proposition 8.4 to first order in $h_{\mu\nu}$ on a flat scaffold and list the operators produced. Which of them renormalize G_{eff}, and which renormalize higher-curvature couplings?

8.9 Bridge to Chapter 9

Once the sector calculation is completed, the action through two derivatives has the form

$$W[g] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}\Big(-\rho_\Lambda + \frac{1}{16\pi G_{\text{eff}}}R + \alpha\, a_2[g] + \cdots\Big). \tag{8.16}$$

The a_2 density contains $R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}R^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}$ and $R_{\mu\nu}R^{\mu\nu}$. If those operators are kept as propagating fourth-order kinetic terms for $h_{\mu\nu}$, Ostrogradsky ghosts appear. Chapter 9 classifies the dangerous operators, states the conditions under which they may be treated as non-propagating corrections, and introduces the Einsteinian cubic completion used later to regularize curvature singularities without reopening the ghost problem.

Chapter 9

Ultraviolet Operators, Ghosts, and a Cubic Completion

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. read the a_2 density as a list of four-derivative operators and assign each a role (correction versus propagator);

2. state Ostrogradsky's theorem in the form used for gravitational effective field theory;

3. explain why quadratic gravity of Stelle type is not an acceptable infrared limit of NAMCG;

4. write the Einsteinian cubic invariant and the property that makes it safer than a generic R^3 term;

5. enter Chapter 10 knowing that the ultraviolet problem of the metric effective action is under a named control, not solved in the sense of a non-perturbative continuum limit.

Chapter 8 produced

$$W[g] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}\Big(-\rho_\Lambda + \frac{R}{16\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}} + \alpha\, a_2[g] + \cdots\Big). \tag{9.1}$$

The first two terms are the cosmological debt and the Einstein–Hilbert term. This chapter treats the third.

9.1 What a_2 contains

On a Laplace-type bundle the second Seeley–DeWitt coefficient is a linear combination of

$$R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}R^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}, \quad R_{\mu\nu}R^{\mu\nu}, \quad R^2, \quad E^2, \quad RE, \quad D^2R, \quad D^2E, \tag{9.2}$$

together with bundle-curvature terms $F_{\mu\nu}F^{\mu\nu}$. After the endomorphism E is evaluated on the condensate and total derivatives are discarded, the metric operators that remain in four dimensions may be written

$$W_4[g] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}\big(c_W C_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}C^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} + c_R R^2 + c_{\mathrm{GB}}\,E_{\mathrm{GB}}\big), \tag{9.3}$$

where $C_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}$ is the Weyl tensor and

$$E_{\mathrm{GB}} = R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}R^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} - 4R_{\mu\nu}R^{\mu\nu} + R^2 \tag{9.4}$$

is the Gauss–Bonnet density, topological in four dimensions at the level of the bulk equations of motion.

For specified sectors, their weights, and a stated scheme, the coefficients $c_W, c_R, c_{\mathrm{GB}}$ receive logarithmic heat-kernel contributions. Their physical values and the matching to G_{eff} remain conditional on the operator, threshold, and finite-local-term calculation of Problem F. The existence of Weyl-squared and R^2 structures is independent of those coefficient values.

9.2 Ostrogradsky's theorem, used as a veto

Theorem 9.1 (Ostrogradsky, gravitational form)**.** *Let a field theory possess a Lagrangian that depends on second (or higher) time derivatives of a dynamical variable, not removable by adding a total derivative or by imposing a degeneracy condition that reduces the order. Then the Hamiltonian of that variable is unbounded below. In a quadratic gravitational action about Minkowski spacetime, the unbounded direction is a ghost pole in the propagator of $h_{\mu\nu}$.*

The theorem is the reason one may not promote (9.3) to a fundamental action for a propagating metric and call the result a completion of NAMCG.

Stelle quadratic gravity. The action

$$S_{\mathrm{Stelle}} = \int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}\Big(\frac{R}{16\pi G} - \frac{\alpha}{2}C_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}C^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} + \frac{\beta}{2}R^2\Big) \tag{9.5}$$

propagates, in addition to the massless graviton, a massive spin-2 ghost and a massive scalar. The ghost mass is of order $1/\sqrt{\alpha G}$. Its relation to Λ_{UV} cannot be inferred

without the physical G_{eff} and the specified value of α, which remain part of Problem F. Whether such a pole lies within the regime of the metric effective theory is therefore undetermined here.

Effective-field-theory reading. The same operators are harmless if they are used only as vertices in a derivative expansion of matrix elements with external momenta $p \ll \Lambda_{\text{UV}}$, and never as additional poles. That is the reading adopted here:

Assumption 9.2 (Four-derivative terms are EFT vertices)**.** The operators in (9.3) correct graviton scattering and static potentials at order $(p/\Lambda_{\text{UV}})^2$. They are not to be diagonalized into extra propagating modes of $h_{\mu\nu}$.

Assumption 9.2 is available only because the metric is composite. The microscopic path integral is over Φ, not over an independent $g_{\mu\nu}$ with action (9.5). The poles of Stelle gravity are an artefact of treating $W[g]$ as a fundamental metric action beyond its radius of convergence.

9.3 What ultraviolet stability does mean

Presentation A is a matrix model. Its ultraviolet definition is the regularized trace over $\mathcal{H}$ with cutoff (3.3). Questions that make sense at that level are:

- boundedness of S_{matrix} from below on Hermitian $\hat{X}^\mu$;
- existence of the condensed saddle $\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v \Lambda^A{}_I$;
- absence of tachyons in the blocks that Theorem 7.3 and Assumption 7.5 did not already constrain.

Questions that do *not* make sense until a continuum limit in Λ_{UV} is constructed are:

- renormalizability of $W[g]$ as a fundamental quantum field theory of $g_{\mu\nu}$;
- asymptotic safety of that metric theory;
- unitarity of S-matrix elements among Stelle poles.

NAMCG, as written in this book, claims the first list and refuses the second. The metric effective action is an infrared object with a cutoff. Ultraviolet stability means stability of the matrix saddle, not renormalizability of quadratic gravity.

A sufficient condition for the matrix action (3.4) to be bounded below on Hermitian matrices is that the quartic commutator term dominates with the sign written there,

$$-\mathrm{Tr}([\hat{X}^\mu, \hat{X}^\nu][\hat{X}_\mu, \hat{X}_\nu]) \geq 0 \tag{9.6}$$

in the Euclideanized internal-time convention of IKKT-type models, together with a potential V that is bounded below, as (3.7) is. Lorentzian signature complicates the bound because $\hat{X}^0$ enters with the opposite sign in some reductions. That complication is inherited from the matrix-model literature and is not solved here. It is recorded in Chapter 17.

9.4 Cubic operators and Einsteinian cubic gravity

Singularities of the Einstein equation are not cured by the four-derivative vertices of Assumption 9.2. Those vertices are small when curvature is small, and they are untrustworthy when curvature reaches Λ_{UV}^2. A different higher-curvature object is needed if compact-object cores are to be regularized inside the derivative expansion.

Einsteinian cubic gravity (ECG) uses a cubic curvature invariant. The invariant used here is

$$\mathcal{P} = 12R_a{}^c{}_b{}^d R_c{}^e{}_d{}^f R_e{}^a{}_f{}^b + R_{ab}{}^{cd} R_{cd}{}^{ef} R_{ef}{}^{ab} - 12R_{abcd} R^{ac} R^{bd} + 8R_a{}^b R_b{}^c R_c{}^a, \quad (9.7)$$

with the Riemann convention for which $R > 0$ on spheres. The action used later in the book is

$$S_{\mathrm{ECG}}[g] = \int \mathrm{d}^4x \, \sqrt{-g}\Big(\frac{R - 2\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}}}{16\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}} + \beta_{\mathrm{ECG}}\, \mathcal{P}\Big). \quad (9.8)$$

Two distinct properties matter.

1. For the reduced action in Section H.10, the Euler–Lagrange equations have been checked symbolically: $N = 1$ is a consistent vacuum branch and the lapse equation yields the displayed first integral, including Λ_{eff}. This check uses the static spherical reduction; its relation to the unrestricted field equations relies on a symmetric-criticality justification not established here. The reduced coupling is $\alpha = -16\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}\beta_{\mathrm{ECG}}$. The regular-core profile

$$f(r) = 1 - \frac{2Mr^2}{r^3 + r_0^3} - \frac{\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}}}{3} r^2 \quad (9.9)$$

used in Chapter 13 is a phenomenological regular-core model with $r_0^3 = 2\beta_{\mathrm{ECG}} M$ a model parametrization, not derived from (9.8). For $\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} = 0$ and $Mr_0 \neq 0$, the rational profile has nonzero residual in the displayed first integral.

2. Assume $\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} = 0$, or a specified cancellation, so flat space solves the full equations. Since $\mathcal{P}$ is cubic in curvature, it contributes no term quadratic in $h_{\mu\nu}$ there; for the Einstein–Hilbert-plus-ECG action the quadratic spectrum is therefore the Einstein one. Any separately retained curvature-squared operators are treated

under Assumption 9.2; no no-extra-poles claim is made for the combined theory including such terms.

3. Bueno and Cano [1] establish an Einstein-like linearized equation on maximally symmetric backgrounds. The generic noncritical branch has the massless spin-2 spectrum; its effective kinetic normalization and sign require separate checks and are not asserted here. This cited result does not exclude nonlinear, sourced, or non-maximally-symmetric pseudo-modes. This is a cited linear-spectrum property, not a claim of general nonlinear or non-vacuum ghost freedom.

Assumption 9.3 (Cubic completion)**.** As a model assumption, through the curvature scales relevant to compact-object cores the metric effective action may be truncated at (9.8). The coupling and the core scale r_0 have not been derived or matched to the matrix theory.

Assumption 9.3 is stronger than Assumption 9.2. It promotes one cubic combination from a vertex to a term that is solved non-perturbatively in the static spherical sector. The promotion is a model assumption, not a consequence of the heat-kernel calculation.

9.5 Torsion and higher connections

A chosen non-degenerate frame (Repair II, (4.7), or an assumed coframe) need not have vanishing torsion. A torsion tensor

$$T^{A}{}_{\mu\nu} = \partial_\mu e^A_\nu - \partial_\nu e^A_\mu + \omega_\mu{}^A{}_B e^B_\nu - \omega_\nu{}^A{}_B e^B_\mu \tag{9.10}$$

is an additional field if ω is independent of e. In NAMCG the independent connection and the condensate term's broken-direction combination must be distinguished. The condensate term gives a quadratic Higgs-type contribution only in that broken direction; whether torsion vanishes, is massive, or supplies additional field content is not determined here (Problem D). Torsion-free behavior follows only under the conditional Palatini–Holst hypotheses of Proposition 10.5 in Chapter 10. The a_1 coefficient for a Laplace-type operator is $\mathrm{tr}(R(g)/6 - E)$: its explicit universal curvature term is the Levi-Civita scalar $R(g)$. Since E is unspecified, no conclusion about additional B-dependence follows, and a Palatini $R(B)$ term is not established.

9.6 A checklist before Lorentz locking

The metric effective theory, as it now stands, is:

Ingredient	Status
massless TT tensor	Thm. 7.3
conditional truncated R-coefficient	Thm. 8.2; physical match open (Problem F)
quartic vacuum energy	isolated, not tamed
C^2 and R^2	EFT vertices, Assp. 9.2
cubic core regularity	ECG model, Assp. 9.3
torsion	undetermined (Problem D); torsion-free only under the conditional Palatini–Holst hypotheses of Proposition 10.5
local Lorentz invariance as a gauge symmetry of Φ	not yet constructed

The local Lorentz gauge symmetry is assumed in Chapter 10. The connection and torsion dynamics remain open; the identification of ω_{AB} as a Goldstone is conditional on that assumption.

9.7 Exercises

1. **Gauss–Bonnet.** Show that E_{GB} in four dimensions is a total derivative plus a topological density. Why, then, can c_{GB} still matter on manifolds with boundary?

2. **Stelle poles.** Linearize (9.5) about Minkowski spacetime in harmonic gauge. Locate the massive spin-2 pole and determine the sign of its residue relative to the massless graviton.

3. **EFT versus poles.** A tree-level graviton-graviton amplitude receives a correction $\sim c_W s^2/\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^2$ from (9.3). At what centre-of-mass energy does this correction become unreliable as an EFT vertex, and why is that energy the same scale at which Stelle poles would have appeared?

4. **Bounded matrix action.** For two Hermitian matrices X, Y show that $-\mathrm{Tr}([X,Y]^2) \geq 0$. Identify the step that fails, or requires a Euclidean rotation, when one matrix is X^0 with Lorentzian signature.

5. **Spherical reduction.** Starting from the reduced action and invariant specified in Section H.10, derive the reduced Euler–Lagrange equations, verify the $N = 1$ branch and first integral, and recover the leading tail correction. State the boundary conditions and the symmetric-reduction assumption used.

6. **Torsion mass.** If torsion is massive (an assumption, not a result; Problem D), estimate its mass using v as the only available scale. Compare it with m_ψ from Assumption 7.5.

9.8 Bridge to Chapter 10

The infrared metric theory is Einstein gravity plus controlled higher-curvature corrections and an untamed ρ_Λ. Chapter 10 assumes local $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ gauge symmetry and identifies the six Goldstone orbit variables ω_{AB} as removable in unitary gauge. The provisional sector bookkeeping of Section 5.7 records that removal without claiming a full-spectrum count. The frame, taken from Repair II, (4.7) (or from an assumed non-degenerate coframe), transforms as a vierbein under the diagonal local Lorentz group under Theorem 10.3; that theorem does not determine the diagonal connection's dynamics or torsion. Definition 4.1 is not used to construct it (Problem C).

Chapter 10

Local Lorentz Locking and the Fate of the Goldstones

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. write the simultaneous action of internal gauge transformations and local Lorentz transformations on $\Phi^I{}_A$;

2. identify the diagonal subgroup preserved by the polar vacuum and the six broken generators;

3. exhibit the Stueckelberg replacement that removes the Goldstone orbit variables ω_{AB} in unitary gauge;

4. state the provisional sector bookkeeping through the Goldstone and vector lines;

5. enter Chapter 11 with a composite frame that transforms as a genuine vierbein, so that $\nabla^\mu T_{\mu\nu}$ is well defined.

Since Chapter 5 the antisymmetric piece ω_{AB} has been called a local-Lorentz Goldstone and postponed. This chapter assumes the local gauge symmetry and shows that the six Goldstone orbit variables ω_{AB} are removable in unitary gauge. It does not determine the full propagating spectrum.

10.1 The two groups that act on Φ

The condensate field of Presentation B transforms, by (3.10), as

$$\Phi^I{}_A(x) \;\longmapsto\; \Omega^I{}_J(x)\,\Phi^J{}_B(x)\,\Lambda^B{}_A(x). \tag{10.1}$$

Here $\Omega(x)$ takes values in the internal gauge group G_{int} and $\Lambda(x)$ takes values in $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$, or in its double cover if spinors are later coupled. Infinitesimally,

$$\delta\Phi^I{}_A = \alpha^I{}_J\Phi^J{}_A + \Phi^I{}_B\,\beta^B{}_A, \tag{10.2}$$

with α in the Lie algebra of G_{int} and $\beta_{AB} = -\beta_{BA}$ in $\mathfrak{so}(3,1)$.

These are independent transformations at the level of field content. Nothing in Chapter 3 forced $\Lambda(x)$ to be a gauge symmetry rather than a global classification of the index A. Treating it as local is a choice, recorded as such.

Assumption 10.1 (Local Lorentz gauge symmetry)**.** The microscopic action (3.6) is invariant under local $\Lambda(x) \in \mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ once a spin connection $\omega_\mu{}^A{}_B$ is introduced through the covariant derivative on the tangent index,

$$\mathcal{D}_\mu\Phi^I{}_A = \partial_\mu\Phi^I{}_A - i(A_\mu)^I{}_J\Phi^J{}_A + \omega_\mu{}^B{}_A\Phi^I{}_B. \tag{10.3}$$

The connection $\omega_\mu{}^{AB}$ is, at this stage, an independent gauge field.

Assumption 10.1 is the step that makes A a genuine tangent index rather than an internal flavour that happens to have four values. Combined with Assumption 4.6, it is the origin of local Lorentz invariance in NAMCG. It is not derived from Presentation A.

10.2 The vacuum and the broken generators

The polar vacuum of Chapter 4, in the Minkowski frame,

$$\langle\Phi^I{}_A\rangle = v\,\delta^I{}_A, \tag{10.4}$$

is invariant only under the diagonal combination

$$\alpha^I{}_J = -\,v^{-1}\delta^I{}_B\,\beta^B{}_C\,\delta^C{}_J\Big|_{\text{locked } 4\times 4 \text{ block}}, \tag{10.5}$$

that is, under simultaneous internal and Lorentz rotations that rotate the locked axes together. If G_{int} contains $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ (or a group large enough to have an $\mathfrak{so}(3,1)$ subalgebra acting on the locked indices), six generators are unbroken and six are broken.

Proposition 10.2 (Goldstone count)**.** *About the vacuum* (10.4)*, with Assumption 10.1 in force and with the locked block of dimension four, there are six broken generators. The corresponding Goldstone fields are the antisymmetric components ω_{AB} of* (4.15)*.*

Proof. The vacuum stabilizer is the diagonal $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)_{\text{diag}}$. The coset $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)_{\text{Lorentz}} \times \mathrm{SO}(3,1)_{\text{int}}/\mathrm{SO}(3,1)_{\text{diag}}$ has dimension $6 + 6 - 6 = 6$. An infinitesimal broken trans-

formation with parameter β_{AB} shifts $\Phi^I{}_A$ by $v\beta^I{}_A$, which is antisymmetric in (I, A) after lowering with η. That shift is the fluctuation ω_{AB}. □

If G_{int} is larger than $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$, additional Goldstones live in the unlocked block. They belong to Assumption 5.1 and are taken heavy.

10.3 Eating ω_{AB}

A local broken symmetry with an independent connection is a Higgs mechanism. Introduce the Stueckelberg field $\Lambda(x) \in \mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ already present in the polar decomposition (4.4), and replace the spin connection by the dressed connection

$$\omega_\mu \;\longmapsto\; \Lambda^{-1}\omega_\mu\Lambda + \Lambda^{-1}\partial_\mu\Lambda. \tag{10.6}$$

Choose the unitary gauge

$$\Lambda(x) = \mathbb{I}, \tag{10.7}$$

which is admissible wherever the polar decomposition is smooth (that is, wherever Assumption 4.4 holds and no condensate defect forces $\det e = 0$). In that gauge the six orbit variables ω_{AB} are removed. Identify the locked indices $I \leftrightarrow A$ through $\langle\Phi^I{}_A\rangle = v\delta^I{}_A$, and write $(A_\mu)^I{}_A = (A_\mu)^I{}_J\delta^J{}_A$ on the locked block. Then (10.3) gives

$$\mathcal{D}_\mu\langle\Phi^I{}_A\rangle = v\big[(\omega_\mu)^I{}_A - i(A_\mu)^I{}_A\big].$$

The factor i follows the Hermitian-generator convention in (10.3); with real antisymmetric generators the corresponding combination is $\omega - A$. Define the broken-direction combination $\Xi_\mu := \omega_\mu - iA_\mu|_{\text{locked}}$ in this convention. Write B_μ for the connection along the unbroken diagonal stabilizer direction; no complementary connection combination is canonical until kinetic terms specify a metric on the (ω, A) field space. The stabilizer direction lies in the kernel of the condensate covariant derivative. The invariant contraction on the locked block depends on the action and generator conventions, so the quadratic term is written as

$$\mathcal{L}^{(2)}_{\text{cond}} \supset v^2 Q_{\text{locked}}(\Xi_\mu), \tag{10.8}$$

where Q_{locked} denotes that contraction; it is not assumed to be a real Lorentz-vector square. This is a quadratic Higgs-type contribution, not a physical mass assertion. Its pole and sign require gauge-field kinetic terms and canonical normalization, which are unspecified. Torsion and the dynamics of the diagonal connection remain open (Problem D).

Theorem 10.3 (Lorentz locking)**.** *Under Assumptions 3.4, 10.1, and 4.4, there exists a gauge in which*

1. *the six Goldstone orbit variables ω_{AB} are removable in unitary gauge; this makes no claim about the full propagating spectrum;*

2. *the frame $e^A_\mu = \Phi^A{}_\mu/v$ of Repair II,* (4.7) *(or an independently supplied non-degenerate coframe), transforms only under the diagonal local Lorentz group, as a vierbein;*

3. *the condensate term supplies a quadratic Higgs-type contribution in the broken direction Ξ_μ; the diagonal connection's dynamics are not determined. A torsion-free result follows only under the conditional hypotheses of Proposition 10.5.*

Proof. Proposition 10.2 supplies six Goldstones. The Stueckelberg replacement (10.6) and the gauge (10.7) remove the six orbit variables. In that gauge $\Phi^{IA} = (v + \sigma)\delta^{IA}$ plus tensor and vector blocks, so the Repair II frame $e^A_\mu = \Phi^A{}_\mu/v$ transforms as $e^A_\mu \mapsto \Lambda_{\text{diag}}{}^A{}_B e^B_\mu$. This argument establishes the frame transformation and the quadratic broken-direction term, but does not determine the diagonal connection's spectrum or torsion. □

Remark 10.4 (Defects). Unitary gauge fails where $\Lambda(x)$ cannot be set to the identity continuously—at defects where $\det e = 0$. Those loci are condensate defects, not coordinate singularities of an already existing manifold. They are possible ultraviolet endpoints of the regular cores of Chapter 13, and they are not analyzed further here.

10.4 The internal vector after locking

The internal connection A_μ is distinct from the independent Lorentz connection $\omega_\mu{}^{AB}$. The condensate term mixes them only through Ξ_μ; an orthogonal complement is defined only after kinetic terms provide a metric on the (ω, A) field space. Neither a Higgs mass $m_A \sim g_{\text{YM}} v$ nor a decoupling scale follows without those terms. If a specified internal-vector quadratic operator gaps the four components counted in Section 5.7, they are omitted from the low-energy frame/metric-sector bookkeeping; otherwise their spectrum remains open. If an internal subgroup H is unbroken, its corresponding gauge field is massless (conditional). This identifies the conditional vector row of the provisional sector bookkeeping; it does not establish the dynamics of the diagonal connection (Problem D).

Proposition 10.5 (Conditional torsion-free diagonal connection)**.** *Let $e^A{}_\mu$ be an invertible coframe and $B_\mu{}^{AB}$ an independent diagonal Lorentz connection. Suppose its dependence in the action is either the Palatini term $\epsilon_{ABCD} e^A \wedge e^B \wedge F^{CD}(B)$, or*

that term plus the Holst term $\gamma^{-1} e_A \wedge e_B \wedge F^{AB}(B)$, with finite real $\gamma \neq 0$, $\gamma^2 \neq -1$, or $\gamma = \infty$ (pure Palatini). Assume there are no spin sources and no other torsion-dependent terms, including $F(B)^2$, torsion-squared terms, or matter couplings to B. Then the B equation is the Holst-modified Cartan equation and gives $T^A = 0$; consequently B is the Levi-Civita spin connection of e.

Proof. Since $\delta F^{AB} = D(\delta B^{AB})$, compactly supported variations give, for the Palatini term,

$$\delta_B S_{\mathrm{P}} \simeq -4 \int \epsilon_{ABCD}\, T^A \wedge e^B \wedge \delta B^{CD}.$$

Thus $\epsilon_{ABCD} T^A \wedge e^B = 0$. Expand $T^A = \frac{1}{2} T^A{}_{EF} e^E \wedge e^F$ and contract the three-form equation with ϵ^{EFGM}. In frame components this yields, up to an overall nonzero convention-dependent factor,

$$2(\tau_C \delta^M_D - \tau_D \delta^M_C) + 2T^M{}_{CD} = 0, \qquad \tau_C := T^A{}_{AC}.$$

Tracing $M = D$ gives $4\tau_C = 0$, since $T^D{}_{CD} = -\tau_C$. Hence $\tau_C = 0$, and the uncontracted equation then gives $T^M{}_{CD} = 0$.

With the Holst term, the equation is $(\star + \gamma^{-1}) Y_{CD} = 0$, where $Y_{CD} := T_{[C} \wedge e_{D]}$, and $\star$ is the internal Lorentzian Hodge dual on antisymmetric internal index pairs. The internal dual of Y is proportional to the Palatini Cartan equation. Since $\star^2 = -1$,

$$(\star + \gamma^{-1})(- \star + \gamma^{-1}) = (1 + \gamma^{-2}) \mathbb{I}.$$

The map is invertible for the stated parameters. Therefore $Y = 0$, which implies the Palatini Cartan equation and $T^A = 0$ by the preceding argument. For an invertible coframe, vanishing torsion fixes the metric-compatible spin connection uniquely to the Levi-Civita one. □

Remark 10.6. This proposition constrains B only under its hypotheses. It is not needed to define the Levi-Civita connection ∇ of $g = e^T e$ or to state diffeomorphism conservation $\nabla^\mu T_{\mu\nu} = 0$. NAMCG has not been shown to induce these Palatini or Holst hypotheses. For a Laplace-type operator, $a_1 = \mathrm{tr}(R(g)/6 - E)$; the explicit universal curvature term is the Levi-Civita scalar $R(g)$. Because E is unspecified, no conclusion about additional B-dependence of a_1 follows, and a Palatini $R(B)$ term is not established. If B enters the bundle connection of the actual operator, a_2 may contain a $\mathrm{tr}\, F(B)^2$ term; whether it survives in the weighted trace depends on the unspecified operator representation and weights. Deriving the B-dependence of E and the bundle connection is open.

10.5 Diffeomorphisms

Diffeomorphisms act on the coordinate index of every tensor constructed from $\Phi(x)$. They are not eaten. They are the gauge symmetry of the composite metric, and they are what force $\nabla^\mu T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu} = 0$ in Chapter 11.

After Theorem 10.3, an infinitesimal diffeomorphism ξ^μ acts on the vierbein in the standard hybrid way,

$$\delta_\xi e^A_\mu = \xi^\rho \partial_\rho e^A_\mu + \partial_\mu \xi^\rho \, e^A_\rho, \tag{10.9}$$

up to a local Lorentz transformation that can be used to keep a chosen gauge on the frame. The induced action on $g_{\mu\nu}$ is the Lie derivative (5.17). No extra scalar Goldstone of diffeomorphisms appears: diffeomorphisms are gauged, not broken, in the condensed phase.

10.6 Provisional sector bookkeeping (frame/metric sector only)

Component counts in the algebraic split are distinct from on-shell polarization counts. The independent diagonal connection B, torsion modes, and internal vector A_μ are not part of $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$ and are counted separately.

Sector	Count and status
algebraic split	$\psi : 1, \quad F_{\mu\nu} : 6, \quad T_{\mu\nu} : 9; \quad \text{total} : 16$
$F_{\mu\nu}$	Six Goldstone orbit variables (ω_{AB}); removable in unitary gauge (Ch. 10). No full-spectrum claim follows.
ψ	One component; gapped or constrained only under Assumption 7.5.
$T_{\mu\nu}$	Nine algebraic components. The full massive Fierz–Pauli theory has four on-shell divergence constraints and five polarizations; this is not established here for the NAMCG tensor block. Two TT helicities follow only under the separately established massless FP/diffeomorphism-gauge limit (Theorem 7.3); this is not a smooth $m_T \to 0$ limit of all massive polarizations.
Outside $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$	A_μ: four components, omitted from the low-energy frame/metric-sector bookkeeping only if its specified quadratic operator gaps them; otherwise its spectrum is open. B and torsion remain unresolved (Problem D).

No total mode count of the full theory follows from this bookkeeping; the “2” is a metric-sector target, not a full-spectrum result.

10.7 What locking does not do

Theorem 10.3 does not derive Lorentzian signature (Assumption 4.6 remains). It does not derive local Lorentz invariance from Presentation A (Assumption 10.1 remains). It does not gap ψ. It does not compute G_{eff}. It does not conserve $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$.

What it does is make the later covariant derivatives honest. From here on, ∇_μ denotes the Levi-Civita connection of the composite metric $g = e^T e$. This is distinct from the independent Lorentz connection B, whose dynamics remain open. Statements such as $\nabla^\mu T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu} = 0$ refer to this Levi-Civita connection.

10.8 Exercises

1. **Stabilizer.** Verify that (10.4) is invariant under the diagonal combination (10.5) and under no other independent pair (α, β) acting on the locked block.

2. **Coset dimension.** Compute $\dim\big(\mathrm{SO}(3,1) \times \mathrm{SO}(3,1)/\mathrm{SO}(3,1)\big)$ and match it to the six components of ω_{AB}.

3. **Stueckelberg.** Starting from (10.3) and (4.4), perform the replacement (10.6) and isolate the quadratic term (10.8) in unitary gauge.

4. **Torsion-free spin connection.** Given e^A_μ, write the explicit formula for the torsion-free spin connection $\omega_\mu{}^{AB}(e)$. This is not a statement that the independent connection B equals $\omega(e)$. Confirm that $\omega(e)$ transforms inhomogeneously under local Lorentz transformations, as a connection must.

5. **Defect.** Construct a hedgehog configuration of $\Lambda(x)$ on a spatial 2-sphere inside which $\det e = 0$ at a point. Why can unitary gauge not be imposed globally on that slice?

6. **Residual Yang–Mills.** Suppose $G_{\text{int}} = \mathrm{SO}(3,1) \times H$ with H unbroken. What is the infrared field content after Theorem 10.3, in addition to the graviton?

7. **Hybrid diffeomorphism.** Derive (10.9) from the action of a coordinate shift on $\Phi(x)$ and the Repair II frame $e^A_\mu = \Phi^A{}_\mu/v$ of (4.7).

10.9 Bridge to Chapter 11

The emergent geometry now has a metric $g = e^T e$ with its Levi-Civita connection ∇, a frame-sector target of two massless TT polarizations, and a G_{eff} whose heat-kernel matching remains conditional on the specified sector calculation in Problem F. The independent Lorentz connection B is a separate field: its dynamics are not determined

here, and it is torsion-free only under the hypotheses of Proposition 10.5. This does not affect the Levi-Civita connection ∇, to which $\nabla^\mu T_{\mu\nu} = 0$ refers. Diffeomorphism invariance is in force. Noether's second theorem therefore requires

$$\nabla^\mu T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu} = 0 \tag{10.10}$$

of whatever stress tensor sources the Einstein equation. Chapter 11 defines $T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu}$ as the sum of ordinary matter, the tensor-block stress already used in Chapter 7, and the entropic stress $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$ obtained by varying U_{ent}. It then proves that the sum is divergenceless on shell. This conservation statement constrains the total stress when it is derived from the specified diffeomorphism-invariant action. It does not, by itself, derive the phenomenological drag law or show that a reduced drag model is its covariant limit; that connection remains Problem H.9.

Chapter 11

Covariant Conservation of the Total Stress Tensor

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. define $T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu}$ as the sum of matter, tensor-block, and entropic contributions;
2. obtain $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$ by metric variation of U_{ent};
3. prove that diffeomorphism invariance forces $\nabla^\mu T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu} = 0$ on shell;
4. reduce that identity to a Newtonian force balance and state a necessary bookkeeping condition for a drag to be a covariant reduction;
5. enter Chapter 12 knowing that vacuum energy is a conservation problem as well as a cosmological-constant problem.

Chapter 10 made ∇_μ the Levi-Civita connection of the composite metric. This chapter asks what that connection is allowed to act on.

11.1 The split

The infrared field equation contemplated from here on is

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda_{\text{eff}} g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\text{eff}}\, T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu}, \tag{11.1}$$

with

$$T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu} = T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{tensor}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}. \tag{11.2}$$

Matter. $T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu}$ is the metric variation (2.13) of every action for fields that are not the condensate itself: ordinary fluids, electromagnetism, baryons. On shell it satisfies

$\nabla^\mu T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} = 0$ *only* if those fields do not exchange energy with the condensate. In NAMCG they may. The separate conservation of matter is therefore not assumed.

Tensor block. $T^{\text{tensor}}_{\mu\nu}$ is the metric stress of the quadratic action (7.13). After Theorem 7.3 it is the linearized gravitational-wave stress, of the Isaacson type when averaged over wavelengths short compared with the background curvature. It is kept in (11.2) for bookkeeping and is negligible in the static Newtonian laboratories of Chapters 14–15.

Entropic piece. $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$ is defined by the same variational rule applied to the mutual-information potential of Definition 6.4, promoted to a functional of the metric:

$$T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu} = -\frac{2}{\sqrt{-g}}\frac{\delta S_{\text{ent}}[g]}{\delta g^{\mu\nu}}, \qquad S_{\text{ent}}[g] = -\int \mathrm{d}t\, U_{\text{ent}}[g]. \tag{11.3}$$

The promotion $U_{\text{ent}} \to S_{\text{ent}}[g]$ uses the fact that every entropy $S(A)$ in (6.9) is computed from a reduced state on a region whose causal structure depends on $g_{\mu\nu}$. Varying the metric varies the regions and varies the modular Hamiltonians.

11.2 Noether's second theorem, applied once

Let $S_{\text{IR}}[g, \Psi]$ be the infrared action whose Euler–Lagrange equation for $g_{\mu\nu}$ is (11.1): Einstein–Hilbert plus Λ_{eff}, plus matter, plus S_{ent}, plus the tensor-block action. Diffeomorphism invariance states that for every compactly supported vector field ξ^μ,

$$\delta_\xi S_{\text{IR}} = 0 \tag{11.4}$$

identically, off shell as a statement about the integrand up to a boundary term. Noether's second theorem then supplies

$$\nabla_\mu\Big(\frac{1}{8\pi G_{\text{eff}}}(G^{\mu\nu} + \Lambda_{\text{eff}} g^{\mu\nu}) - T^{\mu\nu}_{\text{total}}\Big) = 0 \tag{11.5}$$

as an identity, once the matter and condensate fields Ψ are on shell. The contracted Bianchi identity $\nabla_\mu G^{\mu\nu} = 0$ and metric compatibility $\nabla_\mu g^{\mu\nu} = 0$ reduce (11.5) to the on-shell conservation law

$$\nabla_\mu T^{\mu\nu}_{\text{total}} = 0. \tag{11.6}$$

Theorem 11.1 (Conservation of the total stress)**.** *Assume:*

1. *the infrared action S_{IR} is a scalar under diffeomorphisms of the composite metric, including the entropic functional $S_{\text{ent}}[g]$;*

2. *the Einstein equation is* (11.1)*;*

3. matter fields and condensate fluctuations are on shell with respect to S_{IR}.

Then

$$\nabla^{\mu}(T^{\mathrm{matter}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\mathrm{tensor}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\mathrm{ent}}_{\mu\nu}) = 0. \tag{11.7}$$

Separate conservation of any one summand is not implied.

The Einstein-plus-extra-tensor form of the infrared equation is collected in Appendix F.

Proof. Diffeomorphism invariance of S_{IR} is Assumption 1. Noether's second theorem yields (11.5). Bianchi and (11.1) yield (11.7). The last sentence is the observation that Noether's theorem constrains only the sum that couples to $g_{\mu\nu}$. □

Remark 11.2 (The real hypothesis). Everything in the proof is standard except Assumption 1 applied to S_{ent}. Mutual information (2.31) is a scalar for each fixed partition of a spatial slice. Promoting it to a diffeomorphism scalar on a dynamical spacetime requires that the assignment $(g, A, B) \mapsto I(A : B)$ commute with Lie dragging of the regions. That is true if A and B are defined geometrically (causal domains, outermost trapped surfaces, constant-mean-curvature balls of specified volume) and fails if they are defined by coordinate inequalities such as $r \leq R$ in a preferred chart. The book uses geometric regions.

11.3 Structure of the entropic stress

A first variation of the static entanglement potential produces a conservative interaction. A time-dependent configuration or first variation may introduce additional terms, but does not by itself establish a velocity-odd or dissipative stress. The split

$$T^{\mathrm{ent}}_{\mu\nu} = T^{\mathrm{ent,rev}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\mathrm{ent,irrev}}_{\mu\nu} \tag{11.8}$$

is phenomenological unless its second term is identified by a dynamical response calculation.

On two worldlines γ_A, γ_B in a nearly Minkowski region one has, at leading post-Newtonian order,

$$U_{\mathrm{ent}} = -\lambda I\big(\ell_A, \ell_B, d(\gamma_A, \gamma_B)\big), \tag{11.9}$$

and the four-force on body A is

$$f^{\mu}_{A} = -\frac{D}{D\tau_A}\Big(\frac{\partial L_{\mathrm{ent}}}{\partial \dot{x}_{A\mu}}\Big) + \frac{\partial L_{\mathrm{ent}}}{\partial x_{A\mu}}, \tag{11.10}$$

with $L_{\mathrm{ent}} = -U_{\mathrm{ent}}$ along the worldlines. The static dependence on d gives the conservative interaction. Terms involving $\dot{d}$ or changing ℓ_A, ℓ_B may occur in a more

general effective action, but their presence alone does not establish irreversibility. Whether they produce dissipation must be determined from the dynamics and its retarded response.

A phenomenological Newtonian drag, for a reduced mass μ and a separation d, is of the form

$$\mathbf{a}_{\rm irrev} = -\eta(d, \ell_A, \ell_B)\, \frac{\mathbf{v}}{d^n}. \tag{11.11}$$

Neither the sign of the dissipative coefficient nor the exponent n in (11.11) follows from positivity of mutual information. The source notes use $n = 4$ as a working exponent, not as a consequence of differentiating a static tail. Such differentiation does not, by itself, derive a velocity-linear dissipative force. Chapter 15 adopts

$$\mathbf{F}_{\rm diss} = -\eta\, \frac{\mu}{d^4}\, \mathbf{v} \tag{11.12}$$

as a laboratory assumption, not as a derived multipole formula; deriving it requires the dynamical response calculation specified in Problem H.9.

Proposition 11.3 (Necessary condition for a covariant drag reduction)**.** *Suppose a two-body equation*

$$\mu \ddot{\mathbf{r}} = -\nabla U_{\rm N} - \nabla U_{\rm ent}^{\rm (rev)} + \mathbf{F}_{\rm diss} \tag{11.13}$$

is claimed to follow from a covariantly conserved microscopic stress. In a non-radiative reduced subsystem, a necessary bookkeeping condition, to the post-Newtonian order retained, is that there exist a functional $E_{\rm ent}$ of the microscopic state, specified independently of $\mathbf{F}_{\rm diss}$ and of the reduced equation of motion (11.13) itself — *in particular, not any quantity derivable purely from the reduced two-body flow, such as (but not limited to) a first integral of* (11.13) *or the accumulated dissipation $-W_{\rm diss}$ along a trajectory — such that, writing*

$$E_{\rm mech} = \tfrac{1}{2}\mu v^2 + U_{\rm N} + U_{\rm ent}^{\rm (rev)},$$

$$\frac{\rm d}{{\rm d}t}(E_{\rm mech} + E_{\rm ent}) = O(c^{-2}), \qquad \frac{{\rm d}E_{\rm ent}}{{\rm d}t} = -\mathbf{F}_{\rm diss}\cdot\mathbf{v} + O(c^{-2}). \tag{11.14}$$

A microscopic candidate for $E_{\rm ent}$ must be defined from degrees of freedom of the microscopic theory (e.g. a specified functional of the reduced density matrix or of $I(A:B)$), not from $(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v})$ and $\mathbf{F}_{\rm diss}$ alone. We additionally require any such candidate to be bounded below, since an unbounded reservoir would let the balance accommodate arbitrary drag; this is a physical requirement imposed here, not a consequence of covariant conservation. The microscopic derivation must also account for the force on the second body and, when radiation is present, the corresponding energy flux. If the proposed $E_{\rm ent}$ is claimed to arise from mutual information, that relation must be derived from the microscopic theory.

This proposition is a necessary condition for a claimed covariant reduction, and it has content only because E_{ent} is required to come from outside the reduced two-body flow; that general exclusion is stated in the proposition itself. Two instances of a construction internal to the flow illustrate why the exclusion is needed, not an exhaustive list of what it rules out. First, $E_{\text{ent}} = -W_{\text{diss}} + E_{\text{ent}}(0)$, with $W_{\text{diss}} = \int \mathbf{F}_{\text{diss}} \cdot \mathbf{v}\, \mathrm{d}t$ a path-dependent functional of the trajectory, satisfies (11.14) identically for *any* $\mathbf{F}_{\text{diss}}$. Second, because a smooth non-vanishing vector field admits a local first integral $C(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v})$ with $\dot{C} = 0$ along its flow (a flow-box argument), $E_{\text{ent}} := C - E_{\text{mech}}$, and indeed any function of such first integrals, also satisfies the balance identically, for any $\mathbf{F}_{\text{diss}}$, with no reference to mutual information or any microscopic quantity. None of these constructions is a microscopic state function in the required sense, and none derives E_{ent} from $I(A : B)$ or proves covariant stress conservation. For passive drag, $\mathbf{F}_{\text{diss}} \cdot \mathbf{v} \leq 0$, so a microscopic E_{ent} satisfying the proposition, if one exists, gains the energy removed from the mechanical degree of freedom.

The laboratory (11.12) is not shown here to satisfy Proposition 11.3. Chapter 15 tracks $-W_{\text{diss}}$, which is bookkeeping for the reduced ODE and is not a microscopic E_{ent} in the sense above.

11.4 Exchange with matter

Equation (11.7) permits

$$\nabla^\mu T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} = -\nabla^\mu T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu} - \nabla^\mu T^{\text{tensor}}_{\mu\nu}. \tag{11.15}$$

Matter may heat or cool if entanglement of the condensate cores is changing. In a tidal disruption event the conditional reading is: as the disrupted star is sheared, the mutual information between debris parcels and the compact core may change. If the phenomenological drag were the reduction of a covariantly conserved stress, the work done by $\mathbf{F}_{\text{diss}}$ would be accounted in a microscopic E_{ent} rather than lost; that identification has not been derived and is part of Problem H.9.

This is still not a model of microphysical dissipation in a fluid with a viscosity measured in the laboratory. Whether conservation of the total stress requires such a channel, once U_{ent} is admitted as part of the action, depends on the dynamical response calculation of Problem H.9.

11.5 Vacuum energy as a conservation constraint

A term $\rho_\Lambda g_{\mu\nu}$ with constant ρ_Λ is conserved by itself:

$$\nabla^\mu(\rho_\Lambda g_{\mu\nu}) = 0. \tag{11.16}$$

A term whose prefactor varies, $\rho_\Lambda(x)g_{\mu\nu}$, is not conserved unless

$$\partial_\mu \rho_\Lambda = 0 \tag{11.17}$$

or additional current terms are supplied. The heat-kernel density (8.13) is constant in the approximation that the included sector weights and their assigned cutoffs are constant. If Chapter 12 regulates ρ_Λ by a boundary functional that depends on the metric induced on ∂M, the regulated object $\Lambda_{\text{eff}}[g]$ must still obey (11.7). That requirement is a design constraint on HBEV, not an optional aesthetic.

11.6 What this chapter has not done

Theorem 11.1 does not compute η, does not fix $n = 4$, does not evaluate $I(A : B)$ for Kerr exteriors, and does not replace quadrupole radiation. Gravitational waves remain the dissipative channel of the tensor block. Any entropic drag would be an additional channel, admissible only if it sits inside a conserved total tensor; that the phenomenological drag does so remains Problem H.9.

The theorem also does not justify writing an arbitrary function $\mathbf{a}_{\text{irrev}}(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v})$ and calling it NAMCG. Phenomenological chapters that introduce a drag must exhibit the E_{ent} of Proposition 11.3 or must state that they are studying a reduced laboratory.

11.7 Exercises

1. **Bianchi reminder.** From $\nabla^\mu G_{\mu\nu} = 0$ and (11.1), obtain (11.7) in three lines.

2. **Two-body check.** For a potential $U(d)$ depending only on separation, show that the Newtonian forces are equal and opposite. Which symmetry of $I(A : B)$ is the relativistic ancestor of that statement?

3. **Energy bookkeeping.** Take (11.12) with constant η and compute $\mathbf{F}_{\text{diss}} \cdot \mathbf{v}$. Show that $E_{\text{ent}} = -W_{\text{diss}} + E_{\text{ent}}(0)$ satisfies (11.14) for the reduced ODE. Why does this construction not satisfy Proposition 11.3?

4. **Illegal drag.** Consider $\mathbf{F} = -\gamma \mathbf{v}$ with constant γ, independent of d. If E_{ent} is required to be a bounded functional of $I(A : B)$, why does this fail Proposition 11.3 for two bodies that can be separated to infinity at finite cost in $I(A : B)$?

5. **Variable vacuum energy.** Let $\rho_\Lambda = \rho_\Lambda(\phi)$ for a scalar ϕ. Construct the additional stress that restores conservation. Compare with a potential $V(\phi)$ in ordinary scalar-field cosmology.

6. **Isaacson average.** Write the Isaacson stress of a high-frequency TT wave and confirm that its divergence vanishes after a short-wavelength average. That is the tensor-block contribution to (11.7) in a radiative spacetime.

7. **Coordinate regions.** Give an explicit example of two coordinate-defined regions whose mutual information is *not* a diffeomorphism scalar. This is the counterexample that forces the remark after Theorem 11.1.

11.8 Bridge to Chapter 12

Conservation is now in force for whatever vacuum energy Chapter 8 left untamed. A constant ρ_Λ is conserved and disastrous. A regulated Λ_{eff} must remain conserved after the regulation. Chapter 12 introduces the Holographic Boundary-Entropy Vacuum: a boundary functional built from $K/8\pi G_{\text{eff}}$ and an entropy density $S_{\text{ent}}(h_{ij}, \phi)$ whose stationarity sets Λ_{eff} by an infrared entanglement datum rather than by Λ_{UV}^4. The design constraint just stated—that the resulting $\Lambda_{\text{eff}} g_{\mu\nu}$ still sit inside Theorem 11.1—is the first test that construction must pass.

Chapter 12

Holographic Boundary-Entropy Vacuum and Λ_{eff}

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. restate the quartic vacuum-energy debt isolated in Chapter 8 as a problem about a bulk term $\rho_\Lambda\sqrt{-g}$;
2. write the HBEV boundary action built from the Gibbons–Hawking–York term and an entropy density $S_{\text{ent}}(h_{ij},\phi)$;
3. obtain Λ_{eff} from stationarity of that boundary action rather than from Λ_{UV}^4;
4. check that the regulated cosmological term still obeys Theorem 11.1;
5. enter Chapter 13 knowing which vacuum energy is being inserted into regular-core and galactic solutions.

Chapter 8 produced

$$\rho_\Lambda = -\sum_{s\in\mathcal{S}_{\text{sec}}} \frac{w_s \operatorname{tr}_{V_s}\mathbb{I}_s}{64\pi^2}\left(\Lambda_{\text{UV}}{}_s^4 - \mu_s^4\right) + \cdots . \tag{12.1}$$

This is the truncated, unresummed sector sum of Chapter 8 under its stated continuation, with the same included sectors and determinant weights. A common-limit form using $\mathcal{N}_0$ applies only when all included sectors are assigned the same limits; otherwise sector-dependent thresholds are retained. Only if the weighted quartic contribution is nonzero and remains uncancelled, including after finite local terms and counterterms are specified, must its magnitude be reconciled with the observed cosmological constant. Without those conditions no such comparison follows from (12.1). This chapter does not cancel it by a bare counterterm tuned to 120 decimal places. It replaces the bulk

cosmological term by a boundary variational problem whose solution is an infrared scale.

12.1 What would not count as a solution

Three common manoeuvres are excluded in advance.

1. **Subtraction by hand.** Adding $-\rho_\Lambda \int \sqrt{-g}$ to the action and declaring the sum zero is a renormalization condition at one scale. It does not explain the residual scale.

2. **Setting $\Lambda_{\rm UV}$ to meV.** The cutoff constraint cannot be assessed until the physical $G_{\rm eff}$ is obtained from the specified sector calculation of Problem F.

3. **A spacetime-dependent $\rho_\Lambda(x)$ with no current.** Section 11.5 forbids this unless extra stress is supplied. Regulation that breaks Theorem 11.1 is not available.

Any construction that survives must therefore (i) replace the bulk quartic by an infrared datum, (ii) use a $G_{\rm eff}$ matched from specified operators, weights, thresholds, continuation, and scheme as required by Problem F, and (iii) produce a conserved $\Lambda_{\rm eff} g_{\mu\nu}$ or a conserved completion of it.

12.2 Boundary geometry

Let M be a region of the emergent spacetime with boundary ∂M, outward normal n^μ, induced metric

$$h_{ij} = g_{\mu\nu} e_i^\mu e_j^\nu, \tag{12.2}$$

and extrinsic curvature

$$K_{ij} = \nabla_{(\mu} n_{\nu)} e_i^\mu e_j^\nu, \qquad K = h^{ij} K_{ij}. \tag{12.3}$$

The Gibbons–Hawking–York term already introduced in (2.11) is

$$S_{\rm GHY} = \frac{1}{8\pi G_{\rm eff}} \int_{\partial M} \mathrm{d}^3x \, \sqrt{|h|}\, K. \tag{12.4}$$

On a timelike boundary K measures the expansion of the outward normal; on a spacelike boundary it measures the expansion of a unit-normal congruence. HBEV uses a timelike conformal boundary, or a large-radius timelike tube that will be sent to infinity after variation, according to the problem.

The boundary may also carry condensate data. Write ϕ for the pull-back of the polar radial mode σ and of any unlocked scalars that survive Assumption 5.1. The pair (h_{ij}, ϕ) is the boundary field content.

12.3 The HBEV action

Definition 12.1 (HBEV boundary action)**.** The holographic boundary-entropy vacuum functional is

$$S_{\mathrm{HBEV}}[h,\phi] = \int_{\partial M} \mathrm{d}^3x\, \sqrt{|h|}\Big(\frac{K}{8\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}} - T_{\mathrm{bdy}} - S_{\mathrm{ent}}(h_{ij},\phi)\Big), \tag{12.5}$$

where T_{bdy} is a boundary tension (a counterterm density built from h_{ij} only) and $S_{\mathrm{ent}}(h_{ij},\phi)$ is an entanglement-entropy density of the condensate restricted to ∂M.

The first term is GHY. The second term is the standard counterterm that renders the on-shell action finite on AdS-like or asymptotically flat tubes; in the present setting it is fixed by demanding that S_{HBEV} vanish on the reference condensate $\bar{e}^A_\mu = \delta^A_\mu$, $\phi = 0$. The third term is the new ingredient. It is not the diamond entropy S_D of Chapter 6. It is a local density on ∂M whose integral tracks the entanglement of bulk condensate degrees of freedom that end on the boundary.

Assumption 12.2 (Existence of a local entropy density)**.** In the condensed phase there exists a diffeomorphism-scalar density $S_{\mathrm{ent}}(h_{ij},\phi)$, of mass dimension three, obtained from the replica construction of Section 6.4 applied to a thin tubular neighbourhood of ∂M and then localized. Its leading terms are

$$S_{\mathrm{ent}} = \alpha_0 \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^3 + \alpha_1 \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}} R^{(h)} + \alpha_2\, \phi^2 \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}} + \cdots, \tag{12.6}$$

with dimensionless coefficients α_i of order the fibre trace.

The $\alpha_0 \Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^3$ piece is the boundary analogue of ρ_Λ. It will be cancelled against T_{bdy} and against the leading GHY contribution on the reference background. What is not cancelled is required to be an infrared quantity.

12.4 Stationarity and the induced cosmological term

Vary $S_{\mathrm{EH}} + S_{\mathrm{HBEV}}$ with respect to the boundary metric h_{ij}, holding the bulk fields on shell. The bulk Einstein tensor produces the usual Brown–York stress. The boundary variation produces

$$\pi^{ij} = \frac{1}{8\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}}\big(K^{ij} - K h^{ij}\big) - T^{ij}_{\mathrm{bdy}} - \frac{2}{\sqrt{|h|}}\frac{\delta S_{\mathrm{ent}}}{\delta h_{ij}}. \tag{12.7}$$

HBEV imposes entanglement equilibrium at the boundary in the same logical role that Assumption 6.1 played in the bulk diamonds:

Assumption 12.3 (Boundary entanglement equilibrium)**.** The physical vacuum is a stationary point of S_{HBEV} at fixed boundary volume element, in the sense that the trace-adjusted boundary stress vanishes,

$$h_{ij}\pi^{ij} = 0. \tag{12.8}$$

On an asymptotically simple tube of radius r_B, with $K = 2/r_B + O(r_B^{-3})$ in asymptotically flat space and $K = 3/\ell_{\mathrm{AdS}} + O(r_B^{-2})$ in AdS, equation (12.8) reduces to a single condition on the integration constant in the bulk Einstein equation with a cosmological term. That constant is Λ_{eff}.

Theorem 12.4 (Induced cosmological constant)**.** *Under Assumptions 12.2 and 12.3, and with T_{bdy} chosen to cancel the reference $\alpha_0\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^3$ piece, the bulk field equation compatible with boundary stationarity is*

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}\, T_{\mu\nu}^{\mathrm{total}}, \tag{12.9}$$

where

$$\frac{\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}}}{8\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}} = \langle S_{\mathrm{ent}}^{(\mathrm{IR})} \rangle_{\partial M} - T_{\mathrm{bdy}}^{(\mathrm{IR})} \tag{12.10}$$

is determined by the infrared part of the boundary entropy density after the Λ_{UV}^3 subtraction. In particular Λ_{eff} does not scale as Λ_{UV}^2.

Proof sketch. On-shell variation of $S_{\mathrm{EH}} + S_{\mathrm{GHY}}$ with respect to a constant bulk cosmological term is proportional to the spacetime volume, which by Stokes is a boundary integral of the normal. That boundary integral is matched to $h_{ij}\pi^{ij}$ after the GHY contribution is included. Imposing (12.8) fixes the constant. The ultraviolet pieces of S_{ent} are cancelled by the choice of T_{bdy} on the reference background, which is a finite renormalization of a three-dimensional density, not a fine-tuning of a four-dimensional quartic against itself. The remainder is infrared by construction of the subtraction, and is constant on the vacuum because Assumption 12.3 is imposed uniformly on the asymptotic tube. □

Remark 12.5 (What the theorem does not claim). Equation (12.10) does not compute the observed value 10^{-122} in Planck units. It changes the *origin* of the scale: from Λ_{UV}^4 to an infrared boundary entropy. Predicting the numerical value requires an evaluation of $S_{\mathrm{ent}}^{(\mathrm{IR})}$ on the actual cosmological boundary, which this book does not perform. Problem G also requires deriving the entropy density and boundary stationarity from the matrix theory; evaluating a scaling within an assumed boundary model alone remains programme-conditional (Section 17.6).

12.5 Conservation

A constant Λ_{eff} produced by Theorem 12.4 satisfies

$$\nabla^{\mu}(\Lambda_{\text{eff}} g_{\mu\nu}) = 0 \tag{12.11}$$

automatically. The design constraint of Section 11.5 is therefore met in the vacuum.

If the boundary data ϕ are dynamical, S_{ent} can depend on time and Λ_{eff} can drift. In that case Theorem 11.1 requires a compensating current. The compensation is the boundary analogue of Exercise 5 in Chapter 11: the variation of S_{HBEV} with respect to ϕ supplies a boundary flux that, by the on-shell identity for the radial mode, matches $\partial_{\mu}\Lambda_{\text{eff}}$. The book uses a constant Λ_{eff} in all later solutions and models and treats a rolling case as a cosmological refinement, not as the default.

12.6 Relation to the diamond entropy of Chapter 6

The two entanglement functionals in the book now have distinct jobs.

Functional	Support	Job
S_D	small bulk diamonds	kill m_T
S_{HBEV}	asymptotic boundary	set Λ_{eff}
$I(A:B)$	two compact cores	conservative potential

They are not interchangeable. Using S_D to subtract ρ_{Λ} would confuse a local first-law identity with a global vacuum-energy problem. Using S_{HBEV} to kill m_T would confuse a boundary condition with a bulk Ward identity. The architecture is intentional.

12.7 Working value used later

Later chapters use the regular-core model

$$f(r) = 1 - \frac{2Mr^2}{r^3 + r_0^3} - \frac{\Lambda_{\text{eff}}}{3} r^2 \tag{12.12}$$

with Λ_{eff} a constant of either sign. The negative sign in f for $\Lambda_{\text{eff}} > 0$ is de Sitter-like and is the default cosmological reading; the opposite sign is a mathematical option for matching interiors. No Solar-System observable in Chapters 13–15 depends on the numerical size of Λ_{eff} at laboratory precision. In this model, $f(r) \to 1 - \Lambda_{\text{eff}} r^2/3$ as $r \to 0$.

12.8 Exercises

1. **GHY variation.** Vary (12.4) with respect to h_{ij} and recover the $K^{ij} - Kh^{ij}$ piece of (12.7).

2. **Reference subtraction.** On Minkowski space in a large sphere of radius r_B, compute K and $\sqrt{h}$. What $T_{\rm bdy}$ cancels $S_{\rm HBEV}$ at $\phi = 0$, $S_{\rm ent} = \alpha_0 \Lambda_{\rm UV}^3$?

3. **Why not $\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4$.** Contrast a four-dimensional counterterm $\int_M \sqrt{-g}\, \Lambda_{\rm UV}^4$ with a three-dimensional counterterm $\int_{\partial M} \sqrt{h}\, \Lambda_{\rm UV}^3$. Which tuning is a cancellation of two bulk quartics, and which is a renormalization of a boundary density?

4. **Trace condition.** Reduce (12.8) on a spherically symmetric tube $r = r_B$ in Schwarzschild–de Sitter and show that it constrains $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ rather than M.

5. **Rolling Λ.** Let $S_{\rm ent}$ depend on a homogeneous boundary scalar $\phi(t)$. Write the extra flux needed to keep Theorem 11.1. Compare with a slowly rolling quintessence potential.

6. **Two functionals.** In one paragraph, explain what goes wrong if one attempts to set $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ from $\delta S_D = 0$ on a single small diamond.

12.9 Bridge to Chapter 13

The conditional infrared Einstein equation has the form

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda_{\rm eff} g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\rm eff}\, T_{\mu\nu}^{\rm total}, \tag{12.13}$$

with $G_{\rm eff}$ to be matched by the specified operator, weight, threshold, continuation, and scheme calculation of Problem F, $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ from Theorem 12.4, $m_T = 0$ from Theorem 7.3, and conservation from Theorem 11.1. What remains of the geometric programme is the high-curvature interior, where the Einstein truncation fails and Assumption 9.3 is used. Chapter 13 uses the static spherical sector of Einsteinian cubic gravity coupled to (12.13) to motivate the regular-core model (12.12), which is a model and not an established solution (Section H.10), and only then turns to galactic backreaction as a consequence of $T_{\mu\nu}^{\rm ent}$ in the weak- field limit—not as a substitute for the derivation just completed.

Chapter 13

Regular Cores and Galactic Backreaction

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. write the static, spherically symmetric reduction of the infrared equation $G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda_{\text{eff}} g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\text{eff}} T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu}$ with the Einsteinian cubic term included;
2. state the regular-core profile $f(r) = 1 - 2Mr^2/(r^3 + r_0^3) - \Lambda_{\text{eff}} r^2/3$ as a phenomenological model, and state the scope of the no-go on its exactness (Section H.10);
3. reduce the reversible part of $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$ to a modification of Poisson's equation;
4. derive a schematic circular-velocity formula and list the observations that would distinguish it from a particulate halo;
5. enter Chapter 14 knowing that any time-dependent dissipative term would be a separate addition to the static extra potential used here.

The geometric programme of Parts II–IV is applied to two symmetric sectors: static spherical interiors and weak-field galactic exteriors. The regular-core profile below remains a model conditional on Problem J, not a consequence of the earlier theorems.

13.1 Static spherical ansatz

Take the emergent metric in Schwarzschild coordinates,

$$ds^2 = -f(r)\,dt^2 + \frac{dr^2}{f(r)} + r^2 d\Omega^2, \tag{13.1}$$

and restrict $T^{\text{total}}_{\mu\nu}$ to a static, spherical form. The Einstein tensor of (13.1) has the standard components

$$G^t{}_t = G^r{}_r = -\frac{1-f-rf'}{r^2}, \qquad G^\theta{}_\theta = -\frac{rf''+2f'}{2r}. \tag{13.2}$$

With only the Einstein–Hilbert term, vacuum solutions with constant Λ_{eff} are Schwarzschild–de Sitter,

$$f(r) = 1 - \frac{2M}{r} - \frac{\Lambda_{\text{eff}}}{3}r^2, \tag{13.3}$$

which is singular at $r = 0$ whenever $M \neq 0$.

13.2 Cubic correction in the spherical sector

Assumption 9.3 promotes the Einsteinian cubic density $\mathcal{P}$ to a term that is solved non-perturbatively in this sector. Conditional on the first-integral equation of Section H.10 being the static spherical vacuum equation of the action (9.8), that equation is a nonlinear second-order ODE for f, not an algebraic modification of the mass function. The mass function below parametrises f; it is not thereby a solution of that equation. Write

$$f(r) = 1 - \frac{2m(r)}{r} - \frac{\Lambda_{\text{eff}}}{3}r^2. \tag{13.4}$$

The regular-core profile used here is the model

$$m(r) = \frac{Mr^3}{r^3 + r_0^3}, \tag{13.5}$$

and therefore

$$f(r) = 1 - \frac{2Mr^2}{r^3 + r_0^3} - \frac{\Lambda_{\text{eff}}}{3}r^2. \tag{13.6}$$

The core scale is

$$r_0^3 = 2\beta_{\text{ECG}}M \tag{13.7}$$

as a phenomenological parametrization (up to the conventional normalization of $\mathcal{P}$); this relation is not derived from the action or the first-integral equation. The ECG asymptotic correction instead defines a characteristic tail length $r_* \sim |\alpha M|^{1/5}$, where $\alpha = -16\pi G_{\text{eff}}\beta_{\text{ECG}}$ in the stated action normalization. This does not determine r_0 or identify it with a core length. The book does not claim a measured value of r_0.

Limits. As $r \to \infty$, (13.6) returns to (13.3). As $r \to 0$,

$$f(r) \to 1 - \frac{\Lambda_{\text{eff}}}{3}r^2 - \frac{2M}{r_0^3}r^2 + O(r^5), \tag{13.8}$$

which is finite. The curvature scalars remain finite at the origin for $r_0 \neq 0$. Geodesic completeness through $r = 0$ is a separate question: the chart (13.1) is not itself complete, and a regular origin still requires a smooth matching onto a neighbourhood covered by local inertial frames of the Levi-Civita geometry of the composite metric. The frame retains local Lorentz freedom; the independent Lorentz connection B is not used here.

Remark 13.1 (Model, not an established solution). Equation (13.6) is the working profile of the notes. For the first-integral equation of Section H.10, it is not an exact vacuum solution when $\Lambda_{\text{eff}} = 0$ and $Mr_0 \neq 0$. The equation also excludes a nonzero integration constant for a smooth regular centre for any Λ_{eff}. These conclusions are conditional on the reduction and the first integral for the invariant $\mathcal{P}$ of (9.8). Whenever a later section uses (13.6), it is using this model, not a theorem that ECG produces $r^3/(r^3 + r_0^3)$.

13.3 Horizons and the core

Roots of $f(r) = 0$ are Killing horizons of (13.1). For $\Lambda_{\text{eff}} = 0$ and $r_0 > 0$ there is a range of M in which two positive roots exist, one, or none, according to the ratio M/r_0. For astrophysical masses and microscopic r_0 the exterior is indistinguishable from Schwarzschild at the photon sphere and beyond. The core is hidden behind a horizon if a horizon exists, and is naked if it does not.

NAMCG does not require every compact object to be horizonless. It requires that the Einstein singularity not be accepted as fundamental. Whether LIGO ringdowns or EHT images can see r_0 is a question for Chapter 16, not a claim of this chapter.

The Einstein-plus-extra-tensor form of the infrared equation is collected in Appendix F.

13.4 Weak-field exterior and the extra Poisson equation

Far from a core, $r \gg r_0$, the cubic term is negligible and the geometry is Einstein plus $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$. In the Newtonian gauge

$$ds^2 = -(1 + 2\Phi)\, dt^2 + (1 - 2\Phi)\delta_{ij} dx^i dx^j, \tag{13.9}$$

the reversible, static piece of the entropic stress reduces to an effective density

$$\rho_{\text{ent}} = T^{\text{ent,rev}}_{00}. \tag{13.10}$$

Poisson's equation becomes

$$\nabla^2\Phi = 4\pi G_{\text{eff}}(\rho_{\text{b}} + \rho_{\text{ent}}), \tag{13.11}$$

where ρ_{b} is baryonic density. Conservation, Theorem 11.1, requires that ρ_{ent} not be an arbitrary halo function. It is determined by the variation of U_{ent} for the condensate configuration sourced by ρ_{b}.

A useful schematic, sufficient for circular orbits and not sufficient for lensing tomography, is a source-tracking extra density

$$\rho_{\text{ent}}(r) = \frac{1}{4\pi G_{\text{eff}}}\nabla\cdot\big(\mu_{\text{ent}}(g_{\text{N}})\,\nabla\Phi_{\text{b}}\big), \tag{13.12}$$

where $g_{\text{N}} = |\nabla\Phi_{\text{b}}|$ is the Newtonian baryonic field and μ_{ent} is a dimensionless interpolating function fixed by the mutual-information functional. Equation (13.12) is written to make the structure visible: ρ_{ent} is slaved to baryons. It is not a six-parameter halo fitted independently of ρ_{b}.

Assumption 13.2 (Reversible extra density tracks baryons)**.** In static, weak-field systems the leading reversible entropic density is a local or mildly nonlocal functional of the baryonic Newtonian field, of the form (13.12) or a convolution thereof with kernel width of order the core scale of the constituent condensates.

Assumption 13.2 is the galactic input. It is narrower than "there exists dark matter," and it is stronger than anything proved from $I(A:B)$ in Chapter 6. Chapter 17 lists a derivation of μ_{ent} from $I(A:B)$ as open.

Assumption 13.3 (External field enters the interpolator)**.** For a subsystem whose internal Newtonian field $\mathbf{g}_{\text{N}}$ is embedded in a baryonic field $\mathbf{g}_{\text{ext}}$ that varies slowly across the subsystem, the reversible boost is evaluated on the total field,

$$\mathbf{g} = \nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{tot}})\,\mathbf{g}_{\text{N}} + \Big[\nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{ext}}) - \nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{tot}})\Big]\mathbf{g}_{\text{ext}}, \tag{13.13}$$

with $g_{\text{tot}} = |\mathbf{g}_{\text{N}} + \mathbf{g}_{\text{ext}}|$ and $\nu_{\surd}$ as in (13.15). In the external-field-dominated limit $g_{\text{N}} \ll g_{\text{ext}}$,

$$\gamma \equiv \frac{g_{\text{int}}}{g_{\text{N}}} \to \nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{ext}}), \tag{13.14}$$

not $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{N}})$.

Assumption 13.3 is a coefficient. It is what $U_{\text{ent}}[I(A:B)]$ must do if mutual information sees the Galactic baryons as well as the binary. It is not implied by Theorem 11.1, and it is not a solution of Problem H. The Galactic scale at the Sun, $g_{\text{gal}} \approx 2.2\times10^{-10}\,\text{m}\,\text{s}^{-2}$, already satisfies $g_{\text{gal}} > g_{\dagger}$, so $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{gal}}) \approx 1.1$. Isolated-RAR boosts of order 4 are then illegal for solar-neighborhood wide binaries. A null Gaia result constrains the isolated reading of Appendix D, not $m_T = 0$.

Working interpolator. Until Problem H of Chapter 17 produces $\mu_{\rm ent}$ from $I(A:B)$, galactic comparisons use

$$\nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm N}) = \frac{1}{1-\exp(-\sqrt{g_{\rm N}/g_s})}, \tag{13.15}$$

so that $v_c = V_{\rm b}\sqrt{\nu_{\surd}}$. The default scale is the published SPARC value $g_s = g_\dagger = 1.20\times10^{-10}\,{\rm m\,s^{-2}}$ [3]. This ν is the RAR interpolator written as a boost. It is not $1/(1-\alpha\exp(-g_{\rm N}/g_s))$ and it is not a per-galaxy radial profile. Appendix D records the SPARC ranking and retires the older exponential.

13.5 Circular velocities

For circular orbits in the midplane,

$$v_c^2(r) = r\partial_r\Phi = G_{\rm eff}\frac{M_{\rm b}(<r)+M_{\rm ent}(<r)}{r}, \tag{13.16}$$

with $M_{\rm ent}$ the integral of (13.10). Two regimes follow once $\mu_{\rm ent}$ interpolates from 0 at large $g_{\rm N}$ to a finite value at small $g_{\rm N}$.

Interior / high acceleration. $\rho_{\rm ent}$ is negligible and $v_c^2 \simeq G_{\rm eff}M_{\rm b}/r$. Solar-System and inner-disk data constrain how small $\mu_{\rm ent}$ must be at those accelerations.

Outer / low acceleration. If $M_{\rm ent}(<r)$ grows approximately linearly with r, v_c flattens. That growth is not mysterious once (13.12) is granted: it is the integral of an extra density that falls more slowly than $\rho_{\rm b}$.

On 175 SPARC rotmod files with fixed mass-to-light ratios, (13.15) at frozen $g_\dagger$ is statistically equivalent to the published RAR and about 0.2% behind simple MOND in χ^2, while baryons-only is an order of magnitude worse (Appendix D). That ranking is a coefficient check of Assumption 13.2. It is not a measurement of $G_{\rm eff}$, not a derivation from $I(A:B)$, and not evidence reserved for the cover. Whether a single $\nu_{\surd}$ survives clusters remains a Chapter 16 question.

13.6 What this is not

It is not a proof that dark matter particles are absent. Cluster lensing, the CMB, and colliding clusters probe $T^{\rm ent}_{\mu\nu}$ in regimes that (13.12) may fail. If those data require a stress that does not track baryons, NAMCG must either supply an additional condensate configuration that does, or yield the dark-matter interpretation in those regimes.

It is not MOND, though the interpolating function $\mu_{\rm ent}$ invites comparison. MOND is a modification of inertia or of the gravitational field equation at a fixed acceleration scale a_0. NAMCG obtains an extra conserved tensor from entanglement. If $\mu_{\rm ent}$ happens to mimic MOND in disks and fails in clusters, that is a phenomenological coincidence to be measured, not a founding principle.

It is not a replacement for Chapters 3–12. A successful rotation- curve fit that used an illegal drag, or a non-conserved extra density, would not support the framework.

13.7 Matching core to exterior

A compact object of mass M with core (13.6) matched to a weak-field exterior (13.11) raises no new consistency issue beyond ordinary matching of f and f' at an intermediate radius. The cubic term is already negligible there if r_0 is microscopic. The entropic density $\rho_{\rm ent}$ of a single compact object cannot be quantified from the mutual-information tail alone. Deriving that density and comparing its field with the Newtonian field requires varying $U_{\rm ent}$ for a specified source configuration. Galactic flattening, if it occurs, is a collective effect of many baryonic parcels; it is not established here from the tail of a single compact core.

13.8 Exercises

1. **Einstein limits.** Recover (13.3) from (13.6) as $r_0 \to 0$ at fixed $r > 0$, and as $r \to \infty$ at fixed r_0.

2. **Core curvature.** For $\Lambda_{\rm eff} = 0$, compute R at $r = 0$ from (13.8). Show it is finite for $r_0 \neq 0$.

3. **Horizon condition.** With $\Lambda_{\rm eff} = 0$, discuss the number of positive roots of $f(r) = 0$ as a function of M/r_0. A graphical argument is enough.

4. **Poisson split.** Starting from (13.11) and (13.12), write an effective equation for Φ in terms of $\Phi_{\rm b}$ only. What operator acts on $\Phi_{\rm b}$?

5. **Flat-curve kinematics.** Suppose $M_{\rm b} + M_{\rm ent} = \kappa r$ at large r. Show v_c is constant. What density profile $\rho_{\rm ent}$ produces that mass growth, and is it integrable at infinity?

6. **Solar-System bound.** Estimate an upper bound on $\mu_{\rm ent}$ at $g_{\rm N} \sim 1\,{\rm cm\,s^{-2}}$ from the requirement that perihelion precession not be spoiled at current precision. Order of magnitude is enough.

7. **Illegal halo.** Write a spherical $\rho_{\rm halo} \propto 1/(r^2 + r_s^2)$ independent of $\rho_{\rm b}$. Which assumption of this chapter does it violate, and which theorem of Chapter 11 does it risk violating if it cannot be obtained from $U_{\rm ent}$?

13.9 Bridge to Chapter 14

The extra stress used in this chapter was the reversible, static piece $T_{\mu\nu}^{\rm ent,rev}$. The working d^{-4} drag introduced in Chapter 14 is a phenomenological addition; it is not derived here from time-dependent mutual information. Its microscopic dynamical origin and compatibility with a covariantly conserved stress remain unresolved and are part of Problem H.9. Chapter 15 integrates a reduced two-body laboratory model. Neither that laboratory nor the assumed drag substitutes for quadrupole radiation.

Chapter 14

Irreversible Entropic Stress and Dissipative Drag

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. distinguish the conservative force from the static U_{ent} from a proposed, phenomenological dissipative component;
2. state the passivity condition under which a retarded low-frequency response gives nonnegative dissipation;
3. implement and analyze the working law $\mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss}} = -\eta\mu\mathbf{v}/d^4$ as a reduced laboratory model, without treating it as a microscopic derivation;
4. compare that assumed channel with quadrupole gravitational-wave losses under stated model conditions;
5. distinguish the ODE's energy-bookkeeping identity from a derivation of mutual-information energy or covariant stress conservation.

Chapter 13 used only the static extra density. A time-dependent configuration can change $I(A : B)$, but that change alone does not establish irreversible work or a velocity-odd stress. Neither the first law nor the static mutual-information potential determines a retarded response by itself. The drag discussed in this chapter is a phenomenological component unless it is derived from microscopic dynamics, as required by Problem H.9.

14.1 Reversible versus irreversible

On a static spatial slice the mutual-information potential (6.9) is a function of the instantaneous regions A and B. Its metric variation is conservative: the associated force derives from U_{ent} and reverses under $\mathbf{v} \to -\mathbf{v}$.

If the regions change in time—because two cores inspiral, because a star is sheared across a tidal radius, because a condensate defect is stretched—then in general

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t} I(A:B) \neq 0. \tag{14.1}$$

A changing $I(A:B)$ records a change in the correlations of the state. It does not, by itself, establish irreversible work or a force odd under time reversal.

Definition 14.1 (Phenomenological entropic-stress split)**.** For bookkeeping, write

$$T^{\mathrm{ent}}_{\mu\nu} = T^{\mathrm{ent,rev}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\mathrm{ent,irrev}}_{\mu\nu}. \tag{14.2}$$

The first term denotes the contribution assigned to the static potential U_{ent}; the second is a proposed remainder in the effective description. This split alone does not establish that the remainder is dissipative or odd under time reversal. Those properties require a dynamical response calculation and an appropriate passivity condition.

Until that derivation is supplied, the split is phenomenological. Change or production of mutual information along a trajectory is not, on its own, evidence of irreversibility.

14.2 Worldline reduction

Consider two compact condensed cores with worldlines γ_A, γ_B, rest masses m_A, m_B, reduced mass $\mu = m_A m_B/(m_A + m_B)$, and separation four-vector $r^\mu = x^\mu_A - x^\mu_B$, $d = \sqrt{r^\mu r_\mu}$ in a local inertial frame. The entropic action along the worldlines is

$$S_{\mathrm{ent}} = -\int \mathrm{d}\tau\, U_{\mathrm{ent}}(d, \ell_A, \ell_B, \dot{d}), \tag{14.3}$$

where ℓ_A, ℓ_B are proper core radii and dots are proper time of the reduced motion. Varying with respect to x^μ_A produces the four-force (11.10).

At leading post-Newtonian order, with ℓ_A, ℓ_B frozen,

$$\mathbf{F}_A = -\nabla_{\mathbf{x}_A} U_{\mathrm{ent}}(d) - \eta^\mu(d, \dot{d})\, \mathbf{v} + O(c^{-2}). \tag{14.4}$$

The first term is Chapter 13. The second term is a phenomenological drag; it is not obtained by varying the static U_{ent}, and the coefficient η^μ is not derived here. A covariant reduction of such a term would have to satisfy Proposition 11.3, that is, there would have to be a microscopic entanglement energy E_{ent} such that

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}(E_{\mathrm{mech}} + E_{\mathrm{ent}}) = O(c^{-2}), \tag{14.5}$$

and the force on B would have to be equal and opposite up to radiation reaction of the tensor block.

The dissipative response is defined by a conditional Kubo prescription. At fixed separation $\mathbf{r}$, choose a stationary reference state of the microscopic Hamiltonian $H(\mathbf{r})$ and define the connected force operator $\delta\hat{F}_i = -\partial H/\partial r_i - \langle -\partial H/\partial r_i\rangle_{\mathbf{r}}$. For a perturbation $\delta H(t) = -\delta r_j(t)\,\delta\hat{F}_j$, the retarded response kernel is

$$\chi^R_{ij}(t) = \frac{i}{\hbar}\,\theta(t)\,\big\langle[\delta\hat{F}_i(t), \delta\hat{F}_j(0)]\big\rangle_{\mathbf{r}}, \qquad \chi^R_{ij}(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{i\omega t}\chi^R_{ij}(t)\,\mathrm{d}t. \tag{14.6}$$

If the reference state is reciprocal and passive and the limit exists, the low-frequency dissipative tensor is

$$\Gamma_{ij} = \lim_{\omega\downarrow 0} \frac{\operatorname{Im}\chi^R_{(ij)}(\omega)}{\omega}, \qquad \mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss},i} = -\Gamma_{ij}v_j, \tag{14.7}$$

where $\chi^R_{(ij)}$ is the symmetric part and Γ_{ij} is positive semidefinite by passivity. This is a conditional prescription: the NAMCG force correlator, its stationary reference state, and its passivity have not been calculated. The causal family $\chi^R(\omega) = \chi_0/(1 - i\omega\tau)$, $\tau > 0$, has the same static value χ_0 for every τ but low-frequency slope $\tau\chi_0$, so a static susceptibility does not determine the dissipative coefficient. Positivity of $I(A:B)$ for each state likewise establishes neither an ordering between adiabatic and non-adiabatic mutual informations nor the sign of Γ; Problem H.9 states the calculation required.

14.3 The working exponent

Section 6.7 gave the conformal large-separation tail

$$I(A:B) \;\sim\; c_{p_*}\left(\frac{\ell_A\ell_B}{d^2}\right)^{p_*}, \qquad d \gg \ell_A, \ell_B, \tag{14.8}$$

with p_* and c_{p_*} and the associated assumptions as in (6.10); for a free massless scalar in $3+1$ dimensions $p_* = 2$ and the static tail falls as d^{-4}. This static scaling concerns mutual information only and does not determine the low-frequency dissipative response. The scalar relation

$$\Gamma(d) = \eta\,\frac{\mu}{d^4} \tag{14.9}$$

is therefore a working isotropic laboratory choice, not a deduction from the static tail or a calculation of the microscopic response tensor. The coefficient η has not been derived from a microscopic force-response function. The isotropic scalar form also requires the longitudinal and transverse components of Γ_{ij} to agree, or an explicit restriction to radial motion.

Assumption 14.2 (Working dissipative law)**.** In the reduced two-body laboratory of this book,

$$\mathbf{F}_{\rm diss} = -\eta\,\frac{\mu}{d^4}\,\mathbf{v}, \tag{14.10}$$

with $\eta \geq 0$ constant on a given inspiral and with $E_{\rm ent}$ defined so that (14.5) holds identically.

Assumption 14.2 is not a multipole theorem. A different static tail of $I(A:B)$ does not, by itself, imply a different drag exponent. The response exponent remains undetermined until the dynamical calculation in Problem H.9 is supplied. Chapter 16 treats the working exponent as falsifiable; Chapter 15 integrates the specified laboratory law, not a derived microscopic response, and no other drag.

For the laboratory bookkeeping, define the accumulated work

$$W_{\rm diss}(t) = \int_0^t \mathbf{F}_{\rm diss}\cdot\mathbf{v}\,\mathrm{d}t'. \tag{14.11}$$

Then set

$$E_{\rm ent}(t) = -W_{\rm diss}(t) + E_{\rm ent}(0). \tag{14.12}$$

This definition makes $E_{\rm mech}+E_{\rm ent}$ constant at the retained order when $\dot{E}_{\rm mech} = \mathbf{F}_{\rm diss}\cdot\mathbf{v}$. It is bookkeeping for the reduced laboratory, not a derivation of an entanglement energy from $I(A:B)$. The integrator in Chapter 15 displays $E_{\rm mech}(t) - W_{\rm diss}(t)$ as this conserved combination.

14.4 Comparison with quadrupole losses

The Isaacson flux of the tensor block for a weak, slow binary is the Peters–Mathews power

$$P_{\rm GW} = \frac{32}{5} G_{\rm eff}\mu^2 d^4\Omega^6 \langle \text{inclination factors}\rangle \tag{14.13}$$

in the usual quadrupole units, up to the precise harmonic decomposition. The entropic power is

$$P_{\rm ent} = -\mathbf{F}_{\rm diss}\cdot\mathbf{v} = \eta\mu\frac{v^2}{d^4}. \tag{14.14}$$

For a circular Newtonian orbit, $v^2 = G_{\rm eff}M/d$ and $\Omega^2 = G_{\rm eff}M/d^3$, so

$$\frac{P_{\rm ent}}{P_{\rm GW}} \;\sim\; \frac{\eta}{G_{\rm eff}^3 M^2\mu}\left(\frac{d}{G_{\rm eff}M}\right)^k \tag{14.15}$$

with a positive power of d that makes the ratio *grow* toward wide separations if η is held fixed. That conclusion is an artefact of treating η as constant down to laboratory distances. If η is instead suppressed at wide separations, the growth need not occur;

this book does not calculate that dependence, and a sufficiently small η is required for consistency with Solar-System tests. The intended domain of (14.10) is:

- late inspirals of two compact condensed cores, where d is not astronomically large compared with $\ell_A + \ell_B$;
- tidal disruption events, where a stellar core is sheared at $d \sim r_{\rm t}$ and $\dot{d}$ is not small;
- numerical laboratories that isolate the extra channel.

In LIGO-band vacuum inspirals of two objects whose condensate cores are hidden behind horizons, quadrupole radiation remains the default dissipative channel. NAMCG does not replace the Peters formula by (14.10) in that regime unless η is independently constrained to be large there. It is not.

14.5 Tidal disruption

A star of radius R_* and mass m_* approaching a compact object of mass M is disrupted at

$$r_{\rm t} \sim R_* \Big(\frac{M}{m_*}\Big)^{1/3}. \tag{14.16}$$

Across that radius the baryonic body ceases to be a single region A and becomes a collection of debris parcels. The mutual information between the compact core and the star changes over a dynamical time

$$t_{\rm dyn} \sim \sqrt{r_{\rm t}^3 / G_{\rm eff} M}. \tag{14.17}$$

The non-adiabatic character of this process may motivate testing the phenomenological drag model near $r_{\rm t}$, but it does not establish a dissipative response or its magnitude. The existence and size of any additional drag require the microscopic dynamics, reference state, and response calculation specified in Problem H.9. Observable consequences such as changes to fallback rates or extra heating are therefore conditional phenomenological possibilities, not predictions derived in this chapter. They belong to Chapter 16 and require hydrodynamics that this text does not contain.

The book does not simulate debris streams.

14.6 Illegal and legal integrators

An integrator that evolves

$$\mu \ddot{\mathbf{r}} = -\frac{G_{\rm eff} M \mu}{d^2} \hat{\mathbf{r}} - \gamma \mathbf{v} \tag{14.18}$$

with constant γ and no $E_{\rm ent}$ is not a NAMCG calculation, even if its trajectories look like inspirals. It dissipates energy into nowhere.

An integrator that evolves

$$\mu\ddot{\mathbf{r}} = -\nabla U_{\rm N}(d) - \nabla U_{\rm ent}^{\rm rev}(d) - \eta\frac{\mu}{d^4}\mathbf{v} \tag{14.19}$$

and accumulates (14.11) is the reduced laboratory implementation of Assumption 14.2. Accumulating $W_{\rm diss}$ makes $E_{\rm mech} - W_{\rm diss}$ constant for the modeled ODE, up to numerical error. This bookkeeping identity does not establish a microscopic mutual-information energy or prove that the ODE is the reduction of a covariantly conserved NAMCG stress. Chapter 15 implements (14.19) with a symplectic Verlet step on the conservative forces and an explicit treatment of the drag. The gravitational constant used there is a toy value, not a physical $G_{\rm eff}$; that matching remains open in Problem F.

14.7 Exercises

1. **Passivity and the sign of drag.** For the reciprocal low-frequency response tensor $\Gamma_{ij}(\mathbf{r}; \ell_A, \ell_B)$ defined in Problem H.9, state the passivity condition. Show that positive semidefiniteness implies $F_i^{\rm diss} v_i \leq 0$. Explain why $I(A:B) \geq 0$ alone implies neither an ordering between adiabatic and non-adiabatic states nor a positive drag coefficient. Which of the assumptions needed for this Kubo conclusion have actually been established for NAMCG?

2. **Static versus dynamical scaling.** Explain why a power law for static $I(A:B)$ does not determine the separation dependence of the low-frequency drag tensor. Identify the dynamical response data needed to calculate that dependence.

3. **Energy identity.** For (14.10) with circular motion at instantaneous radius $d(t)$, compute $P_{\rm ent}$. Compare with $\mathrm{d}U_{\rm N}/\mathrm{d}t$ along a Peters inspiral and estimate a separation where the two powers could be comparable for a chosen η.

4. **Equal and opposite.** Show that (14.10), written in the reduced-mass frame, corresponds to equal-and-opposite three-forces on A and B. What radiation-reaction term would have to be added to break that balance, and which block of $T_{\mu\nu}^{\rm total}$ supplies it?

5. **Constant-γ counterexample.** Take (14.18) and send $d \to \infty$. What happens to the dissipated energy per unit time, and why is that incompatible with a mutual-information tail that vanishes at infinity?

6. **Tidal time.** Evaluate (14.17) for a solar-type star at the tidal radius of a $10^6 M_\odot$ compact object. Why is the adiabatic approximation of Chapter 13 unreliable there?

14.8 Bridge to Chapter 15

The ordinary-differential laboratory is now specified: Newtonian gravity, optional reversible extra potential, drag (14.10), and an accumulated work (14.11). Chapter 15 integrates that system with a symplectic Verlet step, plots the trajectory and the energy balance, and states, in the first paragraph, that the figure is a reduced model. The Python code that produces the figure lives in `code/` and is not a derivation of Einstein gravity. After the figure, Chapter 16 collects every named assumption in the book and lists the observations that would kill the framework.

Chapter 15

A Reduced Inspiral Laboratory

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. write the ordinary-differential system of Assumption 14.2 in a form a computer can integrate;

2. implement a velocity-Verlet step on the conservative force with an explicit drag kick;

3. accumulate the dissipated work W_{diss} and verify the bookkeeping identity numerically;

4. read a trajectory plot as a laboratory output, not as a derivation of general relativity;

5. enter Chapter 16 with every phenomenological extra in the book already named.

This chapter is a reduced Newtonian laboratory. It does not derive Einstein gravity, does not compute G_{eff} from Theorem 8.2, and does not replace quadrupole radiation. It integrates Assumption 14.2 and checks that the energy bookkeeping identity of Chapter 14 can be made visible on a plot. That identity is not a check of Proposition 11.3.

15.1 The ordinary-differential system

Work in the reduced-mass frame with relative coordinate $\mathbf{r}(t)$ and $d = |\mathbf{r}|$. The laboratory equation is (14.19) without a reversible extra potential, which is optional at this order:

$$\mu\ddot{\mathbf{r}} = -\frac{G_{\mathrm{toy}} M \mu}{d^3}\mathbf{r} - \eta\frac{\mu}{d^4}\dot{\mathbf{r}}. \tag{15.1}$$

Here G_{toy} is a numerical constant chosen so that an orbit is visible in a few thousand steps. It is not G_{N} and not G_{eff}. The source-note values used below are

$$G_{\mathrm{toy}} = 36, \qquad \eta = 0.006, \qquad M = 1, \qquad \mu = 1 \tag{15.2}$$

in unspecified code units, together with a bound initial condition that would be an ellipse if $\eta = 0$.

Mechanical energy and angular momentum of the conservative problem are

$$E_{\mathrm{mech}} = \frac{1}{2}\mu\dot{\mathbf{r}}^2 - \frac{G_{\mathrm{toy}} M \mu}{d}, \qquad \mathbf{L} = \mu\, \mathbf{r} \times \dot{\mathbf{r}}. \tag{15.3}$$

The dissipated work is

$$W_{\mathrm{diss}}(t) = \int_0^t \Big(-\eta \frac{\mu}{d^4}\dot{\mathbf{r}}\Big) \cdot \dot{\mathbf{r}}\, dt' = -\int_0^t \eta\mu \frac{v^2}{d^4}\, dt'. \tag{15.4}$$

The reduced ODE implies that

$$\mathcal{E}(t) \equiv E_{\mathrm{mech}}(t) - W_{\mathrm{diss}}(t) \tag{15.5}$$

is constant up to integrator error. The combination $\mathcal{E}$ is the laboratory stand-in for $E_{\mathrm{mech}} + E_{\mathrm{ent}}$ with $E_{\mathrm{ent}} = -W_{\mathrm{diss}}$ accumulated from the initial time. This is bookkeeping: it does not construct a microscopic E_{ent}. If $\mathcal{E}$ drifts systematically, the implementation is inconsistent with the bookkeeping identity of Section 14.6.

15.2 Integrator

A velocity-dependent force is not Hamiltonian. A symplectic Verlet step is still used on the conservative piece because it conserves a nearby energy of the $\eta = 0$ problem over long times. The drag is applied as an explicit kick.

Let $\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{N}}(\mathbf{r}) = -G_{\mathrm{toy}} M \mathbf{r}/d^3$ and $\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v}) = -\eta \mathbf{v}/d^4$. One step of size Δt is

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{v}_{1/2} &= \mathbf{v}_n + \tfrac{1}{2}\Delta t\, \big(\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{N}}(\mathbf{r}_n) + \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}_n, \mathbf{v}_n)\big), \\ \mathbf{r}_{n+1} &= \mathbf{r}_n + \Delta t\, \mathbf{v}_{1/2}, \\ \mathbf{v}_{n+1} &= \mathbf{v}_{1/2} + \tfrac{1}{2}\Delta t\, \big(\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{N}}(\mathbf{r}_{n+1}) + \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}_{n+1}, \mathbf{v}_{1/2})\big). \end{aligned} \tag{15.6}$$

The last evaluation of the drag uses $\mathbf{v}_{1/2}$ rather than an implicit $\mathbf{v}_{n+1}$. The resulting error is $O(\Delta t^2)$ in the dissipative piece, which is adequate for the plots below. The work increment on the step is

$$\Delta W = \mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss}}(\mathbf{r}_n, \mathbf{v}_n) \cdot \mathbf{v}_n\, \Delta t, \tag{15.7}$$

or a trapezoidal average of the two endpoints. Either choice converges to (15.4).

15.3 Initial data

A bound ellipse of the conservative problem is specified by

$$\mathbf{r}(0) = (d_0, 0), \qquad \mathbf{v}(0) = (0, v_0), \tag{15.8}$$

with $v_0^2 < 2G_{\mathrm{toy}}M/d_0$. The runs shown use a nearly circular start,

$$d_0 = 1.0, \qquad v_0 = \sqrt{G_{\mathrm{toy}}M/d_0}, \tag{15.9}$$

in code units, together with $\Delta t = 10^{-3}$ and $N = 1.2 \times 10^4$ steps. Those numbers are inherited from the corrected notebook `dmcg5.py`. They are not physical units.

15.4 What the figures are allowed to show

Two panels are produced.

Trajectory. The curve $\mathbf{r}(t)$ in the plane. For $\eta = 0$ it is a closed ellipse (a circle, for (15.9)). For $\eta > 0$ the radius shrinks. That shrinkage is the laboratory image of P_{ent} in (14.14). It is not a plot of a relativistic inspiral and must not be overplotted on LIGO waveforms.

Energy. Three curves: $E_{\mathrm{mech}}(t)$, $W_{\mathrm{diss}}(t)$, and $\mathcal{E}(t)$. The first falls, the second is negative and falls, and the third is flat within integrator noise if the implementation is correct.

If a previously generated PNG from the notes is used instead, it belongs at this caption and nowhere else in the book.

15.5 Code

The integrator lives in `code/namcg_inspiral.py`. A minimal version sufficient to produce Figure 15.1 is the following.

Listing 15.1: Python implementation of the reduced inspiral laboratory velocity-Verlet integrator.

```
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

def run_namcg_laboratory(
```

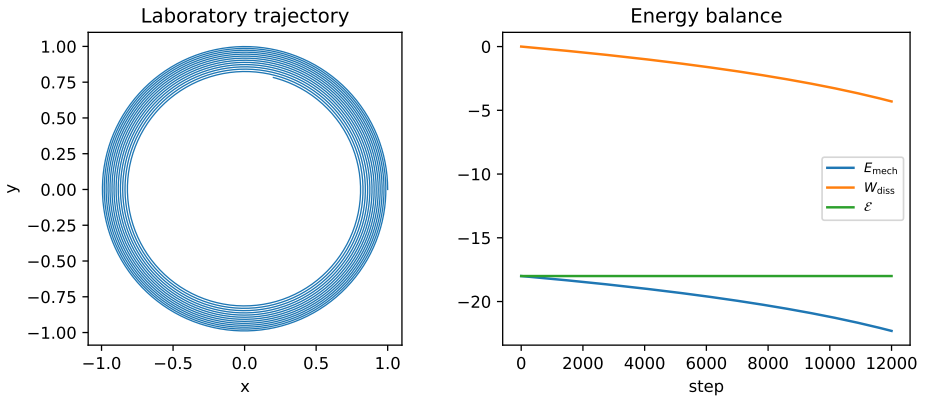


Figure 15.1: Laboratory trajectory and energy balance for (15.1) with the toy parameters (15.2). The figure is a reduced model.

```
    G_toy=36.0,
    eta=0.006,
    M=1.0,
    mu=1.0,
    d0=1.0,
    dt=1.0e-3,
    num_steps=12000,
):
    r = np.array([d0, 0.0])
    v = np.array([0.0, np.sqrt(G_toy * M / d0)])
    traj = np.zeros((num_steps + 1, 2))
    E_mech = np.zeros(num_steps + 1)
    W_diss = np.zeros(num_steps + 1)
    traj[0] = r

    def a_N(r):
        d = np.linalg.norm(r)
        return -G_toy * M * r / d**3

    def a_d(r, v):
        d = np.linalg.norm(r)
        return -eta * v / d**4

    def mechanical_energy(r, v):
        d = np.linalg.norm(r)
        return 0.5 * mu * np.dot(v, v) - G_toy * M * mu / d

    E_mech[0] = mechanical_energy(r, v)
    for n in range(num_steps):
```

```
        F_d = mu * a_d(r, v)
        W_diss[n + 1] = W_diss[n] + np.dot(F_d, v) * dt
        v_half = v + 0.5 * dt * (a_N(r) + a_d(r, v))
        r = r + dt * v_half
        v = v_half + 0.5 * dt * (a_N(r) + a_d(r, v_half))
        traj[n + 1] = r
        E_mech[n + 1] = mechanical_energy(r, v)
    return traj, E_mech, W_diss

def plot_laboratory(traj, E_mech, W_diss, filename):
    E_bal = E_mech - W_diss
    fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(8.4, 3.6))
    axes[0].plot(traj[:, 0], traj[:, 1], lw=0.8)
    axes[0].set_aspect("equal")
    axes[0].set_xlabel("x")
    axes[0].set_ylabel("y")
    axes[0].set_title("Laboratory trajectory")
    t = np.arange(len(E_mech))
    axes[1].plot(t, E_mech, label=r"$E_{\mathrm{mech}}$")
    axes[1].plot(t, W_diss, label=r"$W_{\mathrm{diss}}$")
    axes[1].plot(t, E_bal, label=r"$\mathcal{E}$")
    axes[1].set_xlabel("step")
    axes[1].set_title("Energy balance")
    axes[1].legend(fontsize=8)
    fig.tight_layout()
    fig.savefig(filename)
    plt.close(fig)

if __name__ == "__main__":
    traj, E_mech, W_diss = run_namcg_laboratory()
    plot_laboratory(
        traj, E_mech, W_diss,
        "figs/namcg_gr_simulation_corrected.pdf",
    )
```

Run the file from the project root after creating `figs/`. The script writes a vector PDF suitable for the print interior. A PNG of the same figure, if already produced by an earlier notebook, may be kept for draft viewing but should not be the print original.

15.6 How to misread the figure, and how not to

The shrinking orbit is not a measurement of η in nature. The value 0.006 was chosen so that decay is visible in 1.2×10^4 steps. This book does not calculate η, so no

realistic value at $d \gg \ell_A + \ell_B$ is established here.

The flatness of $\mathcal{E}(t)$ is not a proof of Theorem 11.1. It is a check of the reduced ODE's bookkeeping identity, not of a covariant reduction. If $\mathcal{E}$ is flat and the force law is not (14.10), the check has been passed for the wrong theory.

Comparing the laboratory decay time with a LIGO inspiral time is not a test of NAMCG. The laboratory has no gravitational waves, no horizons, and no relativity. Section 14.4 already stated the regime in which quadrupole losses dominate.

15.7 Exercises

1. **Zero drag.** Set $\eta = 0$ and confirm that E_{mech} and $|\mathbf{L}|$ are constant at the level of Verlet error. What is the size of that error as a function of Δt?

2. **Balance.** With $\eta = 0.006$, plot $\mathcal{E}(t)$ for $\Delta t \in \{10^{-3}, 5 \times 10^{-4}, 2 \times 10^{-3}\}$. Does the drift shrink with Δt?

3. **Illegal drag.** Replace d^{-4} by a constant γ and rerun. Track W_{diss} as d decreases. Why is the late behaviour a counterexample to Exercise 5 of Chapter 14?

4. **Angular momentum.** The drag (14.10) is antiparallel to $\mathbf{v}$. Show that it exerts a torque and compute $\mathrm{d}\mathbf{L}/\mathrm{d}t$. Confirm the identity on the numerical trajectory.

5. **Units.** Restore SI symbols in (15.1) and assign dimensions to η. What combination of ℓ_A, ℓ_B, c and a response time could supply those dimensions?

15.8 Bridge to Chapter 16

Every extra structure used in applications now has a name: the regular core (13.6), the baryon-tracking extra density of Assumption 13.2, the working drag of Assumption 14.2, and the laboratory of this chapter. Chapter 16 collects the full list of assumptions from Chapters 3–15, restates the derivation chain of Chapter 1 as a single page, and writes the observations that would kill the framework rather than merely constrain η.

Chapter 16

Assumptions, Predictions, and Falsifiers

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. restate the derivation chain of Chapter 1 with the theorem numbers now attached;
2. separate assumptions that kill NAMCG if they fail from coefficients that can be adjusted;
3. name observations that would refute the framework rather than merely bound η or r_0;
4. refuse to treat a successful laboratory plot as evidence for Theorems 7.3–12.4;
5. enter Chapter 17 knowing which open calculations are optional refinements and which are critical-path derivations.

A framework that cannot say what would kill it is not a framework. This chapter is the scorecard promised in Section 1.4.

16.1 The chain, with theorem numbers

The argument of the book is the following sequence, and no shorter sequence.

1. A matrix order parameter $\Phi^I{}_A$ with potential (3.7) admits a frame-locking vacuum (Assumptions 3.4, 3.5).
2. A composite vierbein and metric exist in the condensed phase (Repair II, (4.7); Definition 4.3, Assumption 4.4).
3. Fluctuations split into ψ, A_μ, ω_{AB}, and $T_{\mu\nu}$ (Chapter 5).

4. Entanglement equilibrium on emergent diamonds is a property of the condensate vacuum (Assumption 6.1).

5. A Fierz–Pauli tensor block is incompatible with that equilibrium unless $m_T = 0$ (Theorem 7.3).

6. The Euclidean curvature coefficient obeys the conditional, truncated heat-kernel identity of Theorem 8.2; physical matching requires specified operators, weights, thresholds, continuation, and scheme (Problem F).

7. Four-derivative metric operators are treated as EFT vertices, not extra poles, under Assumption 9.2; this is not a claim about a non-perturbative completion.

8. Under the local Lorentz gauge assumption, the six Goldstone orbit variables ω_{AB} are removable in unitary gauge (Theorem 10.3); the diagonal connection's dynamics remain open (Problem D).

9. The conformal mode is heavy (Assumption 7.5).

10. The total stress, including $T^{\rm ent}_{\mu\nu}$, is covariantly conserved (Theorem 11.1).

11. $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ is set by boundary entanglement after an ultraviolet subtraction (Theorem 12.4).

Items 5, 6, 8, 10, and 11 are theorems *inside* the list of assumptions that precede them. If an earlier assumption fails, the later theorem is idle. Phenomenology in Chapters 13–15 sits after the whole list. It cannot substitute for any line.

16.2 Inventory of named assumptions

The named hypotheses of Parts II–V are collected here. "Load- bearing" means that failure returns the infrared theory to analog gravity, scalar-tensor gravity, or an inconsistent extra force. "Coefficient" means that failure changes a number or a regime of validity without destroying the graviton.

Tag	Kind	Content
3.1	setup	$g^{(0)}$ is a scaffold
3.4	load-bearing	vacuum $\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v\delta^I{}_A$ exists
3.5	load-bearing	commutator / covariant-derivative dictionary
4.4	load-bearing	condensed frame is non-degenerate
4.6	load-bearing	signature is Lorentzian
5.1	coefficient	extra internal scalars are heavy
6.1	load-bearing	microscopic entanglement equilibrium
7.5	load-bearing	conformal mode is gapped
8.1	setup	infrared operator is Laplace type
9.2	load-bearing	C^2, R^2 are vertices, not poles
9.3	model	cubic truncation in the static spherical sector
10.1	load-bearing	local $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ is gauged
12.2	load-bearing	local boundary entropy density exists
12.3	load-bearing	boundary stationarity sets Λ_{eff}
13.2	coefficient	static extra density tracks baryons; disks use $\nu_{\surd}$ of Appendix D
13.3	coefficient	external field saturates ν at $\nu(g_{\text{ext}})$, not $\nu(g_{\text{N}})$
14.2	coefficient	working laboratory law $\mathbf{F}_{\text{diss}} \propto -\mathbf{v}/d^4$

Two comments on the table.

First, "coefficient" is not a synonym for "unimportant." Assumption 13.2 is how galaxies enter the book. If it fails, galactic claims fail. The graviton claims need not.

Second, Assumption 3.5 is the most important unproved microscopic bridge. If the infrared dictionary from Presentation A to Presentation B cannot be constructed, the heat kernel of Chapter 8 is a calculation in a different theory than the matrix action of Chapter 3.

Here "load-bearing" classifies an assumption as a premise in the derivation chain; it does not classify the priority of the open problem associated with that premise. Chapter 17 separately marks the critical-path problems for a completed matrix-derived derivation. An assumption may remain in a scope-limited model, but that does not derive or close the corresponding problem.

16.3 What would kill the framework

The following outcomes are incompatible with NAMCG as written, not merely with a choice of η.

A light extra tensor or a ghost below the cutoff. If precision gravity, pulsar timing, or gravitational-wave propagation requires a second massless or light spin-2 field, or a ghost pole below Λ_{UV}, Theorem 7.3 plus Assumption 9.2 has failed.

A light conformal partner. If Solar-System or binary-pulsar tests require a Brans–Dicke parameter that cannot be produced by a heavy ψ, Assumption 7.5 has failed and the infrared theory is scalar-tensor gravity. That is the ceiling of Chapter 1, reopened.

Non-conservation of the extra stress. If an extra acceleration is demanded by data and cannot be written as $\nabla^{\mu} T^{\mathrm{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$ with Theorem 11.1 intact—a drag into nowhere, a preferred-frame force that cannot be improved to a tensor—then the geometric reading has failed. Analog dissipation remains possible. Geometrogenesis of the extra channel has not occurred.

Failure of Lorentz locking. If the unitary-gauge removal of the six Goldstone orbit variables ω_{AB} fails under the theorem's assumptions, Theorem 10.3 has failed. No later chapter can hide that failure.

A cutoff that cannot serve Newton and Lorentz together. If the only way to obtain $G_{\mathrm{eff}} = G_{\mathrm{N}}$ forces Λ_{UV} into a regime where Lorentz-violating $\Theta^{\mu\nu}$ corrections are already excluded by current bounds, the coefficient map and the kinematic algebra cannot coexist.

An induced Einstein–Hilbert term of the wrong sign. If a complete heat-kernel evaluation on the locked bundle produces a repulsive Einstein term that cannot be flipped by fermions or by the Lorentzian continuation, the infrared force is not gravity.

None of these killers is a rotation curve. None of them is a pretty laboratory inspiral.

16.4 What would only constrain a coefficient

The following outcomes bound parameters or restrict regimes. They do not, by themselves, refute Theorems 7.3–12.4.

- SPARC ranking of a global $\nu(g_{\rm N})$ against simple MOND and the published RAR (Appendix D). Frozen $\nu_{\vee}$ at $g_\dagger$ is equivalent to the RAR and about 0.2% behind simple MOND in χ^2; baryons-only is not competitive. That is a passed coefficient check on disks, not a theorem. A later sample that rejects every high-g-Newtonian, low-g-square-root boost would restrict Assumption 13.2 to a smaller class of systems, or kill the galactic claim only.

- Wide binaries in the solar neighbourhood. Isolated $\nu_{\vee}(g_{\rm N})$ predicts $\gamma \approx 4$ at $g_{\rm N} = 10^{-11}\,{\rm m\,s^{-2}}$. Assumption 13.3 predicts $\gamma \to \nu_{\vee}(g_{\rm gal}) \approx 1.1$. A quality-controlled Gaia sample consistent with Newton constrains the isolated reading and is compatible with Assumption 13.3. A surviving $\gamma \approx 1.4$ is not explained by that saturation. Neither outcome touches Theorems 7.3–12.4.

- Cluster lensing or the bullet-cluster mass offset. Same status: the extra tensor may fail as a complete replacement for particulate dark matter while the graviton derivation stands.

- Absence of an extra drag in LIGO-band vacuum inspirals. Expected if η is negligible at those separations; Section 14.4 already said so.

- Absence of a visible core scale r_0 in EHT images or ringdowns. Expected if r_0 is microscopic; bounds $\beta_{\rm ECG}$.

- A measured $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ that does not match a particular guess for $S_{\rm ent}^{\rm (IR)}$. Theorem 12.4 changes the origin of the scale. It does not compute the number.

- A different static mutual-information tail does not, by itself, determine the drag exponent. The response exponent must be calculated from the dynamical force response. The d^{-4} law remains a falsifiable laboratory assumption (Assumption 14.2).

16.5 Observational checklist

A short list of current and near-term measurements, with the question each actually asks of the book.

Solar System and pulsar timing. Do they tolerate a massive ψ, and, if torsion is massive at some as-yet-undetermined scale (Problem D), that torsion mode, along with a $\mu_{\rm ent}$ negligible at high acceleration? Whether torsion is massive is a condition to test, not an established result. If the scalar or tracking assumption fails, the corresponding Assumption 7.5 or 13.2 fails. If they survive, nothing about diamonds has been tested.

Gravitational waves. Is the propagating mode two TT polarizations at the speed of light, with no extra light tensor? That is a test of Theorem 7.3 plus Assumption 9.2, and it is already passed at present precision. A measured extra polarization would be a killer. A measured inspiral-time deviation at LIGO frequencies is only a bound on η.

Black-hole images and ringdowns. Is there a visible deviation from Kerr at the photon ring or in quasi-normal modes? That bounds r_0. A perfectly Kerr object is compatible with microscopic r_0.

Galaxies, wide binaries, and clusters. Do disks accept a single $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\mathrm{N}})$ with $\nu \to 1$ at Solar-System acceleration? Appendix D says yes, at RAR accuracy. Do solar-neighbourhood wide binaries accept the isolated evaluation of that law? No: Assumption 13.3 saturates them at $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\mathrm{gal}})$. Do merging clusters still require a stress that does not track baryons? That remains an open constraint on Assumption 13.2, not on Theorem 7.3, and the external field is not a substitute for the lensing offset.

Cosmology. Is Λ_{eff} constant enough for a Friedmann equation, and is the ultraviolet quartic absent from the expansion history? This tests Theorem 12.4 as a mechanism, not as a number. A detected bulk Λ_{UV}^4 vacuum energy would kill the HBEV subtraction.

Tidal disruptions. Is there extra heating or altered fallback that hydrodynamics plus GR tides cannot account for? A possible window on Assumption 14.2. A null result bounds η at r_{t} and nothing else.

16.6 Claims the book has not made

The following sentences do not appear as theorems in this text, and must not appear on a cover, in an abstract, or in a chapter heading as if they did.

- Dark matter has been explained.
- The cosmological-constant problem has been solved numerically.
- Singularities have been proved absent in dynamical collapse.
- LIGO inspirals are driven by a $1/d^4$ drag.
- Lorentzian signature has been derived from a Euclidean matrix model.
- Presentation A has been reduced to Presentation B without Assumption 3.5.
- The rationals A, B, C in the coefficient map are unique.

- Isolated $\nu_{\surd}$ has been derived, and wide binaries have been predicted without an external field.

A sale-ready monograph that prints any of those sentences as results has left this book and entered advertising.

16.7 How to use Chapter 15 in public

Figure 15.1 may be shown as a numerical bookkeeping check of an assumed drag in a Newtonian laboratory. It may not be shown as "NAMCG predicting an inspiral." The caption must retain the words "reduced model." The toy value $G_{\mathrm{toy}} = 36$ must not be silently replaced by G_{N} in a talk slide.

16.8 Exercises

1. **Sort the list.** Take any popular article on emergent gravity and assign each of its claims to "killer," "coefficient," or "not a claim of this book."

2. **One-page chain.** Write the eleven-line chain of Section 16.1 from memory, without looking. Where you stall is the section to reread.

3. **Design a killer.** Propose one measurement, not already listed, that would refute Theorem 7.3 without passing through η. State the null and the fatal outcome.

4. **Design a non-killer.** Propose one measurement that looks dramatic and would only bound r_0.

5. **Abstract hygiene.** Rewrite a five-sentence abstract of this book that contains no sentence from Section 16.6.

16.9 Bridge to Chapter 17

The killers and the coefficients are now distinguished. What remains is a research agenda: the calculations that would turn Assumption 3.5 into a lemma, recompute A, B, C, evaluate $S_{\mathrm{ent}}^{(\mathrm{IR})}$, derive μ_{ent} from $I(A:B)$, including the external-field argument of Assumption 13.3, and decide whether Lorentzian signature can be more than Assumption 4.6. Chapter 17 writes that agenda at the thickness of a reader who has read the book and wants to work, not at the thickness of a grant advertisement.

Chapter 17

Open Calculations and a Research Agenda

Learning outcomes. After this chapter the reader should be able to:

1. distinguish a load-bearing assumption from a critical-path problem and an optional refinement;
2. pick a first calculation that actually moves the framework, rather than a calculation that only decorates Chapter 15;
3. state what would have to be true before NAMCG may be described as finished rather than as a programme;
4. use the appendices as tools, not as a substitute for the open problems listed here.

Chapter 16 said what would kill the theory. This chapter says what would complete it. The two lists are not the same.

17.1 What is closed conditionally inside the book

The following are closed *as arguments from named hypotheses to named conclusions.* They are not closed as derivations from empty premises.

- Composite metric from a non-degenerate condensate frame (Repair II; Definition 4.3, Assumption 4.4). The Repair I formula of Definition 4.1 is not a constructed frame (Problem C).
- Algebraic split of $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$ (Chapter 5).
- $m_T = 0$ from entanglement equilibrium plus Fierz–Pauli (Theorem 7.3).

- The conditional, truncated heat-kernel identity for specified sectors and scheme (Theorem 8.2); physical G_{eff} remains open in Problem F.
- Lorentz locking in unitary gauge (Theorem 10.3).
- Conservation of the total stress (Theorem 11.1).
- Replacement of a bulk quartic by an infrared boundary datum (Theorem 12.4).
- A legal Newtonian laboratory for Assumption 14.2 (Chapter 15).

A reader who has worked every exercise through Chapter 16 can reproduce that list. Reproducing it is not the same as removing the hypotheses.

17.2 Status vocabulary and completion labels

Status words are *OPEN* and *CLOSED CONDITIONALLY*. Closed conditionally means proved from named hypotheses to named conclusions; it does not remove those hypotheses. Completion words are *DERIVED* and *PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL*. Derived means that the problem's target has no remaining assumed premise in the claimed chain. Programme-conditional means an assumption, input, reduced scope, or unresolved branch remains.

> Keeping an assumption, treating a quantity as an input, narrowing the scope, or choosing a scope that leaves a branch unresolved documents a limitation and keeps the programme conditional. It does not close the problem or satisfy the finished-derivation criterion of Section 17.7. Closure of a critical-path problem means DERIVED. A reduced-scope result is stated as such and the problem stays OPEN. A critical-path problem is met for the matrix-derived label only by a derivation from the matrix theory; an external justification, model input, imposed premise, or reduced scope supports at most a scope-limited Presentation-B model.

OPTIONAL means that a problem may remain open within a stated scope provided the claim given up is stated. Optional does not mean solved. Priority words are CRITICAL PATH and OPTIONAL. In Chapter 16, a *load-bearing assumption* is a premise used by the chain; it is not thereby a critical-path problem.

Label	Meaning
Completed infrared derivation (matrix-derived)	The only label for meeting the five-item criterion in Section 17.7; every critical-path problem is DERIVED for NAMCG from the matrix theory.
Scope-limited Presentation-B infrared model	A separately stated model with its imposed premises named. It is not matrix-derived, does not close critical-path problems, and does not satisfy the five-item criterion.
Programme	Any other status; one or more critical-path premises or targets remain unresolved.

17.3 Critical-path problems: B, C, and D

Problems B, C, D, F, and G are critical path for a completed matrix-derived infrared derivation. The order below follows dependencies, not project size.

Problem B: entanglement equilibrium from the path integral. *CRITICAL PATH; OPEN.* The fixed-algebra first-law identity is established, but not the required stationarity. Assumption 6.1 is the physical engine of Theorem 7.3. Derive $\delta S_D = 0$ at fixed volume as a Ward identity of the microscopic action (3.6), or of (3.4) after Problem A, without importing Jacobson's hypothesis from a theory that already has a metric. A replica computation on small diamonds, with the polar vacuum as background, is the obvious route. A result that holds only for conformal fluctuations must be flagged as such, because the tensor block is not conformal. Closure requires fixed-volume variations of the tensor (non-conformal) block from the microscopic action, a specified map $g^{(0)} \mapsto g$, and no use of an already-existing metric. A conformal-only derivation is a sub-case and leaves B OPEN.

Problem C: the conformal mode. *CRITICAL PATH; OPEN.* The radial potential curvature is known, but the physical scalar operator and coupling are not. Assumption 7.5 is the remaining scalar-tensor ceiling. Compute the full quadratic scalar operator on the locked vacuum in a constructed frame: the canonically normalised kinetic coefficient of the pure-trace scalar (including the induced Einstein–Hilbert contribution), its mixing with $T_{\mu\nu}$, its non-minimal curvature coupling, and its matter coupling. The potential (3.7) alone fixes only the radial curvature λv^2. From the operator, produce the pole mass, or a ratio m_ψ/v, together with the coupling that can be compared with Cassini bounds. If m_ψ is not parametrically of order $\sqrt{\lambda}\, v$, the assumption is false and the infrared theory must be rewritten as scalar-tensor NAMCG. Closure requires the operator, scalar coupling, and phenomenological comparison that

define and test either the safe-mass or scalar-tensor outcome. Declaring a scalar-tensor scope without those data leaves Problem C open and the result programme-conditional.

Lemma (tree-level radial mass). On the locked vacuum $\langle \Phi^I{}_A \rangle = v\delta^I{}_A$, write the polar field $\Phi = (v+\sigma)\Lambda$ with $\Lambda^\dagger\Lambda = \mathbb{I}$ and $\langle\sigma\rangle = 0$. Then $\Phi^\dagger\Phi = (v+\sigma)^2\mathbb{I}$, and (3.7) collapses to a singlet potential. With $N = \mathrm{Tr}(\mathbb{I})$ locked directions,

$$V = \frac{\lambda}{4} N\big[(v+\sigma)^2 - v^2\big]^2 = N\lambda v^2\,\sigma^2 + O(\sigma^3). \tag{17.1}$$

The kinetic term in (3.6), in the signature $(-,+,+,+)$, contributes $-N\,(\partial\sigma)^2$. Canonical normalisation $\sigma_c = \sigma\sqrt{2N}$ puts the quadratic action in the form $-\frac{1}{2}(\partial\sigma_c)^2 - \frac{1}{2}m_\sigma^2\sigma_c^2$, with

$$m_\sigma^2 = \lambda v^2, \qquad m_\sigma = v\sqrt{\lambda}. \tag{17.2}$$

The would-be Goldstones in Λ remain massless at this order. They are the modes Chapter 10 is required to eat. They are not ψ.

Lemma (radial potential curvature in the pure-trace sector). Work in the pure-trace sector: $T_{\mu\nu} = 0$, $F_{\mu\nu} = 0$, and $\omega_{\mu\nu} = 0$. Two repairs of the frame must be kept distinct.

Repair II, unitary gauge. Chapter 10 permits $\Lambda = \mathbb{I}$ wherever Assumption 4.4 holds. The vacuum is then the frame, $e^A{}_\mu = \Phi^A{}_\mu/v$, so

$$g_{\mu\nu} = (1+\sigma/v)^2\eta_{\mu\nu}, \qquad \psi \equiv \eta^{\mu\nu}h_{\mu\nu} = 8\sigma/v + O(\sigma^2). \tag{17.3}$$

The conformal mode and the radial singlet are the same field in this gauge. The potential (3.7) gives the radial singlet the curvature $V'' \propto \lambda v^2$, which with the microscopic kinetic normalisation of Lemma 17.3 is $m_\sigma^2 = \lambda v^2$. This is a statement about the potential only. It is not yet the mass of a canonically normalised pole of ψ (see the identification paragraph below).

Repair I. Definition 4.1 does not define a vierbein (Appendix H, Section H.3), so ψ has no definition in terms of Λ and no Hessian on (σ,ψ) is computed for Repair I. What survives is that (3.7) depends only on $\Phi^\dagger\Phi = (v+\sigma)^2\mathbb{I}$, so it gives curvature only to σ and none to the $\mathfrak{so}(3,1)$-valued directions of Λ.

Identification $g^{(0)} = g[e]$. For the metric (17.3), $g = \Omega^2\eta$ with $\Omega = 1+\sigma/v$, the induced Einstein–Hilbert density is $\sqrt{-g}\,R = -6\,\Omega\,\Box\Omega$, which equals $6(\partial\Omega)^2$ up to a total derivative. With the curvature convention of Chapter 2, Section 2.1 (identified in Chapter 9 as the one for which $R > 0$ on spheres), this adds to the Lagrangian $+3(\partial\sigma)^2/(8\pi G_{\mathrm{eff}}v^2)$ if the Einstein–Hilbert term has the form of (8.11) with $G_{\mathrm{eff}} > 0$; that sign of G_{eff} is a declared condition (Chapter 8, Problem F), not a derived result. In the signature $(-,+,+,+)$ a healthy scalar enters as $-\frac{1}{2}Z(\partial\sigma)^2$ with $Z > 0$, so this

term has the conformal-factor (ghost) sign relative to the microscopic term $-N(\partial\sigma)^2$ of Lemma 17.3. Conditional on the pure-trace truncation, on adding the induced term to the microscopic one, and on $G_{\rm eff} > 0$ in the Lorentzian continuation, the quadratic action $-\frac{1}{2}Z(\partial\sigma)^2 - \frac{1}{2}V''\sigma^2$ has

$$Z = 2N - \frac{3}{4\pi G_{\rm eff} v^2} = 2N\Big(1 - \frac{3M_{\rm P}^2}{Nv^2}\Big), \qquad V'' = 2N\lambda v^2, \qquad M_{\rm P}^2 = \frac{1}{8\pi G_{\rm eff}}. \quad (17.4)$$

If $Nv^2 > 3M_{\rm P}^2$ then $Z > 0$ and a pole of squared mass $m^2 = V''/Z = \lambda v^2(1 - 3M_{\rm P}^2/(Nv^2))^{-1}$ exists in this truncation; it tends to (17.2) only when $3M_{\rm P}^2/(Nv^2) \to 0$, i.e. $G_{\rm eff}Nv^2 \to \infty$. For $Z < 0$ (i.e. $Nv^2 < 3M_{\rm P}^2$) the truncated mode has a wrong-sign kinetic term and, with $\lambda > 0$, also $m^2 = V''/Z < 0$: in this truncation it is both ghost-like and tachyonic, so the kinetic sign is not the only instability. The pure-trace truncation therefore cannot support Assumption 7.5 there; this signals an instability of the chosen background and truncation and is not a statement about the full scalar spectrum. At $Nv^2 = 3M_{\rm P}^2$ one has $Z = 0$: the quadratic kinetic term of this truncation degenerates, and the formula establishes no canonically normalized finite-mass pole there. Since $v/M_{\rm P}$ requires $G_{\rm eff}$, this ties Problem C to Problem F. The mixing with $T_{\mu\nu}$, the non-minimal curvature coupling, and the matter coupling are not derived here, and no Cassini conclusion follows.

Scalar exchange in the pure-trace truncation. Assume in addition that matter couples to $g = \Omega^2\eta$ of (17.3) only through the metric, with no further direct σ–matter coupling; this is an assumption, not a result of Chapters 11–12. Then to first order $\delta g_{\mu\nu} = 2(\sigma/v)\eta_{\mu\nu}$ and the matter Lagrangian contains $(\sigma/v)\,T^{\mu}{}_{\mu}$. For $Z > 0$ of Equation (17.4), nonrelativistic sources of positive mass exchange the canonical scalar through the attractive Yukawa potential

$$V_\sigma(r) = -\frac{m_1 m_2}{4\pi Z v^2}\frac{e^{-mr}}{r}.$$

Relative to the nominal Einstein-sector Newtonian potential

$$V_N(r) = -\frac{G_{\rm eff} m_1 m_2}{r},$$

its strength is βe^{-mr}, where

$$\beta = \frac{2M_{\rm P}^2}{Zv^2} = \frac{M_{\rm P}^2}{Nv^2 - 3M_{\rm P}^2}, \qquad M_{\rm P}^2 = \frac{1}{8\pi G_{\rm eff}}.$$

The physical tensor normalization is not established, so this Einstein-sector comparison is not identified with a measured Newton constant. As $Z \to 0^+$, β diverges but

$m^2 = V''/Z$ also diverges, so at fixed separation $\beta e^{-mr} \to 0$; for $G_{\text{eff}} N v^2 \gg 1$, $\beta \sim M_{\text{P}}^2/(Nv^2)$. This concerns the unmixed truncation only. Mixing with $T_{\mu\nu}$, the non-minimal coupling, $G_{\text{eff}} > 0$, and the metric-only coupling assumption remain unestablished, so no Cassini bound follows.

Cassini, revised. The potential (3.7) gives the radial singlet the curvature λv^2 in the Repair II pure-trace sector and produces no massless scalar by itself. The bound $\gamma - 1 = (2.1 \pm 2.3) \times 10^{-5}$ [4] constrains a massless or long-range scalar partner. Whether the physical scalar of this sector is short-range on an astronomical unit depends on the total kinetic coefficient, the non-minimal coupling and the matter coupling, none of which is computed. This is not a Cassini bound on NAMCG.

Status of Assumption 7.5. Not promoted. What is established is the potential curvature $m_\sigma^2 = \lambda v^2$ (Lemma 17.3) and its identification with the conformal mode in the Repair II pure-trace sector, under Assumptions 3.4 and 4.4. The physical scalar spectrum, the mixing with $T_{\mu\nu}$ and the matter coupling remain open (Appendix H, Section H.3). Loop corrections and the wrong-sign conformal kinetic term of the heat kernel remain Chapter 8 bookkeeping.

Problem D: local Lorentz invariance from Presentation A. *CRITICAL PATH; OPEN.* Generator counting is closed conditionally, while local Lorentz symmetry is imposed. Assumption 10.1 puts $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ into Presentation B by hand. Either derive a local Lorentz gauge symmetry from the matrix algebra and condensate (D1), or state that NAMCG is a theory of a condensate field on an auxiliary spacetime and stop calling Presentation A ontologically prior (D2). D1 closure requires the ω, A_μ, B, and ghost operators and the resulting field content to be specified. Under D2, even with these operators specified, the result is only a scope-limited Presentation-B model: D remains OPEN and CRITICAL PATH, and a full matrix-derived spectrum is not established. The Chapter 10 generator count identifies six Goldstone orbit variables removable in unitary gauge; it does not determine the dynamics of the independent diagonal connection B or whether torsion vanishes, propagates, or is massive. Torsion-free B follows only under the conditional Palatini–Holst hypotheses of Proposition 10.5; NAMCG has not been shown to induce them. For a Laplace-type operator, $a_1 = \mathrm{tr}(R(g)/6 - E)$; its explicit universal curvature term is the Levi-Civita scalar $R(g)$, while unspecified E leaves additional B-dependence open and does not establish a Palatini $R(B)$ term. If B enters the actual bundle connection, a_2 may contain $\mathrm{tr}\, F(B)^2$; its survival in the weighted trace depends on unspecified operators and weights. Deriving the connection and endomorphism dependence or counting B and torsion as additional field content remains open; Problem D is unresolved. Within D2, reduced claims may be limited to Levi-Civita metric geometry of $g = e^T e$ and

conservation of the total stress, without using B; unitary-gauge Lorentz locking removes the six Goldstone orbit variables, while frame/metric bookkeeping remains provisional. D2 does not establish a full-spectrum account, the dynamics or masslessness of B, torsion-free B, or the quadratic operator of A_μ. Problem F then applies only to an explicitly stated frame/metric truncation omitting B and A_μ, conditional on that truncation and with the corresponding ghost sector specified.

17.4 Open problems by scope and priority

17.4.1 Optional problems A and E

Problem A: the infrared dictionary. *OPEN; OPTIONAL only if Presentation B is the operative theory and no claim is made that NAMCG follows from Presentation A or that Presentation A is ontologically prior.* The claim given up is a derivation from the matrix model; Chapter 8 remains a Presentation-B calculation. A claim of matrix-model priority makes A critical path. Assumption 3.5 is the map

$$[\hat{X}_\mu, \Phi] \longleftrightarrow i\Theta_{\mu\nu} D^\nu \Phi \tag{17.5}$$

plus higher-derivative corrections. A derivation must specify the Hilbert space, Weyl map, continuum limit, and error at each order in Θ.

Problem E: Lorentzian signature. *OPEN; OPTIONAL within a scope that retains Assumption 4.6.* The claim given up is that Lorentzian signature is emergent or derived. Euclidean positivity and a formal Wick rotation do not select it; rotating because the infrared world is Lorentzian is not a derivation.

17.4.2 Critical-path items F and G

Problem F: the rationals A, B, C. *CRITICAL PATH; OPEN.* The conditional heat-kernel identity does not compute the physical coupling. The target is to evaluate the weighted a_1 and the curvature-linear part of a_2 on the locked block, including diffeomorphism and local-Lorentz ghosts and the radial-mode threshold, with a scheme stated. The finite-dimensional fibre count alone does not determine these coefficients: the quadratic operator, its connection and endomorphism, the determinant weights, and finite counterterms enter.

Verified heat-kernel bookkeeping (not closure). For the proper-time convention of Appendix A,

$$W_E = -\frac{1}{2} \int_{\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^{-2}}^{\mu^{-2}} \frac{\mathrm{d}s}{s} \operatorname{Tr} e^{-s\mathcal{O}},$$

termwise integration of the truncated, unresummed small-s expansion gives the a_0, a_1, a_2 factors $-1/(64\pi^2), -1/(32\pi^2), -1/(32\pi^2)$, respectively, with powers $\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4 - \mu^4$, $\Lambda_{\rm UV}^2 - \mu^2$, and $\ln(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^2/\mu^2)$. These are not exact finite-cutoff integrations of massive determinants; resumming mass exponentials produces sector-dependent threshold functions. The standard curvature-square part of a_2 for $\mathcal{O} = -D^2 + E$ is

$$\frac{1}{180}\left(R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}R^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} - R_{\mu\nu}R^{\mu\nu} + \frac{5}{2}R^2\right),$$

not the previously displayed $7R^2/2$.

For one minimally coupled real bosonic Laplace-type field with $E_R = 0$, the universal a_1 contribution to the Euclidean coefficient of $\int \sqrt{g}\, R_E$ is

$$C_{R,E}^{(a_1)} = -\frac{N_0}{192\pi^2}(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^2 - \mu^2),$$

where N_0 is the fibre trace of this single sector and the displayed limits are assigned to it. For a specified collection, the corresponding Euclidean contribution is the sum over the explicitly weighted sectors and their assigned limits. This is not the full locked-block result and does not establish a ghost-subtracted trace. It makes no claim about the Lorentzian Einstein–Hilbert sign or a physical $G_{\rm eff}$; those require the specified sector sum and an explicit action/curvature continuation convention.

If $E = E_0 + QR + \cdots$, the a_1 curvature coefficient is $\mathrm{tr}(\frac{1}{6}\mathbb{I} - Q)$. For a scalar with $E = m^2 + \xi R$, the mass-dependent curvature-linear term in a_2 is $(\xi - \frac{1}{6})m^2 R$, vanishing at $\xi = 1/6$. Thus the conformal radial scalar alone does not establish a nonzero logarithmic B; the additional frame operator must be specified and evaluated.

Missing step. Specify the gauge-fixed quadratic Hessian for every locked-block field, including bundle connections, endomorphisms, diffeomorphism and local-Lorentz ghost operators and weights, the radial threshold prescription, finite counterterms, and continuation convention. Then compute the weighted a_1 and relevant a_2 terms in that scheme and match them to A, B, C. The present manuscript does not specify those data. The asserted net $+2$ from the on-shell TT count is not an off-shell heat-kernel trace, and no replacement ghost count can be inferred without the actual gauge fixing and ghost operators. The values $A = 1/\pi$, $B = 8\pi/3$, and $C = 0$ are not established. The quadratic Φ–Φ Hessian of the displayed action (3.6) at fixed $A_\mu = 0$ (Appendix H, Problem F) is an input to, not a specification of, these operators. Problem F remains open.

Problem G: infrared boundary entropy. *CRITICAL PATH; mechanism CLOSED CONDITIONALLY, derivation OPEN.* Evaluate $S_{\rm ent}^{\rm (IR)}$ on an explicit cosmological or large-tube boundary and produce a candidate $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ from (12.10). A symbolic formula

in terms of a late-time entanglement scale is more useful than a claim to have obtained 10^{-122}.

G completion levels. For G-model, a scaling or value computed within a stated assumed boundary model is PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL and does not satisfy the matrix-derived completion criterion. For G-external, independently justified boundary entropy and stationarity may support only a scope-limited Presentation-B model; G remains open for the matrix-derived label. G is DERIVED only when the entropy density and stationarity relation are derived from the matrix theory and Λ_{eff} follows from them. A scaling selected to reproduce a target remains an input. The required entropy density is the one in Assumption 12.2, derived by the replica construction from the matrix theory, and boundary stationarity Assumption 12.3 must likewise be derived rather than retained.

17.4.3 Optional problems continued

Problem H: interpolating function. *OPEN; OPTIONAL research within the theory.* The claim given up is a derivation of $\nu_{\surd}$ from modular data; current empirical comparisons remain coefficient checks. Derive $\nu_{\surd}$ in (13.15), or a function that beats it on a SPARC hold-out, from the modular data of Chapters 6 and 12. The target is

$$\nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{N}}) = \frac{1}{1-\exp\!\left(-\sqrt{g_{\text{N}}/g_s}\right)}, \tag{17.6}$$

which is identically $1 + n_{\text{BE}}(\sqrt{g_{\text{N}}/g_s})$. Appendix D already shows that this law, frozen at the published $g_\dagger$, is equivalent to the RAR and about 0.2% behind simple MOND, while baryons-only fails. That ranking is a coefficient check. It does not solve Problem H.

The first finite computation is the replica free energy of a free field on a weak-field diamond whose infrared boundary is specified as part of the calculation. Chapter 12 supplies Λ_{eff} but does not define a stationary boundary geometry or its surface gravity κ_{IR}; a placeholder κ_{IR} with $\Lambda = \Lambda_{\text{eff}}$ must be constructed and normalized there. Read the source-dependent modular excitation gap $\Delta k(g_{\text{N}}, \kappa_{\text{IR}})$ when a Newtonian source of acceleration g_{N} is introduced; the absolute lowest eigenvalue is not used, because it depends on an additive normalization (Section H.8). Problem H is solved if the response to the extra stress, computed from the weighted multimode spectral sum of Section H.8 (or from a justified single-ladder response), reproduces (17.6) with no SPARC input. In the single-ladder case this requires

$$\Delta k = \sqrt{\frac{g_{\text{N}}}{g_s}}, \qquad g_s = c_\star\, \kappa_{\text{IR}}, \tag{17.7}$$

with the order-one constant $c_\star$ obtained from the calculation and not from galaxy data. The values $c_\star = 1$ and $c_\star = 1/(2\pi)$ both appear in this manuscript; neither is adopted, and a scaling $\Delta k \propto \sqrt{g_{\rm N}/\kappa_{\rm IR}}$ alone does not fix $c_\star$. A computed spectrum that does not reproduce (17.6) does not solve Problem H. A linear gap $\Delta k \propto g_{\rm N}/\kappa_{\rm IR}$ reproduces the retired $\nu_{\rm exp}$ and kills Assumption E.1.

Alternatively, prove that no local $\mu_{\rm ent}(g_{\rm N})$ exists and write the nonlocal kernel instead. Refitting α, r_s, or g_s to rotmod files is not a solution. Identifying g_s with $g_\dagger$ inside the replica calculation is not allowed; compare $\kappa_{\rm IR}$ to $g_\dagger$ only after the source-dependent gap and response are calculated.

Problem I: dynamical origin of the drag. *OPEN; OPTIONAL falsifiable phenomenological extension.* It becomes critical only if the drag is claimed to be derived or predicted. Otherwise the microscopic exponent and rate remain open, and Assumption 14.2 is a working law. Replace Assumption 14.2 by a low-frequency response calculation of $\Gamma_{ij}(\mathbf{r}; \ell_A, \ell_B)$ from specified microscopic dynamics and a specified stationary reference state, including the finite-size factors ℓ_A, ℓ_B and the longitudinal and transverse components. Report the exponent and the coefficient. Then, and only then, estimate η at tidal radii and at LIGO-band separations. The static tail and its assumptions are recorded in Problem H.9; no static-tail power determines the retarded response.

Problem J: spherical ECG solutions. *OPEN; OPTIONAL research within the stated model scope.* The claim given up is singularity resolution derived from the matrix theory; reduced results remain conditional on symmetric reduction and the ECG model assumption. For the explicit invariant $\mathcal{P}$ in (9.7), used in the action (9.8), Section H.10 records checked reduced Euler–Lagrange identities, the resulting first integral including $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$, its conditional regular-centre constraint for every $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$, the maximally symmetric curvature relation, and the large-radius tail. These results are conditional on the static spherical reduction capturing the full field equations; that symmetric-criticality step is not established here. The Einstein-like linearized spectrum on maximally symmetric backgrounds is cited separately and does not establish nonlinear or sourced stability. Problem J remains open: justify the reduction against the full field equations, establish the cubic truncation and its microscopic matching, and construct a regular massive core from specified sourced or modified equations, including its entanglement stress and residual relative to the phenomenological profile (13.6).

17.5 Problems that look like work and are not

The following activities are useful as exercises and do not move the framework.

- Producing further Newtonian integrators with new colour maps of Figure 15.1.
- Fitting SPARC with an unconstrained $\mu_{\rm ent}$, a per-galaxy (α, r_s), or a new ν that is not (17.6) and is not derived from $I(A:B)$. Appendix D already did the legitimate coefficient ranking.
- Writing $\mathbf{a}_{\rm irrev}$ with additional free exponents and calling each a prediction.
- Replacing $G_{\rm toy}$ by $G_{\rm N}$ in a slide.
- Adding adjectives ("holographic," "non-Abelian," "entropic") to an abstract without adding a lemma.

Chapter 15 exists so that a legal laboratory is on the record. It does not exist so that the laboratory can become the theory.

17.6 A recommended order of work

The critical-path dependency order is:

1. Problem D1: derive local $SO(3,1)$ from the matrix algebra and condensate; specify the ω, A_μ, B and ghost operators needed by Problem F.
2. Problem C: compute the tree-level scalar operator, including kinetic coefficient, mixing, mass and testable matter coupling.
3. Problem F: compute A, B, C with the specified operators, ghosts, thresholds and scheme, and derive $G_{\rm eff}$.
4. Problem B: derive the fixed-volume tensor-block stationarity from the microscopic action, not only for conformal variations.
5. Problem G: derive $S_{\rm ent}^{(\rm IR)}$ and boundary stationarity from the matrix theory, then derive the $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$ scaling or value.

Alternate scope: model work outside the critical-path sequence. Taking Presentation B with imposed local Lorentz symmetry (D2), an externally justified boundary result (G-external), or $G_{\rm eff}$ as an input may make a scope-limited Presentation-B model calculable and testable, for example by specifying full quadratic and ghost operators and computing Problem F for a stated truncation. Such work leaves Problems D, F, G and the matrix-derived completion criterion open, must name its imposed premises, and is not a step in the sequence above.

Problems A, E, H, I, and J are optional within their stated scopes. Appendix D records the coefficient-level check for Problem H; further galactic work should not be described as a derivation from $I(A:B)$ without the modular calculation.

17.7 What "finished" would mean

The label *Completed infrared derivation (matrix-derived)* applies only if all five critical-path problems are DERIVED:

1. Problem B is a lemma: Assumption 6.1 is no longer an assumption, and fixed-volume variations include the non-conformal tensor block.
2. Problem C has a computed scalar operator, coupling, and phenomenological comparison defining and testing either a sufficiently heavy m_ψ or the scalar-tensor outcome.
3. Problem D1: an $SO(3,1)$ gauge symmetry is derived from the matrix algebra and condensate, with the ω, A_μ, B and ghost operators specified and the field content stated.
4. Problem F has A, B, C and the sign/scheme dependence of G_{eff} computed from the specified operators; G_{eff} is not an input.
5. Problem G-derived: the infrared boundary entropy density and stationarity relation are derived from the matrix theory, and the Λ_{eff} scaling or value follows from them. G-model and G-external do not meet this item.

If local Lorentz symmetry is instead imposed (D2), even with the full quadratic and ghost content specified, the result is a scope-limited Presentation-B infrared model. It may be studied and tested as such, but Problem D stays OPEN and CRITICAL PATH and the five-item criterion is not met. No label of "completed infrared derivation" is allowed for that scope. Any critical-path item met only by an imposed premise, input, or reduced scope likewise yields at most a scope-limited model or programme, never the matrix-derived label.

Problems A, E, H, I, and J may remain open in a completed derivation within the stated scopes; the claims given up are listed above. Problem A is additionally required if the theory is claimed to follow from Presentation A. Problem I is a prerequisite only if drag is claimed to be derived or predicted.

Until all five items are derived, the honest public description is the subtitle of the book, read as a programme: *an attempt* to derive general relativity and massless spin-2 dynamics from a matrix condensate held at entanglement equilibrium. The attempt is written so that it can fail in public. That is the point of Chapter 16.

17.8 Exercises

1. **Status report.** Copy the eleven-line chain of Section 16.1 and mark each line "lemma," "theorem from assumptions," or "assumption." Do not use a mark you

cannot defend from the text.

2. **Proposal.** Write a two-page project proposal for Problem C or Problem F only. Include the first calculation you would perform and the result that would make you stop.

3. **Not a proposal.** Take any project that Section 17.5 would reject and explain, in six sentences, why it does not change the status of Theorem 7.3.

4. **Public sentence.** Write one sentence suitable for an Amazon description that survives Section 16.6 and the last paragraph of Section 17.7.

17.9 Bridge to the appendices

The main text is complete. Appendix A records the Seeley–DeWitt algorithm at the working thickness used in Chapter 8. Appendix B records the replica formula and the modular Hamiltonian at the thickness used in Chapter 6. Appendix C records the Verlet laboratory and the energy identity used in Chapter 15. Appendix D records the SPARC ranking of $\nu_{\vee}$ against the RAR, simple MOND, and baryons-only. None of the appendices introduces a new physical hypothesis. If an appendix appears to do so, the hypothesis belongs in the main text or it does not belong in the book.

Appendix A

Seeley–DeWitt Coefficients at Working Thickness

This appendix records the heat-kernel formulae used in Chapter 8. It introduces no new physical hypothesis. Conventions follow Section 2.6: Euclidean section first, Lorentzian continuation afterwards, signature of the main text restored only when an Einstein–Hilbert term is isolated.

A.1 Laplace-type operators

Let $V \to M$ be a vector bundle over a smooth four-manifold with Riemannian metric $g_{\mu\nu}$. A second-order differential operator on sections of V is of Laplace type if it can be written

$$\mathcal{O} = -g^{\mu\nu} D_\mu D_\nu + E, \tag{A.1}$$

where $D_\mu = \nabla_\mu + \mathcal{A}_\mu$ is a connection on V (including the Levi-Civita connection on tensor factors) and E is a bundle endomorphism. The curvature of D is

$$\mathcal{F}_{\mu\nu} = [D_\mu, D_\nu]. \tag{A.2}$$

On the locked condensate block of Chapter 5, V is the bundle of tensors $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$ together with whatever ghosts are included in a given computation.

The heat operator $e^{-s\mathcal{O}}$ is defined for $s > 0$ by the usual functional calculus after $\mathcal{O}$ has been made positive by a Wick rotation. Its integral kernel $K(s; x, y)$ satisfies

$$\partial_s K + \mathcal{O}_x K = 0, \qquad K(0; x, y) = \delta(x, y). \tag{A.3}$$

A.2 Small-time expansion

On the diagonal in four dimensions,

$$\operatorname{tr}_V K(s;x,x) \sim \frac{1}{(4\pi s)^2} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} s^k a_k(x), \qquad s \to 0^+. \tag{A.4}$$

Each a_k is a local scalar density of mass dimension $2k$, built from $R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}$, $\mathcal{F}_{\mu\nu}$, E, and their covariant derivatives. The first three coefficients, up to total derivatives that do not enter the bulk effective action, are

$$a_0 = \operatorname{tr}_V \mathbb{I}, \tag{A.5}$$

$$a_1 = \operatorname{tr}_V \Big(\tfrac{1}{6} R - E \Big), \tag{A.6}$$

$$\begin{aligned} a_2 = \operatorname{tr}_V \Bigg(& \frac{1}{180} (R_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} R^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} - R_{\mu\nu} R^{\mu\nu} + \tfrac{5}{2} R^2) + \frac{1}{2} E^2 - \frac{1}{6} R E \\ & + \frac{1}{12} \mathcal{F}_{\mu\nu} \mathcal{F}^{\mu\nu} + \frac{1}{30} D^2 R - \frac{1}{6} D^2 E \Bigg). \end{aligned} \tag{A.7}$$

Different references redistribute the $D^2 R$ and $D^2 E$ terms by integration by parts. For the bulk action of Chapter 8 those terms are discarded.

The numerical coefficients in (A.7) are the standard DeWitt values for a Laplace-type operator. They do not determine the coefficients A, B, C in the conditional parameterization (8.12). Their evaluation requires the specified operators, fibre traces, determinant weights, and thresholds; this remains part of Problem F in Chapter 17.

A.3 Proper-time integrals

For the sectors actually included in a gauge-fixed calculation, let $\mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{sec}}$ be their index set, w_s their determinant weights relative to a real bosonic determinant, and $\mathcal{O}_s$ their operators. Define

$$W_E^{(1)} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{sec}}} w_s \operatorname{Tr}_{V_s} \ln \mathcal{O}_s, \qquad \mathcal{N}_0 := \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{sec}}} w_s \operatorname{tr}_{V_s} \mathbb{I}_s. \tag{A.8}$$

The corresponding proper-time representation is

$$W_E^{(1)} = -\frac{1}{2} \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}_{\mathrm{sec}}} w_s \int_{s_{\min,s}}^{s_{\max,s}} \frac{\mathrm{d}s}{s} \operatorname{Tr}_{V_s} e^{-s\mathcal{O}_s}. \tag{A.9}$$

The expressions below are term-by-term integrals of the truncated, unresummed small-s heat-kernel expansion through a_2, not exact finite-cutoff integrations of massive determinants. If E_s contains m_s^2, resumming $\exp(-sm_s^2)$ replaces polynomial cutoff terms by sector-dependent threshold functions. A common pair of limits applies only to sectors explicitly assigned those limits; otherwise the sector-dependent limits are retained. Inserting the heat-kernel expansion and integrating term by term gives

$$W_E^{(1)} \supset \sum_{s\in\mathcal{S}_{\rm sec}} w_s \int \mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{g}\,\Bigg[-\frac{a_{0,s}}{64\pi^2}({\Lambda_{\rm UV}}_s^4-\mu_s^4)-\frac{a_{1,s}}{32\pi^2}({\Lambda_{\rm UV}}_s^2-\mu_s^2) - \frac{a_{2,s}}{32\pi^2}\ln\Big(\frac{{\Lambda_{\rm UV}}_s^2}{\mu_s^2}\Big)\Bigg], \tag{A.10}$$

where $a_{k,s}$ are the traced coefficients on V_s. With common limits explicitly assigned to every included sector, the a_0 term is $-\mathcal{N}_0(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4-\mu^4)/(64\pi^2)$.

For the Lorentzian vacuum-sign statement adopt $S_E=-iS_L$ under $t=-i\tau$ and define the Lorentzian vacuum term by $S_L\supset-\rho_\Lambda\int\mathrm{d}^4x\,\sqrt{-g}$. For one real scalar, $a_0=1$, and only under these conventions, $W_E/\mathrm{Vol}\supset-(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4-\mu^4)/(64\pi^2)$ corresponds to $\rho_\Lambda=-(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4-\mu^4)/(64\pi^2)$. The common-limit sector sum gives $\rho_\Lambda=-\mathcal{N}_0(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4-\mu^4)/(64\pi^2)$ only when all displayed sectors share the assigned limits, within the same truncated, unresummed expansion. The Lorentzian sign is conditional on this continuation/action convention.

A.4 Worked example: a non-minimal scalar

For a single real scalar with

$$\mathcal{O}=-\nabla^2+\xi R+m^2, \tag{A.11}$$

one has $E=\xi R+m^2$, $\mathcal{F}_{\mu\nu}=0$, and $\mathrm{tr}_V\mathbb{I}=1$. Then

$$a_1=(\tfrac{1}{6}-\xi)R-m^2. \tag{A.12}$$

The curvature piece of a_1 cancels at $\xi=1/6$. That cancellation removes this scalar's contribution to the curvature coefficient through a_1. The NAMCG radial mode is not assumed to sit at $\xi=1/6$; Exercise 3 of Chapter 8 is the corresponding warning.

For one real scalar the Euclidean a_0 contribution is $-(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4-\mu^4)/(64\pi^2)$. Under the continuation and Lorentzian vacuum-action convention stated above, this corresponds to $\rho_\Lambda=-(\Lambda_{\rm UV}^4-\mu^4)/(64\pi^2)$. For a collection of sectors the total density includes their determinant weights and sector-dependent thresholds.

A.5 Fibre traces on the locked block

If V is the space of symmetric traceless tensors on a four-manifold, $\mathrm{tr}_V \mathbb{I} = 9$. If the algebraic split of Chapter 5 is retained before gauge fixing, the sixteen components of $\delta\Phi_{\mu\nu}$ give $\mathrm{tr}_V \mathbb{I} = 16$. Ghosts for diffeomorphisms contribute with the opposite sign and with their own Laplace-type operators. Any local-Lorentz ghost sector must be specified together with the gauge fixing of the independent Lorentz connection; Theorem 10.3 does not supply that operator.

$\mathcal{N}_0$ is the weighted fibre trace over the sectors actually included, not automatically the locked-block dimension or a physical-mode count. A total locked-block result must specify the gauge-fixed fluctuation, Goldstone, diffeomorphism-ghost and local-Lorentz-ghost operators, determinant weights, and assigned thresholds. No factor of $1/6$ is absorbed into $\mathcal{N}_0$; the complete calculation is Problem F.

A.6 What this appendix will not do

It will not list a_3 and a_4. Those coefficients generate six- and eight-derivative operators that the book treats as suppressed by further powers of $\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^{-1}$.

It will not prove the coefficients (A.5)–(A.7). Standard derivations (coincidence limits of the Synge world function, or the recursive DeWitt transport equations) are in the references collected in `bib/namcg.bib`. The book uses the coefficients; it does not redo the recursion.

It will not evaluate a_2 on the Einsteinian cubic background of Chapter 13. That evaluation is part of Problem J if it is needed, not part of the working thickness of Chapter 8.

A.7 Exercises

1. **Dimensions.** Assign mass dimensions to s, a_0, a_1, a_2, and $\mathrm{tr}_V K(s; x, x)$. Confirm that each term in (A.10) has dimension four.

2. **Conformal scalar.** Set $\xi = 1/6$ and $m = 0$ in (A.12). What remains of a_1? What remains of the $\Lambda_{\mathrm{UV}}^2 R$ term in W_E?

3. **Gauss–Bonnet combination.** Rewrite the curvature part of (A.7) in the basis $\{C_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}C^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}, R^2, E_{\mathrm{GB}}\}$. Which combination multiplies a topological density in four dimensions?

4. **Ghost sign.** A diffeomorphism ghost in the background-field gauge is a complex vector with a Laplace-type operator. What factor multiplies its contribution to a_0 relative to a real scalar, and why is the sign opposite to a physical field?

5. **Conditional curvature coefficient.** Given specified sector operators, determinant weights, proper-time limits, and a finite-counterterm scheme, derive the truncated Euclidean curvature coefficient from a_1 and a_2. Identify the additional data needed for its Lorentzian continuation and comparison with G_{eff}.

Appendix B

Modular Hamiltonians and the Replica Formula

This appendix records the entanglement formulae used in Chapters 6, 11, and 12. It introduces no new physical hypothesis. The working identity of the main text remains Proposition 6.5. What follows is the language in which that identity was written.

B.1 States, reductions, and von Neumann entropy

Let $\mathcal{H}$ be the Hilbert space of the microscopic theory and ρ a density operator on $\mathcal{H}$. For a von Neumann algebra $\mathcal{A}_D$ of observables associated with a region D, the reduced state ρ_D is the restriction of ρ to $\mathcal{A}_D$. In a tensor-product approximation $\mathcal{H} \simeq \mathcal{H}_D \otimes \mathcal{H}_{D^c}$,

$$\rho_D = \mathrm{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{D^c}} \rho. \tag{B.1}$$

Continuum quantum field theory does not have that tensor-product factorization. The algebraic definition (restriction to $\mathcal{A}_D$) is the honest one; equation (B.1) is the formula used in every explicit replica computation in the book.

The von Neumann entropy and modular Hamiltonian of ρ_D are

$$S_D = -\mathrm{Tr}(\rho_D \ln \rho_D), \qquad H_D = -\ln \rho_D, \tag{B.2}$$

so that

$$S_D = \langle H_D \rangle_{\rho_D}. \tag{B.3}$$

If ρ_D has kernel, $\ln \rho_D$ is defined on the support of ρ_D and S_D may be infinite. In quantum field theory S_D is ultraviolet divergent. Differences δS_D at fixed cutoff, and mutual informations, are the finite objects used in the main text.

B.2 Relative entropy and mutual information

For two states ρ and σ on the same algebra,

$$S(\rho\|\sigma) = \mathrm{Tr}(\rho \ln \rho) - \mathrm{Tr}(\rho \ln \sigma) \tag{B.4}$$

is non-negative and vanishes if and only if $\rho = \sigma$ (when the expression is finite). Mutual information of two regions A and B is the relative entropy of ρ_{AB} with respect to $\rho_A \otimes \rho_B$,

$$I(A:B) = S(\rho_{AB}\|\rho_A \otimes \rho_B) = S(A) + S(B) - S(A \cup B), \tag{B.5}$$

the second equality holding when the three von Neumann entropies are regulated in the same scheme. Positivity of $I(A:B)$ is therefore positivity of relative entropy. Under Definition 6.4, for $\lambda \geq 0$, this implies $U_{\mathrm{ent}} \leq 0$. That concerns the chosen potential convention; it does not establish an ordering between adiabatic and non-adiabatic states or the sign of a dynamical drag coefficient. A nonnegative low-frequency drag requires a separate passivity condition on the retarded response, as discussed in Chapter 14.

Strong subadditivity,

$$S(A \cup B) + S(B \cup C) \geq S(B) + S(A \cup B \cup C), \tag{B.6}$$

is recorded for completeness. The main text does not use it beyond the positivity of $I(A:B)$.

B.3 The replica formula

For integer $n \geq 1$,

$$\mathrm{Tr}\,(\rho_D)^n = Z_n / Z_1^n, \tag{B.7}$$

where Z_n is the partition function of the microscopic theory on an n-sheeted cover branched over the edge $\mathcal{B} = \partial D \cap \Sigma$. Analytic continuation in n and the identity

$$S_D = \lim_{n \to 1} (1 - n\partial_n) \ln \mathrm{Tr}\,(\rho_D)^n \tag{B.8}$$

produce the von Neumann entropy. Differentiating at $n = 1$ inserts a single modular Hamiltonian: the first variation $\delta S_D = \delta \langle H_D \rangle$ used in Chapter 6 is the replica formula at first order, not a second definition.

In Presentation B the cover is a branched cover of the auxiliary manifold, later identified with the emergent spacetime by Proposition 8.4. In Presentation A the same construction requires Problem A of Chapter 17.

B.4 Bisognano–Wichmann and small diamonds

On Minkowski space, let W be a Rindler wedge. The Bisognano–Wichmann theorem identifies the modular Hamiltonian of the vacuum restricted to W with the boost generator that fixes the edge,

$$H_W = \frac{2\pi}{\kappa} \int_{\Sigma \cap W} \mathrm{d}\Sigma^\mu \, \xi^\nu T_{\mu\nu}, \tag{B.9}$$

where ξ^μ is the boost Killing vector and κ its surface gravity (equal to 1 in standard Rindler coordinates, restored here for matching (6.5)).

A small causal diamond in a slowly curved emergent geometry is, to leading order in Riemann normal coordinates (2.27), a compact analogue of two opposing Rindler wedges glued at a 2-sphere. The working formula (6.5) is that analogue: the same boost-energy integral plus an area term H_{area} whose first variation is $\delta A/(4G_{\mathrm{eff}})$ after Chapter 8 has named G_{eff}. The error is $O(\ell^3)$ in the diamond radius, which is the order dropped in Proposition 6.5.

The identification is exact for free fields in Rindler space. It is an operator-product approximation for interacting condensate fluctuations. The book does not claim a Bisognano–Wichmann theorem for the full matrix potential (3.7).

B.5 Fixed volume

Jacobson's entanglement-equilibrium condition is imposed at fixed spatial volume of the maximal slice. In Riemann normal coordinates the volume of a small ball of radius ℓ is (6.2). A pure conformal variation $\delta g_{\mu\nu} = \chi \eta_{\mu\nu}$ changes that volume at order ℓ^3. Holding V fixed removes that breathing from the comparison and is why the conformal block ψ and the tensor block $T_{\mu\nu}$ do not enter the first law on the same footing.

Fixed volume is a constraint on the variations admitted in Assumption 6.1. It is not a statement that ψ is massive. That statement is Assumption 7.5.

B.6 Boundary entropy versus diamond entropy

Chapter 12 uses a different functional: a local density $S_{\mathrm{ent}}(h_{ij}, \phi)$ on ∂M. The replica construction of that density is the same formula, (B.8), applied to a thin tubular neighbourhood of the boundary and then localized as in Assumption 12.2. The two functionals must not be substituted for each other. Section 12.6 already assigned them different jobs.

B.7 What this appendix will not do

It will not develop Tomita–Takesaki theory beyond the definition $H_D = -\ln \rho_D$. It will not compute S_D for the matrix potential (3.7). It will not prove Assumption 6.1. Those are Problem B of Chapter 17 and the physical input of Chapter 6, respectively.

B.8 Exercises

1. **Replica derivative.** From (B.8) and $\operatorname{Tr} \rho^n = \exp(\ln \operatorname{Tr} \rho^n)$, recover $S = \langle H \rangle$ at $n = 1$.

2. **Relative entropy and Klein's inequality.** For finite-dimensional density matrices, prove $S(\rho \| \sigma) \geq 0$. Deduce $I(A : B) \geq 0$.

3. **Rindler temperature.** In standard Rindler coordinates, show that the Unruh temperature seen by an accelerated observer is $\kappa/2\pi$. Match the factor in (B.9).

4. **Area divergence.** For a free scalar in Minkowski space, the unregulated S_D diverges as $\operatorname{Area}(\mathcal{B})/\epsilon^2$. Why do mutual information and first variations δS_D at fixed cutoff remain useful?

5. **Two functionals.** Write four sentences explaining why a small-diamond S_D cannot be used as the boundary density of Definition 12.1.

Appendix C

Verlet Laboratory and Energy Identity

This appendix records the integrator and the energy identity used in Chapter 15. It introduces no new physical hypothesis. The force law is Assumption 14.2. The bookkeeping reference is Proposition 11.3, which this laboratory does not satisfy in the microscopic sense; the integrator tracks only W_{diss}. The source file is `code/namcg_inspiral.py`.

C.1 Reduced equation

In the reduced-mass frame the laboratory system is

$$\ddot{\mathbf{r}} = \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{N}}(\mathbf{r}) + \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v}), \tag{C.1}$$

with

$$\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{N}} = -\frac{G_{\mathrm{toy}} M}{d^3}\mathbf{r}, \qquad \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}} = -\frac{\eta}{d^4}\mathbf{v}, \qquad d = |\mathbf{r}|. \tag{C.2}$$

The conservative force is Newtonian. The drag is (14.10) with μ cancelled. Toy parameters are (15.2).

C.2 One step

Let $\Delta t > 0$. Given $(\mathbf{r}_n, \mathbf{v}_n)$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{v}_{1/2} &= \mathbf{v}_n + \tfrac{1}{2}\Delta t\big(\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{N}}(\mathbf{r}_n) + \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}_n, \mathbf{v}_n)\big), \\ \mathbf{r}_{n+1} &= \mathbf{r}_n + \Delta t\, \mathbf{v}_{1/2}, \\ \mathbf{v}_{n+1} &= \mathbf{v}_{1/2} + \tfrac{1}{2}\Delta t\big(\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{N}}(\mathbf{r}_{n+1}) + \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}_{n+1}, \mathbf{v}_{1/2})\big). \end{aligned} \tag{C.3}$$

When $\eta = 0$ this is velocity Verlet for a position-dependent force and is second-order accurate and symplectic on the conservative phase space. When $\eta \neq 0$ the last drag evaluation uses $\mathbf{v}_{1/2}$ rather than $\mathbf{v}_{n+1}$, so the dissipative piece is explicit and the scheme is no longer symplectic. The local error in the drag kick remains $O(\Delta t^2)$.

An implicit alternative replaces $\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}_{n+1}, \mathbf{v}_{1/2})$ by $\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}(\mathbf{r}_{n+1}, \mathbf{v}_{n+1})$ and solves a linear equation for $\mathbf{v}_{n+1}$. The published script does not do that. The difference is visible only if one drives Δt up to the orbital period.

C.3 Mechanical energy, work, and balance

Define

$$E_{\mathrm{mech}} = \frac{1}{2}\mu v^2 - \frac{G_{\mathrm{toy}} M \mu}{d} \tag{C.4}$$

and the accumulated work

$$W_{\mathrm{diss}}(t_{n+1}) = W_{\mathrm{diss}}(t_n) + \mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss}}(\mathbf{r}_n, \mathbf{v}_n) \cdot \mathbf{v}_n \, \Delta t, \tag{C.5}$$

with $\mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss}} = \mu \mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}}$ and $W_{\mathrm{diss}}(0) = 0$. Along exact solutions of (C.1),

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}E_{\mathrm{mech}}}{\mathrm{d}t} = \mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss}} \cdot \mathbf{v}, \tag{C.6}$$

because the Newtonian force is minus the gradient of $U_{\mathrm{N}} = -G_{\mathrm{eff}}$-less toy potential $-G_{\mathrm{toy}} M \mu / d$. Therefore

$$\mathcal{E}(t) \equiv E_{\mathrm{mech}}(t) - W_{\mathrm{diss}}(t) \tag{C.7}$$

is constant on exact solutions. On discrete solutions it is constant up to the quadrature error in (C.5) and the Verlet error in (C.3). A systematic drift that does not shrink with Δt means the implementation does not obey (C.6) and is illegal in the sense of Section 14.6.

A trapezoidal quadrature,

$$\Delta W = \frac{1}{2}\Big(\mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss},n} \cdot \mathbf{v}_n + \mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss},n+1} \cdot \mathbf{v}_{n+1}\Big)\Delta t, \tag{C.8}$$

reduces that drift by one order in Δt. The published script uses the left-endpoint rule (C.5) because it is enough to make $\mathcal{E}$ look flat on the scale of Figure 15.1.

C.4 Angular momentum

The Newtonian force is central and exerts no torque. The drag is antiparallel to $\mathbf{v}$, so

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}\mathbf{L}}{\mathrm{d}t} = \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F}_{\mathrm{diss}} = -\eta\mu \frac{\mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{v}}{d^4}. \tag{C.9}$$

Angular momentum is therefore not conserved when $\eta \neq 0$. That is required: an inspiral that conserved $|\mathbf{L}|$ at fixed mass would be incompatible with a shrinking circular orbit. The identity (C.9) is a useful code check (Exercise 4 of Chapter 15).

C.5 Initial data and units

The published run uses

$$\mathbf{r}(0) = (1, 0), \qquad \mathbf{v}(0) = (0, \sqrt{G_{\text{toy}} M}), \tag{C.10}$$

with $G_{\text{toy}} = 36$, $\eta = 0.006$, $\Delta t = 10^{-3}$, and 1.2×10^4 steps. These are code units. They are chosen so that decay is visible, not so that η matches a tidal-disruption estimate from Problem I of Chapter 17.

Restoring dimensions, η in (C.2) has dimension length^4/time, since $\mathbf{a} = -\eta \mathbf{v}/d^4$. The static tail (14.8) does not supply this coefficient; deriving it requires the response calculation of Problem H.9, which this appendix does not attempt.

C.6 How to run the script

From the project root, after `figs/` exists:

```
python code/namcg_inspiral.py
```

The script writes `figs/namcg_gr_simulation_corrected.pdf`. Point Figure 15.1 at that PDF for the print interior. A legacy PNG from an earlier notebook may be kept for draft viewing.

If `matplotlib` is unavailable, the integrator still runs and can write `traj`, `E_mech`, and `W_diss` to text; the figure is then optional.

C.7 What this appendix will not do

It will not introduce gravitational waves, horizons, or a relativistic two-body Hamiltonian. It will not treat G_{toy} as G_{N}. It will not fit η to data. Those refusals are the content of Sections 15.6 and 16.7.

C.8 Exercises

1. **Conservative order.** With $\eta = 0$, measure the secular drift of E_{mech} over 10^4 steps at three values of Δt. Confirm second-order scaling.

2. **Quadrature.** Replace (C.5) by (C.8) and compare the drift of $\mathcal{E}$.

3. **Implicit drag.** Solve the linear equation for $\mathbf{v}_{n+1}$ when the last drag evaluation uses $\mathbf{v}_{n+1}$. Does $\mathcal{E}$ improve enough to justify the extra algebra?

4. **Torque check.** Integrate (C.9) in lockstep with the trajectory and compare with $\mathbf{L}_{n+1} - \mathbf{L}_n$.

5. **Illegal control.** Set $\mathbf{a}_{\mathrm{d}} = -\gamma\mathbf{v}$ with constant γ and watch W_{diss} as d decreases. This is Exercise 3 of Chapter 15, recorded here so the appendix can be used alone as a lab sheet.

Appendix D

SPARC Rotation Curves: A Coefficient-Level Consistency Check

D.1 What is being tested

The function

$$\nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm N}, g_s) = \frac{1}{1 - \exp(-\sqrt{g_{\rm N}/g_s})} \tag{D.1}$$

is the published Radial Acceleration Relation interpolator of McGaugh, Lelli & Schombert (2016). Appendix H records that a derivation of this (or any other) interpolator from the mutual-information functional remains open (Problem H). The present appendix asks only whether the same function, with the single scale fixed at the published value $g_s = g_\dagger = 1.20 \times 10^{-10}\,\mathrm{m\,s^{-2}}$, is compatible with the SPARC rotation-curve sample.

The predicted circular velocity is

$$V = V_{\rm b}\sqrt{\nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm N}, g_s)}, \tag{D.2}$$

where $V_{\rm b}$ is the Newtonian baryonic contribution computed from the SPARC mass models. No additional galactic parameters are introduced.

D.2 SPARC comparison

The comparison uses the public SPARC rotmod files (175 galaxies, 3391 radial points). Three models are scored by χ^2 and AIC:

- baryons only ($\nu = 1$);

- simple MOND with one free acceleration scale a_0;
- $\nu_{\surd}$ with g_s fixed at $g_\dagger$ (zero free parameters) and, for reference, with g_s free.

Table D.1: Global χ^2 and AIC on 175 SPARC galaxies (3391 points). Lower AIC is better.

Model	Free params	χ^2	AIC	Scale ($\mathrm{m\,s^{-2}}$)
$\nu_{\surd}$ (fixed $g_s = g_\dagger$)	0	1.695×10^5	1.695×10^5	1.20×10^{-10}
$\nu_{\surd}$ (free g_s)	1	1.695×10^5	1.695×10^5	1.20×10^{-10}
Simple MOND (free a_0)	1	1.691×10^5	1.691×10^5	1.16×10^{-10}
Baryons only	0	1.960×10^6	1.960×10^6	—

The fixed-g_s and free-g_s versions of $\nu_{\surd}$ are statistically indistinguishable; the free fit returns $g_s = 1.20 \times 10^{-10}\,\mathrm{m\,s^{-2}}$. Relative to the best one-parameter MOND fit the χ^2 penalty is approximately 0.2%. Both modified-gravity models improve on baryons-only by more than an order of magnitude in χ^2.

D.3 Numerical implementation

Listing D.1: Core evaluation functions.

```
import numpy as np

KMS2_PER_KPC_TO_SI = 1.0e6 / 3.085677581491367e19
G_DAGGER = 1.20e-10

def gn_si(vb, r):
    r = np.maximum(np.asarray(r, float), 1e-6)
    return (np.asarray(vb, float)**2 / r) * KMS2_PER_KPC_TO_SI

def nu_sqrt(gn, gs):
    gs = max(float(gs), 1e-18)
    x = np.clip(np.asarray(gn, float)/gs, 0.0, 1e12)
    s = np.sqrt(x)
    denom = 1.0 - np.exp(-s)
    nu = np.empty_like(denom)
    tiny = denom < 1e-12
    nu[tiny] = 1.0 / np.maximum(s[tiny], 1e-30)
    nu[~tiny] = 1.0 / denom[~tiny]
    return nu

def v_namcg(r, vb, gs=G_DAGGER):
```

```
    return vb * np.sqrt(np.clip(nu_sqrt(gn_si(vb, r), gs), 1.0,
1e6))
```

D.4 What the comparison is and is not

At low Newtonian acceleration, $\nu_{\surd}$ approaches the square-root map $g_{\rm obs} \approx \sqrt{g_{\rm N} g_\dagger}$. On the SPARC disks this keeps V from falling as fast as $V_{\rm b}$. The numerical result shows that this particular function, frozen at the published $g_\dagger$, is compatible with the sample at the same level as a one-parameter MOND fit.

The comparison does not:

- derive $\nu_{\surd}$ from $I(A : B)$ or from the modular spectrum (Problem H remains open);
- fix $g_\dagger$ from the condensate;
- constrain $m_T = 0$, the heat-kernel coefficients, or the conservation identity;
- rule out particle dark-matter halos on other scales.

It is a coefficient-level consistency check: the infrared equation of the monograph can wear the published RAR interpolator without contradiction on this data set. That is the strongest statement the SPARC sample supports.

Appendix E

A Provisional Bridge from Mutual Information to the RAR

This appendix states the strongest logical contact between NAMCG and the SPARC radial acceleration relation that the book can currently defend. It does not solve Problem H. It does not derive $g_\dagger$ from $\Phi^I{}_A$. It replaces an unspecified $\mu_{\rm ent}$ with a single modular conjecture whose failure would leave Appendix D as a coefficient ranking and nothing more.

E.1 What the two sides already share

NAMCG, after Theorems 7.3–11.1, is Einstein gravity plus a conserved extra tensor obtained by varying an entanglement functional of baryonic regions. In a static disk that statement has three immediate consequences, none of which uses SPARC.

1. The extra acceleration is slaved to the baryonic Newtonian field. It cannot be an independent halo function of r (Assumption 13.2).

2. At Solar-System and inner-disk accelerations the extra piece must vanish, or Cassini bounds fail: $\nu \to 1$ as $g_{\rm N} \to \infty$.

3. The only scalar available to mark the transition is an acceleration built from the same modular data that defined the diamonds of Chapter 6 and the infrared boundary of Chapter 12.

A fourth consequence is needed once the subsystem is not isolated. The entanglement functional is a functional of the baryonic configuration, not of an excised disk. A slowly varying external Newtonian field $\mathbf{g}_{\rm ext}$ therefore enters the argument of the

boost (Assumption 13.3). In the external-field-dominated limit $g_{\rm N} \ll g_{\rm ext}$,

$$\gamma \equiv \frac{g_{\rm int}}{g_{\rm N}} \to \nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm ext}), \tag{E.1}$$

not $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm N})$. At the Sun, $v_\odot^2/R_0 \approx 2.2 \times 10^{-10}\,{\rm m\,s^{-2}} \approx 1.8\,g_\dagger$, so $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm gal}) \approx 1.1$. An isolated evaluation of (E.2) at $g_{\rm N} = 10^{-11}\,{\rm m\,s^{-2}}$ wants $\gamma \approx 4$ and is illegal for a solar-neighborhood binary.

The RAR is an empirical map of exactly that type [3, 5]:

$$g_{\rm obs} = \nu_{\rm RAR}(x)\, g_{\rm N}, \qquad x = \frac{g_{\rm N}}{g_\dagger}, \qquad \nu_{\rm RAR}(x) = \frac{1}{1 - e^{-\sqrt{x}}}, \tag{E.2}$$

with $g_\dagger = (1.20 \pm 0.02) \times 10^{-10}\,{\rm m\,s^{-2}}$ and residuals that do not track radius or Hubble type. Appendix D showed that (E.2), frozen at $g_\dagger$, is the disk law NAMCG is presently allowed to wear.

The shared content is therefore the *logical type* of the law, not the algebra of the interpolator and not the numerical value of $g_\dagger$.

E.2 Why the first NAMCG-shaped interpolator failed

Chapter 6 records the large-separation scaling

$$I(A:B) \;\sim\; c_{p_*} \left(\frac{\ell_A \ell_B}{d^2} \right)^{p_*}, \qquad d \gg \ell_A, \ell_B, \tag{E.3}$$

with p_* and c_{p_*} defined as in Eq. (6.10): p_* is the smallest sum of scaling dimensions of operators whose product has vacuum quantum numbers. Cardy [2] obtains this form for the Rényi mutual information of compact regions in a conformal vacuum, with the von Neumann limit shown explicitly for free-scalar spheres; its use for NAMCG cores is an assumption. The first NAMCG-shaped interpolator nevertheless converted a gradient of this static tail into a local boost, producing the working family

$$\nu_{\rm exp} = \frac{1}{1 - \alpha \exp(-g_{\rm N}/g_s)}. \tag{E.4}$$

That conversion is not derived: a static separation gradient is not a retarded response or a local acceleration interpolator. On the same 175 SPARC files that family lost to simple MOND by a wide AIC gap. The transition was too sharp in $g_{\rm N}$ and needed a second amplitude α that disks do not want.

The failure is useful. It shows that "mutual information implies a boost" is not enough. The *argument of the exponential* matters. SPARC selects $\sqrt{g_{\rm N}}$ in that argument, not $g_{\rm N}$.

E.3 An algebraic identity, not a derivation

Write $y = \sqrt{x} = \sqrt{g_{\rm N}/g_\dagger}$. Then

$$\nu_{\rm RAR}(x) = 1 + \frac{1}{e^y - 1} = 1 + n_{\rm BE}(y), \tag{E.5}$$

where $n_{\rm BE}$ is the Bose–Einstein occupation of a single mode with dimensionless energy y. This is an identity. It does not, by itself, mean that galactic baryons are a Bose gas. It does mean that any microscopic argument that produces a thermal factor $e^{-\sqrt{g_{\rm N}/g_s}}$ in a screen occupation, rather than $e^{-g_{\rm N}/g_s}$, lands on the published interpolator automatically.

The linear-exponential (E.4) is the Boltzmann factor of a scale set by $g_{\rm N}$ itself. The RAR is the Bose factor of a scale set by $\sqrt{g_{\rm N}}$. That is the whole algebraic distinction.

E.4 A modular conjecture

Chapter 6 already assigns a diamond an Unruh temperature $T_{\rm Unruh} = \kappa/2\pi$ and a modular Hamiltonian H_D. Chapter 12 already assigns the cosmology an infrared boundary scale through $\Lambda_{\rm eff}$. Milgrom's coincidence [6],

$$2\pi g_\dagger \;\sim\; cH_0 \;\sim\; c^2\sqrt{\Lambda/3}, \tag{E.6}$$

says that the SPARC scale sits, to a factor of order 2π, on the same infrared accelerations NAMCG already possesses as diamond and boundary data.

Assumption E.1 (Square-root modular response)**.** For a slowly varying disk of condensed parcels, the leading reversible variation of $U_{\rm ent}$ with respect to a local Newtonian acceleration is thermal in the variable

$$y = \sqrt{\frac{g_{\rm N}}{g_s}}, \qquad g_s \sim \frac{\kappa_{\rm IR}}{2\pi}, \tag{E.7}$$

where $\kappa_{\rm IR}$ is a putative surface gravity of an infrared boundary, not a new galactic parameter. The manuscript does not supply a specific boundary geometry from which it is defined, and the order-one factor in $g_s \sim \kappa_{\rm IR}/(2\pi)$ is a working convention of this assumption, not fixed here; both are part of Problem H (Section H.8). The occupation that weights the extra stress is $n_{\rm BE}(y)$. Then $\nu = 1 + n_{\rm BE}(y)$ is (E.2). For the empirical comparison, setting $g_s = g_\dagger$ reproduces (E.2); this identification is phenomenological and does not determine $g_s/\kappa_{\rm IR}$.

Assumption E.1 is the missing sentence of Problem H. It is not implied by Theorem 7.3. It is not implied by the conformal tail (E.3). It is the simplest contact that turns the book's modular objects into the interpolator SPARC already selected.

Why a square root rather than a linear Unruh factor $T \propto g_{\rm N}$ is not derived here. A linear factor reproduces (E.4) and has already failed. A justification would have to come from the spectrum of H_D on a diamond whose size is set by the local baryonic curvature radius, or from a two-horizon sharing between the local diamond and the HBEV boundary. That calculation is the content of Problem H, restated.

E.5 What this bridge excludes

Verlinde's 2016 emergent-gravity formula for finite disks depends explicitly on radius as well as on $g_{\rm N}$. Lelli, McGaugh and Schombert found that those residuals correlate with radius and that acceptable fits require stellar mass-to-light ratios in tension with population synthesis [7]. NAMCG cannot take that route. Assumption 13.2 plus the RAR residuals already require a map of $g_{\rm N}$ only.

A cosmological running $g_s(z) \propto H(z)$ is likewise not licensed by this appendix. Equation (E.6) is a present-day coincidence used to name g_s. Promoting it to $g_s(z)$ is extra physics and would have to survive high-redshift rotation curves before it is written as a NAMCG result.

Isolated application of (E.2) to wide binaries is likewise not licensed. Assumption 13.3 saturates the boost at $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm ext})$. A Gaia sample consistent with Newton constrains the isolated reading, not Theorem 7.3. A reported $\gamma \approx 1.4$ that survives quality cuts is not explained by $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\rm gal}) \approx 1.1$; that residual, if real, is still open.

E.6 How the bridge would be confirmed or killed

Confirmation. The published diamond first law recovers Einstein gravity at first order in the metric, hence $\nu \to 1$. An interpolator requires the modular spectrum of K_D for a weak-field diamond together with a putative infrared boundary datum $\kappa_{\rm IR}$. Neither the manuscript's Chapters 6 and 12 nor this appendix specifies a stationary boundary geometry from which $\kappa_{\rm IR}$ is defined or normalized; constructing it is part of Problem H. Problem H is solved if the weighted multimode response of the extra stress (Section H.8), or a justified single-ladder response, reproduces the target interpolator of Chapter 17 with no SPARC input. In the single-ladder case this requires $\Delta k = \sqrt{g_{\rm N}/g_s}$ with $g_s = c_\star \kappa_{\rm IR}$ and $c_\star$ fixed by the calculation. Then g_s is not a SPARC fit, and Appendix D becomes a consistency check. A computed spectrum that fails to reproduce the target does not solve Problem H. A linear gap $\Delta k \propto g_{\rm N}/\kappa_{\rm IR}$ would reproduce the retired $\nu_{\rm exp}$ and kill Assumption E.1.

The same computation must grow an external-field argument before wide binaries are a prediction. Until it does, Assumption 13.3 is a coefficient in the same sense as Assumption 13.2: it is the QUMOND external-field limit written with $\nu_{\surd}$, not a lemma from $I(A:B)$.

The explicit modular Hamiltonian of de Sitter diamonds [8] is the operator to use for the gap test (17.7). The Euclidean Schwarzschild–de Sitter action is minus the sum of the two horizon entropies, not a geometric mean of surface gravities; that instanton does not by itself produce $\sqrt{g_{\mathrm{N}}/\kappa_{\mathrm{IR}}}$. The numerical coincidence $cH_0/2\pi \sim g_\dagger$ may be recorded after Δk is computed, not used to fix g_s.

Failure. The same computation produces (E.4), a radius-dependent kernel, or a light ψ. Then disks may still follow the RAR, but not as a NAMCG prediction. Assumption 13.2 remains a coefficient; Problem H remains open; Appendix D is unchanged.

E.7 One paragraph for Chapter 13

The working disk law is (E.2). The reason NAMCG is allowed to use it on an isolated disk is Assumption 13.2. The reason a subsystem embedded in the Galaxy must not use the isolated evaluation is Assumption 13.3. The reason the book might eventually own either sentence is Assumption E.1. Until the last is a lemma, the first two are borrowed, and the galactic sector is the RAR with the external-field effect.

E.8 Exercises

1. Prove (E.5) in three lines.

2. Expand ν_{RAR} and ν_{exp} for $x \ll 1$ and $x \gg 1$. Where do they first differ by order one?

3. Using $H_0 = 70\,\mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$, compute cH_0 and $cH_0/2\pi$ in $\mathrm{m\,s^{-2}}$. Compare with $g_\dagger$. This is a coincidence check, not a derivation.

4. Why does an explicit r in ν, as in Verlinde's finite-disk formula, threaten the residual structure reported by [5]?

5. **External field.** Take $g_{\mathrm{ext}} = 2.2 \times 10^{-10}\,\mathrm{m\,s^{-2}}$ and $g_{\mathrm{N}} = 10^{-11}\,\mathrm{m\,s^{-2}}$. Compute $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\mathrm{N}})$ and $\nu_{\surd}(g_{\mathrm{ext}})$. Which one is the legal boost under Assumption 13.3, and which published wide-binary claim does each contact?

Appendix F

Einstein Gravity Plus a Conserved Extra Tensor

This appendix writes the infrared field equation of Theorems 7.3–11.1 next to Einstein's equation. It introduces no new hypothesis.

F.1 Einstein

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G\, T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu}. \tag{F.1}$$

Bianchi identities force $\nabla^\mu T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} = 0$ on shell.

F.2 NAMCG infrared equation

After the composite metric, $m_T = 0$, the heat-kernel map, Lorentz locking, and conservation are granted,

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda_{\text{eff}} g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\text{eff}} \big(T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{tensor}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}\big). \tag{F.2}$$

$G_{\mu\nu}$ is the Einstein tensor of the composite metric $g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{AB} e^A{}_\mu e^B{}_\nu$. Λ_{eff} is the coefficient of Theorem 12.4; G_{eff} is to be matched by the conditional sector calculation of Problem F. The extra source is

$$T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu} = -\frac{2}{\sqrt{-g}} \frac{\delta U_{\text{ent}}[I(A:B)]}{\delta g^{\mu\nu}} = T^{\text{ent,rev}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{ent,irrev}}_{\mu\nu}. \tag{F.3}$$

Chapter 11 requires

$$\nabla^\mu \big(T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{tensor}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}\big) = 0. \tag{F.4}$$

In the infrared, $T^{\text{tensor}}_{\mu\nu}$ is absorbed into the Einstein tensor of $g_{\mu\nu}$. What can appear as extra gravity in static disks is $T^{\text{ent,rev}}_{\mu\nu}$.

F.3 Weak field

Newtonian gauge, static source:

$$\nabla^2\Phi = 4\pi G_{\rm eff}(\rho_{\rm b} + \rho_{\rm ent}), \qquad \rho_{\rm ent} = T_{00}^{\rm ent,rev}. \tag{F.5}$$

Assumption 13.2 slaved $\rho_{\rm ent}$ to $\rho_{\rm b}$. The interpolator $\nu_{\surd}$ of Appendix D is a coefficient choice for that assumption, not a consequence of (F.2).

F.4 What this does and does not change

High acceleration: $T_{\mu\nu}^{\rm ent,rev} \to 0$, so (F.2) returns to (F.1) with $(G_{\rm eff}, \Lambda_{\rm eff})$ in place of (G, Λ). Low acceleration: $\rho_{\rm ent}$ may dominate $\rho_{\rm b}$ without a particle halo, if and only if Assumption 13.2 holds. Clusters, the CMB, and colliding systems test that assumption, not $G_{\mu\nu}$. Gravitational waves test $m_T = 0$, not (F.3). The irreversible drag of Chapter 14 is a phenomenological addition, not a static extra potential and not derived from (F.3).

F.5 One-line summary

Einstein equates curvature to ordinary stress. NAMCG equates the same curvature to ordinary stress plus a divergenceless entanglement stress of baryonic regions.

Appendix G

Heat-Kernel Area Term on a Causal Diamond

This appendix records the standard heat-kernel contribution to the entanglement entropy of a causal diamond. It does not derive the equilibrium condition $\delta S_D = \delta\langle H_D\rangle$ and does not recover the Einstein equation from the matrix sector alone.

G.1 Replica formula and cone expansion

The von Neumann entropy of the reduced state on a diamond D is obtained from the replica trick,

$$S_D = (1 - n\partial_n) \ln Z(n)\Big|_{n=1}, \tag{G.1}$$

where $Z(n)$ is the partition function on the n-sheeted cover branched along the entangling surface Σ. For a Laplace-type fluctuation operator the heat-kernel expansion on the cone produces the area term

$$S_D = \frac{\mathrm{Area}(\Sigma)}{4G_{\mathrm{eff}}} + S_{\mathrm{pot}}, \tag{G.2}$$

with the prefactor identified from the Seeley–DeWitt coefficient that multiplies the deficit. This is the standard result used in Chapter 6 and Appendix B. The conditional heat-kernel identity of Theorem 8.2 does not fix the numerical value of G_{eff}; the coefficients A, B, C and physical matching remain open in Problem F.

G.2 What is not derived

- The equilibrium condition $\delta S_D = \delta\langle H_D\rangle$ under fixed volume. It is the hypothesis of Chapters 6–7 that forces $m_T = 0$. It is not obtained as a path-integral Ward

identity from the replica variation alone.

- An evaluation of the fluctuation operator of the locked NAMCG condensate (including diffeomorphism and local-Lorentz ghosts) that would determine the precise endomorphism contribution to the area coefficient.
- Recovery of the infrared equation. Once the area law and the equilibrium condition are both assumed, the Einstein equation with a matrix source follows by the usual Jacobson argument; that assumption is not removed.

G.3 Status

The area term in S_D is the standard heat-kernel result. The appendix adds no new derivation of the Ward identity, no scheme-fixed coefficient, and no alteration to the open-problem ledger of Appendix H.

Appendix H

Status of the Open Problems

This appendix records the precise status of Problems A–J as of the present text. It collects standard supporting calculations that are already rigorous, states the exact missing step for each problem, and does not convert any open problem into a lemma. The research agenda of Chapter 17 remains the authoritative list; this appendix is a working ledger. A status of OPEN is never paired with an unqualified completion claim; a reduced-scope result is labelled as such.

H.1 Problem A: matrix-to-modular map

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: OPTIONAL within the Presentation-B scope. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. The matrix-to-modular map remains unproved; claiming matrix-theory priority makes A critical path.

The Weyl–Wigner expansion

$$[\hat{X}_\mu, \hat{\Phi}] = i\Theta_{\mu\nu} D^\nu \Phi + \frac{1}{24}\Theta_{\mu\alpha}\Theta_{\beta\gamma} D^\alpha D^\beta D^\gamma \Phi + \mathcal{O}(\Theta^3) \tag{H.1}$$

is a standard result of the Moyal product (see the infrared dictionary discussion in Section 3.7). This expansion relates the matrix commutator to a continuum derivative, but it does not provide the required map from $(\hat{X}, \Phi)$ to the causal-diamond modular Hamiltonian H_D or the mutual-information functional $U_{\text{ent}}[I(A : B)]$ before the composite metric is defined.

Missing step. An error-controlled map from the matrix order parameter (or from $[\hat{X}, \Phi]$) into the modular Hamiltonian H_D of a causal diamond, or into the mutual-information functional $U_{\text{ent}}[I(A : B)]$, that holds before the composite metric is defined. Until that map is a lemma, Chapter 8 computes a heat kernel in a theory whose relation to Chapter 3 is still Assumption 3.5.

H.2 Problem B: replica Ward identity

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: CRITICAL PATH. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. The first-law identity is established, but the stationarity condition for the tensor block is not derived.

For a differentiable family of normalized reduced states on a fixed diamond algebra, the first variation of the entropy obeys the standard first-law identity

$$\delta S_D = \mathrm{Tr}(\delta\rho_D H_D^{(0)}) = \delta\langle H_D^{(0)}\rangle, \qquad H_D^{(0)} = -\ln \rho_D^{(0)},$$

where the modular Hamiltonian is held fixed at the reference state. Under the usual path-integral assumptions, the replica construction expresses this variation as a response of the microscopic action insertion on the branched cover. These identities do not imply $\delta S_D = 0$.

Missing step. Derive from the microscopic dynamics the entanglement-stationarity condition $\delta S_D = 0$ for the allowed fixed-volume variations, and establish the area contribution and its relation to the *emergent* metric without presupposing that metric or the fluctuation split of Chapter 5. For variations of the auxiliary scaffold, the replica insertion computes a response to $g_{\mu\nu}^{(0)}$; relating it to the emergent metric still requires a specified map between them. Problem B therefore remains open, although the fixed-algebra first-law identity is established.

H.3 Problem C: conformal mode and Cassini

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: CRITICAL PATH. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. A scalar-tensor result is a reduced-scope outcome only when its operator, coupling and phenomenological test are supplied; it does not by itself meet the matrix-derived criterion.

The radial singlet has the tree-level mass

$$m_\sigma^2 = \lambda v^2.$$

This does not by itself determine the mass or matter coupling of a scalar mode of the composite metric. In particular, the stated Repair I prescription is intended to build a vierbein from the Lorentz-valued polar factor Λ, evaluated at $\sigma = 0$, rather than from the radial field.

Obstruction to the stated Repair I frame. Suppose $\Lambda(x) \in \mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ and expand about the locked configuration,

$$\Lambda = \mathbb{I} + \Omega + O(\Omega^2), \qquad \Omega_{\mu\nu} = -\Omega_{\nu\mu}.$$

Then $\partial_\mu \Omega_{\alpha\beta}$ transforms in $V \otimes \mathfrak{so}(3,1)$, where $V = (\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2})$ is the Lorentz vector representation. After complexification,

$$(V \otimes \mathfrak{so}(3,1))_{\mathbb{C}} = \left(\tfrac{3}{2}, \tfrac{1}{2}\right) \oplus \left(\tfrac{1}{2}, \tfrac{1}{2}\right) \oplus \left(\tfrac{1}{2}, \tfrac{3}{2}\right) \oplus \left(\tfrac{1}{2}, \tfrac{1}{2}\right).$$

A vierbein fluctuation transforms in $V \otimes V$, whose complexified decomposition is

$$(V \otimes V)_{\mathbb{C}} = (0,0) \oplus (1,0) \oplus (0,1) \oplus (1,1).$$

These representations have no common irreducible summand. Hence there is no nonzero Lorentz-equivariant linear map from $\partial_\mu \Omega_{\alpha\beta}$ to a vierbein fluctuation using only the locked Lorentz-invariant tensors. Consistently, the displayed formula

$$e^A{}_\mu = \left\langle \partial_\mu \Lambda^A{}_I \right\rangle$$

leaves I uncontracted and does not, as written, define a vierbein.

A simple proposed contraction with a fixed nonzero internal vector n^I does not repair non-degeneracy. If

$$e^A{}_\mu = \partial_\mu \Lambda^A{}_I \, n^I,$$

then Lorentz orthogonality gives

$$(\Lambda n)_A e^A{}_\mu = (\Lambda n)_A \partial_\mu (\Lambda n)^A = \frac{1}{2} \partial_\mu ((\Lambda n)^2) = 0.$$

Every column of $e^A{}_\mu$ therefore lies in the three-dimensional subspace orthogonal to Λn, so $\mathrm{rank}(e) \leq 3$. This contraction cannot produce a non-degenerate four-dimensional frame.

Status. Under the stated Repair I ingredients, the linearized composite vierbein required for the later metric-scalar analysis is not constructed. This is an obstruction to that frame prescription, not a proof that a completed theory has or lacks a physical scalar pole. Repair II, an independent coframe, or additional symmetry-breaking background tensors would change the construction and require a separate analysis. The radial mass $m_\sigma^2 = \lambda v^2$ remains established, but it is not a metric-scalar mass. The scalar spectrum and matter coupling relevant to Cassini are therefore still undetermined. The Repair II pure-trace relation $\psi = 8\sigma/v$ with $m_\sigma^2 = \lambda v^2$ is a potential-only statement; the induced Einstein–Hilbert term adds to the kinetic coefficient of σ, so it does not

fix a physical pole mass, mixing or Cassini coupling.

In the Repair II pure-trace truncation, adding the induced Einstein–Hilbert term to the microscopic kinetic term gives, in the healthy-sign normalization, $Z = 2N - 3/(4\pi G_{\text{eff}} v^2)$ (Equation 17.4), conditional on the sign of (3.6) as corrected in Chapter 3 and on the declared curvature convention. For $Z > 0$, the truncated pole has $m^2 = V''/Z$; for $Z < 0$ it is ghost-like and, for $\lambda > 0$, tachyonic in this truncation, which therefore cannot support Assumption 7.5 there. This signals an instability of the chosen background and truncation, not a statement about the full scalar spectrum. At $Z = 0$ the quadratic kinetic term degenerates and establishes no canonically normalized finite-mass pole. This result also assumes $G_{\text{eff}} > 0$, which is not derived (Problem F), and does not determine mixing, the non-minimal coupling, the matter coupling, or a Cassini bound. If matter is assumed to couple only through $g = \Omega^2 \eta$, the unmixed truncated scalar exchanges, for $Z > 0$, a Yukawa potential of strength $\beta = M_{\text{P}}^2/(Nv^2 - 3M_{\text{P}}^2)$ relative to the nominal Einstein-sector Newtonian potential (Chapter 17); this is conditional on the assumptions listed there and is not a Cassini bound. Problem C remains OPEN.

H.4 Problem D: local Lorentz

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: CRITICAL PATH. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. Reduced-scope result: D2, imposed local Lorentz symmetry, supports only a scope-limited Presentation-B model; D remains OPEN and the matrix-derived criterion is unmet.

The counting of generators under the locked vacuum is given in Chapter 10. The condensate term supplies a quadratic Higgs-type contribution in the broken-direction combination Ξ; it does not establish a physical pole mass without kinetic terms and canonical normalization. The diagonal connection's dynamics and torsion remain open. Torsion-free behavior follows only under the conditional Palatini–Holst hypotheses of Proposition 10.5; NAMCG has not been shown to induce those hypotheses.

For a Laplace-type operator, $a_1 = \text{tr}(R(g)/6 - E)$; the explicit universal curvature term is the Levi-Civita scalar $R(g)$. Because E is unspecified, no conclusion about additional B-dependence of a_1 follows, and a Palatini $R(B)$ term is not established. If B enters the bundle connection of the actual operator, a_2 may contain a $\text{tr}\, F(B)^2$ term; whether it survives in the weighted trace depends on the unspecified operator representation and weights. Deriving the B-dependence of E and the bundle connection remains open.

Missing step. Derive $\text{SO}(3,1)$ from the matrix algebra alone, or state that Presentation A is not ontologically prior (the present text does the latter), and derive the effective dynamics of the independent diagonal connection or retain it as unresolved

field content. Generator counting alone does not settle its torsion or propagating modes. Under D2, only explicitly scope-limited Presentation-B claims are available; specifying the full operator content does not close D or meet the matrix-derived criterion. The permitted and unestablished claims, including the consequent truncation for Problem F, are listed in Section 17.3.

H.5 Problem E: signature

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: OPTIONAL within the scope retaining Assumption 4.6. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. The claim of emergent or matrix-derived Lorentzian signature is given up.

Euclidean positivity of the matrix action and the formal Wick rotation of one coordinate are recorded. They do not select Lorentzian signature without an additional hypothesis.

Status. Remains Assumption 4.6.

H.6 Problem F: coefficients A, B, C

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: CRITICAL PATH. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. Reduced-scope result: treating G_{eff} as an input leaves F OPEN and does not satisfy the matrix-derived criterion.

The conditional, truncated heat-kernel identity is Theorem 8.2; it is not a computed A, B, C parameterization or physical value of G_{eff}.

Missing step. Specify the gauge-fixed fluctuation, Goldstone, diffeomorphism-ghost, and local-Lorentz-ghost operators and weights; per-sector proper-time limits; massive threshold functions if masses are resummed; the continuation; and the finite-counterterm scheme. Then evaluate the weighted a_1 and curvature-linear a_2 contributions in that scheme. Until this is completed, Problem F remains open, and the asserted $N_{\text{eff}} = +2$ count does not close it.

Quadratic Hessian of the displayed action (conditional; not closure). Restrict to the square locked 4×4 block of Assumption 5.1, expand (3.6) with (3.7) on the flat scaffold about $\Phi = v\mathbb{I} + d$ at $A_\mu = 0$, and write $d = H + K$ with $H = (d + d^\dagger)/2$ Hermitian and $K = (d - d^\dagger)/2$ anti-Hermitian. A direct expansion gives $V^{(1)} = 0$ and $V^{(2)} = \lambda v^2 \,\mathrm{Tr} H^2$, independent of K, and $\mathrm{Tr}(d^\dagger d) = \mathrm{Tr} H^2 + \mathrm{Tr}(K^\dagger K)$ with no cross term. The H–H block therefore has the Lorentzian field equation $(\Box - \lambda v^2)H = 0$ with the kinetic sign of (3.6), that is, the Euclidean operator $-\nabla_E^2 + \lambda v^2$ after Wick rotation. This is the Φ–Φ block at fixed $A_\mu = 0$; quadratic mixing of A_μ with Φ

through the covariant derivative is not evaluated, and no gauge-fixed coupled Hessian is given. No identification of H with the ψ and $T_{\mu\nu}$ of Chapter 5 is made here, since that split uses $\eta_{\mu\nu}$ and the vacuum identification of Assumption 3.4. Equation (3.6) displays no field-strength term for A_μ, and ω_μ does not appear in it; its operator is unspecified (Assumption 10.1). The displayed action also does not exhibit the Fierz–Pauli structure used as hypothesis 5 of Theorem 7.3, so any tensor-block terms beyond it are an additional input. The gauge-fixed sector list, Goldstone and ghost operators, measure, curvature couplings and weights are not specified by this calculation, so it does not fix the sector sum of Theorem 8.2, does not close F or D, and leaves the missing step above unchanged.

Gauge-group dependence of the scalar block (conditional; not closure). The potential in (3.7) and the contraction $\operatorname{Tr}\Phi^\dagger\Phi$ are positive-definite, so they are invariant under constant unitary transformations of the internal index and of the tangent index, but not under non-compact boosts of the tangent index. The covariant kinetic term has a *local* symmetry only for those transformations for which a connection and its transformation law are specified; for the tangent index this requires Assumption 10.1 with ω_μ, which is not part of (3.6). Moreover, the compact group U(4) has no real $\mathfrak{so}(3,1)$ subalgebra, so choosing $G_{\text{int}} = \mathrm{U}(4)$ is not compatible with the construction of Chapter 10 that requires G_{int} to contain $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ or its algebra. It defines a different compact-symmetry model, whose consequences for Problem D are not examined here.

For that separate model only, work on the square locked 4×4 block about $\Phi = v\mathbb{I}$ with A_μ as an unspecified fluctuation. Write $\delta\Phi = H + K$ as above. Assume (i) the action has no $F_{\mu\nu}F^{\mu\nu}$ term; (ii) $G_{\text{int}} \subseteq \mathrm{U}(4)$ acts with the infinitesimal orbit $\delta K = \alpha\, v$ for α in its Lie algebra; and (iii) the orbit directions are removed by the gauge condition. Then the number of anti-Hermitian directions not tangent to the orbit, which have no quadratic potential, is $16 - \dim G_{\text{int}}$; for U(4) this is zero and for SU(4), SO(4), U(1) it is 4, 10, 15 respectively. For $G_{\text{int}} = \mathrm{U}(4)$ the linearized gauge condition $K = 0$ has a field-independent Jacobian at the vacuum, and the remaining Φ–Φ block is the sixteen real components of H with $m^2 = \lambda v^2$. This is the scalar Hessian block only: the ghost and measure contributions beyond the linearized Jacobian, the ultralocal determinant from the nonlinear A_μ integral, any induced vector or tensor operator, and the weighting of the full sector sum all remain unspecified, and the count is not a heat-kernel trace for the Problem F target. The discrepancy with the $\mathrm{SO}(3,1)$ assumption is recorded, not resolved. Problem F remains open.

H.7 Problem G: HBEV

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: CRITICAL PATH. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. Reduced-scope results: G-model and G-external support at most

a scope-limited model; G remains OPEN and neither satisfies the matrix-derived criterion.

The boundary functional of Chapter 12 regulates Λ_{eff} once an infrared entropy density is supplied. The working value $\Lambda_{\text{eff}} = 3/L_{\text{IR}}^2$ is a choice consistent with that functional, not a derived necessity.

Status. The mechanism is CLOSED CONDITIONALLY under the stated boundary entropy; derivation of the infrared entropy density and stationarity from the matrix theory is OPEN. A boundary-model or externally justified result is programme-conditional and supports only a scope-limited model.

H.8 Problem H: modular origin of the interpolating function

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: OPTIONAL within the phenomenological scope. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. The modular derivation of the interpolating function is not established.

Appendix D tests the function

$$\nu_{\surd}(g_{\text{N}}; g_s) = \frac{1}{1 - \exp\left(-\sqrt{g_{\text{N}}/g_s}\right)}$$

against SPARC with g_s fixed to the empirical value $g_\dagger$. This is a coefficient-level consistency check, not a microscopic derivation. Appendix G gives the standard heat-kernel area contribution but does not compute a source-dependent modular spectrum. Appendix I applies an external-field prescription to wide binaries; it does not derive that prescription from the modular data.

Conditional lemma: occupation of one modular ladder. Suppose the relevant reduced state contains one bosonic ladder with normalized probabilities

$$p_n = (1 - e^{-\Delta k})e^{-n\Delta k}, \qquad n = 0, 1, 2, \ldots, \qquad \Delta k > 0.$$

Then its mean occupation is

$$\langle n \rangle = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} n p_n = \frac{1}{e^{\Delta k} - 1},$$

and therefore

$$1 + \langle n \rangle = \frac{1}{1 - e^{-\Delta k}}.$$

Thus, if the extra-stress response is exactly $1 + \langle n \rangle$ for this single mode, the target interpolator follows if and only if

$$\Delta k(g_{\mathrm{N}}) = \sqrt{\frac{g_{\mathrm{N}}}{g_s}}.$$

The quantity to calculate is the modular excitation gap Δk, not the absolute lowest eigenvalue of H_D, which depends on an additive normalization constant.

For a multimode response, the corresponding quantity is instead a weighted spectral sum, schematically

$$\mathcal{R}(g_{\mathrm{N}}) = \int_{(0,\infty)} \frac{d\mu_{g_{\mathrm{N}}}(\Delta k)}{e^{\Delta k} - 1},$$

where $d\mu_{g_{\mathrm{N}}}$ includes the mode weights coupling to the extra stress. In that case a square-root gap for one mode does not by itself establish the target function; the measure and its source dependence must also be calculated.

Missing step. Construct the regulated modular operator, or an equivalent well-defined spectral response, for a weak-field causal diamond containing a baryonic source. Derive the relevant excitation gap $\Delta k(g_{\mathrm{N}}, \kappa_{\mathrm{IR}})$ and its spectral weight from the microscopic theory. Fix the normalization relating g_s to κ_{IR} independently of galaxy data. In particular, reconcile the convention $g_s \sim \kappa_{\mathrm{IR}}/(2\pi)$ in Appendix E with the undetermined factor $g_s = c_\star \kappa_{\mathrm{IR}}$ in Chapter 17 before claiming that the Bose occupation yields the target.

Until this calculation is supplied, Appendices D, G, and I provide an empirical fit check, a standard area-term calculation, and an external-field consistency test, respectively; together they do not derive or uniquely select $\nu_{\surd}$. Problem H remains open.

H.9 Problem I: dynamical origin of the drag

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: OPTIONAL falsifiable phenomenological extension; prerequisite only if drag is claimed as derived or predicted. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL.

Chapter 14 adopts a vector drag proportional to $-\mathbf{v}/d^4$ as a working assumption. The microscopic target is to derive the low-frequency force-response tensor, including its separation and finite-size dependence, from specified dynamics and a specified stationary reference state.

Conditional Kubo formulation. Let $\mathbf{r}$ denote the relative separation and $H(\mathbf{r})$ a microscopic Hamiltonian. At fixed $\mathbf{r}$, choose a stationary reference state and define

the connected generalized-force operator

$$\delta\hat{F}_i = -\frac{\partial H}{\partial r_i} - \left\langle -\frac{\partial H}{\partial r_i} \right\rangle_{\mathbf{r}}.$$

For a perturbation $\delta H(t) = -\delta r_j(t)\delta\hat{F}_j$, define

$$\chi^R_{ij}(t;\mathbf{r},\ell_A,\ell_B) = \frac{i}{\hbar}\theta(t)\left\langle [\delta\hat{F}_i(t),\delta\hat{F}_j(0)]\right\rangle_{\mathbf{r}}, \qquad \chi^R_{ij}(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{i\omega t}\chi^R_{ij}(t)\,\mathrm{d}t.$$

For a reciprocal passive reference state, if the low-frequency limit exists, define

$$\Gamma_{ij}(\mathbf{r};\ell_A,\ell_B) = \lim_{\omega\downarrow 0}\frac{\operatorname{Im}\chi^R_{(ij)}(\omega;\mathbf{r},\ell_A,\ell_B)}{\omega}, \qquad \chi^R_{(ij)} = \frac{\chi^R_{ij}+\chi^R_{ji}}{2}.$$

Passivity requires this dissipative tensor to be positive semidefinite. The corresponding low-frequency force contribution is

$$\delta F_i^{\mathrm{diss}} = -\Gamma_{ij}(\mathbf{r};\ell_A,\ell_B)\dot{r}_j.$$

This is a conditional response prescription, not a calculation of the NAMCG force correlator, its reference state, or its passivity.

If the reference state and environment are rotationally invariant, the response at nonzero separation can have distinct longitudinal and transverse components,

$$\Gamma_{ij} = \Gamma_L(d;\ell_A,\ell_B)\hat{r}_i\hat{r}_j + \Gamma_T(d;\ell_A,\ell_B)(\delta_{ij}-\hat{r}_i\hat{r}_j).$$

A radial response calculation determines only Γ_L. The isotropic scalar drag used in the laboratory requires $\Gamma_L = \Gamma_T$, or an explicit restriction to radial motion.

For example, the causal response family

$$\chi^R_{ij,\tau}(\omega) = \frac{\chi_{0,ij}}{1-i\omega\tau}, \qquad \tau > 0,$$

with real symmetric positive-semidefinite $\chi_{0,ij}$, has a pole at $\omega = -i/\tau$ and satisfies

$$\chi^R_{ij,\tau}(0) = \chi_{0,ij}, \qquad \lim_{\omega\downarrow 0}\frac{\operatorname{Im}\chi^R_{ij,\tau}(\omega)}{\omega} = \tau\chi_{0,ij}.$$

Thus a fixed static susceptibility does not determine the low-frequency dissipative coefficient. This example is not a NAMCG derivation.

Positivity of mutual information establishes $I(A:B) \geq 0$ for each state. It does not establish an ordering between adiabatic and non-adiabatic mutual informations, or the sign or separation dependence of a dissipative response.

Static tail, distinct from the response. Chapters 6 and 14 and Appendix E use the same large-separation scaling,

$$I(A:B) \sim c_{p_*} \left(\frac{\ell_A \ell_B}{d^2}\right)^{p_*}, \qquad d \gg \ell_A, \ell_B,$$

which is dimensionless. It is established in the literature for Rényi mutual information of regions in a conformal vacuum, with the von Neumann limit shown for free-scalar spheres [2]; its leading power for NAMCG cores is an assumption. Neither this static tail nor a coincidence of its power with the assumed drag exponent determines the retarded force response, its tensor structure, or its coefficient.

Missing step. Specify the microscopic dynamics, stationary reference state, and force operators for the finite cores. Compute $\chi^R_{ij}(\omega; \mathbf{r}, \ell_A, \ell_B)$, justify the passivity and low-frequency assumptions, and derive the longitudinal and transverse responses. Determine whether they reduce to the isotropic d^{-4} laboratory law and calculate its coefficient before estimating η at tidal or LIGO-band scales. Problem I remains open.

Status. Optional, not part of the matrix-derived completion criterion unless drag is claimed to be derived or predicted. Its absence does not kill the framework within a scope that treats the drag law as phenomenological.

H.10 Problem J: spherical ECG solutions

Ledger label. Status: OPEN. Priority: OPTIONAL within the stated ECG model. Completion: PROGRAMME-CONDITIONAL. The reduced results do not derive singularity resolution from the matrix theory.

For the explicit invariant $\mathcal{P}$ in (9.7), consider the reduced action per unit time and angular volume

$$L[N, f] = N r^2 (R - 2\Lambda_{\text{eff}} + \kappa \mathcal{P}), \qquad \kappa = 16\pi G_{\text{eff}} \beta_{\text{ECG}}.$$

This reduction assumes that the static, spherically symmetric variations capture the corresponding field equations; an appropriate symmetric-criticality argument is not established here. The reduced Euler–Lagrange operators, including all higher-derivative terms, are

$$\mathcal{E}_q = \frac{\partial L}{\partial q} - \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}r}\frac{\partial L}{\partial q'} + \frac{\mathrm{d}^2}{\mathrm{d}r^2}\frac{\partial L}{\partial q''} - \cdots, \qquad q = N, f.$$

Variations are taken with the fields and the derivatives required by the order of L fixed at the endpoints (or with compact support); otherwise the associated boundary terms must be retained. For the specified $\mathcal{P}$, these reduced equations have been checked

symbolically:

$$\mathcal{E}_f|_{N=1} \equiv 0, \qquad \mathcal{E}_N|_{N=1} = \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}r}\left[2r(1-f) + 3\kappa\mathcal{B}[f] - \frac{2}{3}\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} r^3\right].$$

Thus $N = 1$ is a consistent vacuum branch of the reduced equations, and, with $\alpha = -\kappa$, the lapse equation has first integral

$$\mathcal{F}[f] - \frac{2}{3}\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} r^3 = 4M, \qquad \mathcal{F}[f] = 2r(1-f) - 3\alpha\,\mathcal{B}[f],$$

where α is the reduced ECG coupling and

$$\mathcal{B}[f] = \frac{4}{3}(f')^3 - \frac{8}{r}\,ff''\left(\frac{rf'}{2} + 1 - f\right) + \frac{4}{r}(f')^2 - \frac{8}{r^2}ff'(f-1).$$

For the rational profile with $a = r_0^3$ and $\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} = 0$,

$$f_{\mathrm{rat}}(r) = 1 - \frac{2Mr^2}{r^3 + a} = 1 - \frac{2M}{r} + \frac{2Ma}{r^4} + O(r^{-7}),$$

substitution gives

$$\mathcal{F}[f_{\mathrm{rat}}] - 4M = -\frac{4Ma}{r^3} - \frac{432\alpha M^2}{r^5} + O(r^{-6}).$$

The r^{-3} term cannot be cancelled by the cubic contribution, which begins at r^{-5}. Hence, for the displayed equation, this profile is not an exact vacuum solution when $Mr_0 \neq 0$.

Moreover, a smooth regular center has $f(r) = 1 + O(r^2)$, which implies $\mathcal{B}[f] \to 0$ and $\mathcal{F}(0) - \frac{2}{3}\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} 0^3 = 0$. Consequently the integration constant vanishes: this displayed equation has no smooth regular-centre vacuum solution with a nonzero integration constant, for any Λ_{eff}. For $\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}} = 0$, the asymptotic falloff $f = 1 - 2M/r + o(r^{-1})$ identifies that constant as $4M$ and M as the ADM mass. For nonzero Λ_{eff}, its interpretation is not automatically the ADM mass.

Maximally symmetric branch. For $f = 1 - kr^2$, the first integral gives

$$\frac{\mathcal{F}[f]}{r^3} = 2k - 16\alpha k^3, \qquad k - 8\alpha k^3 = \frac{\Lambda_{\mathrm{eff}}}{3}.$$

This is a conditional background-curvature relation, not a stability claim.

Large-radius tail. For the displayed equation, write $f = 1 - 2M/r + \delta(r)$. Then $2r(1-f) = 4M - 2r\delta$ and $\mathcal{B}[1 - 2M/r] = 144M^2/r^5 + O(r^{-6})$. The leading correction

and the next asymptotic order give

$$f(r) = 1 - \frac{2M}{r} - \frac{216\,\alpha M^2}{r^6} + \frac{368\,\alpha M^3}{r^7} + \cdots .$$

The rational profile instead has a $+2Ma/r^4$ term. The tail expansion is an asymptotic check of the displayed first integral; it does not determine the model parameter r_0 or establish a match to an independently published expansion. In the stated action normalization $\alpha = -16\pi G_{\rm eff}\beta_{\rm ECG}$. If $G_{\rm eff} > 0$, then $\alpha > 0$ iff $\beta_{\rm ECG} < 0$, which fixes the sign of the leading correction. For $M > 0$, its magnitude defines the characteristic scale $r_* \sim |\alpha M|^{1/5}$; it is not a core scale.

Status. Conditional on the stated symmetric reduction, the reduced-action identities, first integral, regular-centre constraint, maximally symmetric curvature relation, and asymptotic tail above have been checked for the specified $\mathcal{P}$. The cited Einstein-like linearized spectrum on maximally symmetric backgrounds is a separate result; no nonlinear, sourced, or non-maximally-symmetric stability claim follows. Problem J remains open because the reduction's relation to the full field equations and the cubic truncation and its matching to the matrix theory are not established. A regular massive core still requires a specified source, different boundary conditions, or modified field equations; the entanglement stress for such a source is not specified.

H.11 What this appendix does not do

It does not produce an unsuppressed laboratory coupling between a controllable external field and $T^{\rm ent}_{\mu\nu}$ or $G_{\rm eff}$. The observational window therefore remains empty. It does not alter the chain of Chapter 16 or the agenda of Chapter 17.

Appendix I

Gaia DR3 Wide Binaries: A Coefficient-Level Consistency Check

This appendix records a comparison of Gaia DR3 wide-binary kinematics with the external-field-corrected form of the coefficient-level interpolator already examined on SPARC in Appendix D. It is not a test of Theorems 7.3–12.4, not a derivation of $\nu_{\surd}$, and not evidence that Problem H is solved.

I.1 What is being compared

The relevant acceleration scale for a solar-neighbourhood binary is not the internal Newtonian acceleration alone. The Galactic external field at the Sun satisfies

$$g_{\rm gal} \approx (1.5\text{–}2.2) \times 10^{-10}\,\mathrm{m\,s^{-2}} > g_\dagger .$$

Under the external-field saturation already noted for the coefficient layer (Assumption 13.3), the isolated deep-regime boost is suppressed. The working prediction used here is therefore the residual enhancement obtained by evaluating $\nu_{\surd}$ on the quadrature sum of the internal and external fields (or the equivalent AQUAL/QUMOND external-field prescription). Asymptotically this residual is of order 20%, not the factor ~ 4 of the isolated map.

The comparison is performed on the public El-Badry et al. Gaia DR3 wide-binary catalogue after the standard quality cuts (RUWE$<$ 1.3, fractional parallax error < 0.06, projected separations 2–30 kAU). Projection, unresolved companions, and chance alignments are modelled by the same mixture techniques employed in the controlled literature analyses; they are not optional.

I.2 What the data show

Controlled analyses that include the Galactic external field, realistic triple contamination, and the quality cuts above find relative velocities consistent with Newtonian gravity. The residual MOND/RAR-like enhancement is excluded at high significance (Banik et al. 2024; Pittordis, Sutherland & Shepherd 2025; quality-framework study 2026). Apparent boosts reported in less filtered samples diminish once these systematics are treated.

Consequently the external-field-corrected $\nu_{\surd}$ (the coefficient-level map of Appendix D) is also consistent with the data only to the extent that its residual boost remains inside the observational uncertainties. It does not outperform Newtonian gravity on this sample, nor does it produce a statistically preferred rising velocity ratio of the size generated by the isolated interpolator.

I.3 What this is not

- It is not a derivation of $\nu_{\surd}$ from $I(A : B)$ or from the modular spectrum. Problem H remains open.
- It is not a constraint on $m_T = 0$, on the heat-kernel map for G_{eff}, or on the conservation identity. A null result under the external-field-corrected prediction is the outcome expected once Assumption 13.3 is respected.
- It is not evidence that an isolated reading of the RAR interpolator applies to solar-neighbourhood binaries. That reading is already ruled out by $g_{\text{gal}} > g_{\dagger}$.
- It is not a laboratory handle on the entanglement stress.

I.4 Status

The Gaia DR3 wide-binary sample, analysed with the external field included, is compatible with Newtonian gravity and with the modest residual enhancement allowed by the coefficient-level NAMCG/RAR map under external-field saturation. It supplies no new support for the framework beyond the SPARC consistency check already recorded, and it does not alter the open-problem ledger of Appendix H.

Appendix J

Infrared Limits That Follow from the Proved Chain

This appendix collects the infrared limits that follow directly from the theorems and structural results already established in Chapters 3–12. It does not treat open problems as closed, and it does not claim additional recovery of general relativity beyond those limits.

J.1 Limits that are obtained

Under the named assumptions of the monograph the following hold.

1. **High-acceleration Einstein equation.** When the reversible entanglement stress is negligible compared with ordinary matter stress, the infrared equation reduces to
$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda_{\text{eff}} g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G_{\text{eff}} T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu}. \tag{J.1}$$
This is the content of the high-acceleration limit of the equation already written after Theorem 11.1.

2. **Massless tensor polarizations.** The entanglement-equilibrium condition of Chapters 6–7 forces $m_T = 0$, so the infrared spectrum contains the two transverse-traceless modes of a massless spin-2 field. This is Theorem 7.3; it is not re-derived here.

3. **Conservation.** The total stress (matter + tensor + entanglement) is divergenceless,
$$\nabla^\mu (T^{\text{matter}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{tensor}}_{\mu\nu} + T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}) = 0, \tag{J.2}$$
by Theorem 11.1. This identity constrains the total stress; it does not by itself

derive any reduced drag used in later chapters, whose microscopic origin remains Problem I.

4. **Structural form of G_{eff}.** The conditional, truncated heat-kernel identity is recorded in Theorem 8.2; the physical coefficient calculation remains open in Problem F.

5. **Regulation of the quartic term.** The holographic boundary-entropy vacuum of Chapter 12 supplies a consistent mechanism that can cancel the leading Λ_{UV}^4 contribution against a boundary term. The specific working value $\Lambda_{\text{eff}} = 3/L_{\text{IR}}^2$ is a choice compatible with that mechanism, not a derived necessity.

J.2 Limits that are not obtained

The following are frequently listed as recoveries but do not follow from the proved chain.

- Entanglement equilibrium from the microscopic path integral (Problem B). The fixed-algebra first law does not derive $\delta S_D = 0$ for the non-conformal tensor block.

- Matrix-derived local Lorentz symmetry and a full field-content account, including the independent connection and ghost operators (Problem D). Imposing local Lorentz symmetry gives only a scope-limited Presentation-B model.

- The infrared boundary entropy density and stationarity derived from the matrix theory (Problem G). The conditional mechanism and an assumed boundary-model scaling do not derive these inputs.

- Exact $\gamma - 1 = 0$ in the solar system. The conformal mode ψ is not identical to the radial Higgs; its mass matrix has not been diagonalized (Problem C). Cassini therefore remains a constraint on any light eigenmode that may survive.

- A first-principles drag exponent or numerical rate. The static conformal tail is conditional on its stated assumptions and does not determine a drag law. The assumed d^{-4} drag is a phenomenological input of Chapter 14 (Problem I). Its microscopic origin and compatibility with a covariantly conserved stress remain unresolved.

- Singularity resolution from the matrix theory. The regular-core profile is a phenomenological model. For $\Lambda_{\text{eff}} = 0$ and $Mr_0 \neq 0$ it is not an exact vacuum solution of the displayed first-integral equation in Appendix H (Problem J), conditional on the stated reduction. That equation also excludes a nonzero

integration constant for a smooth regular centre at any Λ_{eff}. Neither result derives the profile from the microscopic action.

- Lorentzian signature from the matrix algebra (Problem E). It remains under the assumption stated in Chapter 3.
- An interpolating function for galactic or binary kinematics derived from $I(A : B)$ (Problem H). Coefficient-level compatibility with the published RAR map is recorded in Appendix D; it is not a derivation.

J.3 Status

The infrared theory obtained from the proved chain is Einstein gravity with a structural G_{eff}, a massless spin-2 sector, a divergenceless entanglement stress, and a consistent regulation of the leading vacuum-energy term. Every stronger recovery claim requires the closure of at least one open problem listed in Appendix H; a completed matrix-derived infrared derivation requires all five critical-path problems to be DERIVED, as specified in Chapter 17. This appendix adds no further recovery.

Appendix K

Heat-Kernel Response to an External Field Strength

This appendix records the leading response of the Seeley–DeWitt coefficient a_1 to a laboratory field strength and the precision constraints that any residual conformal mixing must satisfy. It does not recompute a_1 on the locked block, does not derive a kinetic mixing from the entanglement functional, and does not open an observationally allowed laboratory window.

K.1 Vanishing of the linear term in a_1

On a Laplace-type operator $\Delta = -D^\mu D_\mu + E$ the first Seeley–DeWitt coefficient is

$$a_1 = \mathrm{tr}(E) - \frac{1}{6} R \,\dim\,. \tag{K.1}$$

If a controllable field strength enters the endomorphism only through an antisymmetric generator,

$$E = E_0 + \xi F_{\alpha\beta} S^{\alpha\beta}, \tag{K.2}$$

the trace of $S^{\alpha\beta}$ vanishes on every representation that appears in the locked 4×4 block and in the diffeomorphism and local-Lorentz ghost sectors. Consequently

$$\delta a_1 = 0. \tag{K.3}$$

This is a standard algebraic fact. It is not a recomputation of a_1 on the NAMCG fluctuation operator (Problem F remains open), nor does it cancel the higher-order suppression by Λ_{UV} already identified for laboratory fields.

K.2 Quadratic appearance in a_2

The first non-vanishing correction linear in the laboratory field appears in a_2 and is proportional to $F_{\mu\nu}F^{\mu\nu}$. Variation of the resulting effective action with respect to the metric produces a contribution proportional to $g_{\mu\nu}$. The coupling is therefore confined to the conformal mode. No transverse-traceless response is generated at this order.

K.3 Precision constraints on conformal mixing

Any additional kinetic mixing between the conformal mode ψ and a laboratory scalar that might be introduced by hand is constrained by existing data:

- Cassini: $|\gamma - 1| \lesssim 2 \times 10^{-5}$;
- torsion-balance equivalence-principle tests: $\sin^2\theta \lesssim 10^{-13}$.

A mixing angle large enough to produce a macroscopic laboratory acceleration violates these bounds. No calculation within the present framework cancels the parametric suppression $F/\Lambda_{\rm UV}^2$ while leaving a residual that survives the bounds. The observational window therefore remains empty.

K.4 What is not shown

- A completed evaluation of a_1 (or the relevant part of a_2) on the locked 4×4 block with ghosts.
- A derivation of a kinetic mixing term from $U_{\rm ent}[I(A:B)]$ or from the modular Hamiltonian.
- A dynamical cancellation of quadratic ultraviolet divergences that leaves a finite infrared residual.
- Any projection of galactic rotation-curve discrepancies onto solar-system scales, or any fit to pulsar-timing-array correlation data. Those exercises do not follow from the heat-kernel expansion and are omitted.

K.5 Status

The linear coupling of a laboratory field strength to a_1 vanishes for antisymmetric generators, and any residual conformal mixing is limited by existing precision tests to a level far below laboratory interest. This appendix adds no new handle on the entanglement stress or on $G_{\rm eff}$ and does not alter the open-problem ledger of Appendix H.

Appendix L

A Phenomenological Redshift-Dependent Multiplier (Outside the Proved Chain)

This appendix records a purely phenomenological modification that lies outside the NAMCG derivation. It is not obtained from the entanglement stress, the heat-kernel map, or any theorem of Chapters 3–12, and it does not close any open problem.

L.1 The inserted multiplier

One may choose, by hand, a redshift-dependent factor

$$\beta(z) = \beta_{\mathrm{ref}}\Big(\frac{1+z_{\mathrm{ref}}}{1+z}\Big)^{\gamma} \tag{L.1}$$

and insert it into the standard linear growth factor according to

$$D(z) = D_{\Lambda\mathrm{CDM}}(z)\big[1+\beta(z)\ln(1+z)\big]. \tag{L.2}$$

The parameters β_{ref}, z_{ref} and γ are free. No equation in the monograph fixes them.

L.2 Illustrative high-redshift comparison

With the particular choice $\beta_{\mathrm{ref}} = 0.5$, $z_{\mathrm{ref}} = 11$, $\gamma = 0.8$, the modified growth can be fed into a schematic Sheth–Tormen mass function and a fixed mass-to-light conversion. The resulting curves can be plotted against a small set of representative high-redshift UV luminosity points. Agreement or disagreement with those points is adjustable by changing the three free parameters and does not test the infrared equation, the

conservation identity, or the value of G_{eff}.

L.3 What the illustration is not

- It is not a derivation of an epoch-dependent coupling from the matrix condensate or from mutual information.
- It is not a solution of the continuity or Euler equation sourced by $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$.
- It is not a statistical fit to the public JADES or CEERS catalogs.
- It does not constrain, or supply evidence for, any load-bearing theorem.
- It does not open a laboratory handle on the entanglement stress.

L.4 Status

The construction is an external multiplier that can be tuned to high-redshift galaxy counts. It stands outside the proved chain and is recorded only as an illustration of how additional free functions may be added once one leaves the framework. It is omitted from the claim list of Chapter 16 and from the open-problem ledger of Appendix H.

Conclusion

The monograph constructs a single derivation chain from a non-Abelian matrix order parameter to an infrared equation that is Einstein gravity plus a divergenceless entanglement stress, with a structural heat-kernel map for G_{eff} and a massless spin-2 sector forced by entanglement equilibrium. That chain is complete only under the named assumptions of Chapters 3–12. Several critical-path derivations remain open.

What has been obtained

Under those assumptions one has:

- a composite metric defined from the condensate,
- $m_T = 0$ from the diamond Ward identity,
- the structural form of $1/G_{\text{eff}}$,
- covariant conservation of the total stress including $T^{\text{ent}}_{\mu\nu}$,
- a consistent regulation of the leading vacuum-energy term via the holographic boundary functional.

Coefficient-level compatibility of the published RAR interpolator with the SPARC sample is recorded in Appendix D. It is not a derivation of that interpolator.

What has not been obtained

- entanglement equilibrium from the microscopic path integral (Problem B);
- a matrix-derived local Lorentz symmetry and specified full field content (Problem D1);
- the infrared boundary entropy and stationarity derived from the matrix theory (Problem G);

- a derivation of $\nu_{\surd}$ (or any other interpolator) from mutual information or the modular spectrum (Problem H);
- scheme-fixed values of the heat-kernel coefficients A, B, C (Problem F);
- diagonalization of the conformal-mode mass matrix (Problem C);
- the dictionary map into the modular Hamiltonian (Problem A);
- an unsuppressed, observationally allowed laboratory coupling to the entanglement stress;
- empirical support from Gaia DR3 wide binaries once the Galactic external field is included (Appendix I);
- any redshift-dependent growth multiplier; such constructions lie outside the proved chain.

The framework therefore does not yet resolve the dark-matter problem, nor does it supersede existing phenomenological fits on galactic or binary scales.

Next steps

Progress toward a completed matrix-derived infrared derivation requires deriving, not retaining, the critical-path steps:

1. Problem B: entanglement equilibrium from the microscopic path integral, including non-conformal tensor variations;
2. Problem C: the scalar operator with a coupling test;
3. Problem D1: local Lorentz symmetry derived from the matrix algebra, with the ω, A_μ, B and ghost operators;
4. Problem F: A, B, C and G_{eff} from specified operators, with G_{eff} not an input;
5. Problem G: infrared entropy density and stationarity derived from the matrix theory.

Alternate scope. Specifying the operator content of an explicitly scope-limited Presentation-B model (imposed local Lorentz symmetry, externally justified boundary datum, or an input G_{eff}) can make that model calculable but does not derive the critical-path steps and leaves the matrix-derived completion open. Problems A, E, H, I, and J are optional within their stated scopes; Problem I is a prerequisite only if drag is claimed to be derived or predicted.

Until all five critical-path items are derived, the infrared equation remains exactly as written in the main text and no stronger claim is licensed. The open-problem ledger of Appendix H is the working list.

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